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Virginia Board of Education, Business Meeting, Thursday, November 17, 2022

Date	Thursday, November 17, 2022
Place	Virginia Board of Education (Virginia Department of Education), Richmond, Virginia
Length	11h 10m (video)

- Official meeting video (VDOE, YouTube): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vPIQhS2cYGw
- Board of Education meetings, agendas and minutes (VDOE): https://www.doe.virginia.gov/state-board-data-funding/virginia-board-of-education

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Speech-to-text: whisper.cpp, model large-v3-turbo. Produced 2026-10-23. Each paragraph starts with its time [HH:MM:SS] in the meeting video.

[00:17:33] With us today, welcome to the business meeting of the Virginia Board of Education, or as we like to say, the hardest-working unpaid board in the Commonwealth. We obviously have a lot of people, and to the extent we can maintain enough decorum to get through the meeting properly, I would certainly appreciate that.

[00:17:56] We're going to begin, as we always do, with a moment of silence followed by the Pledge of Allegiance. I ask that you keep in your hearts today, specifically, and honor the memory of the victims of the tragic shooting at University of Virginia. So we'll have a moment of silence, followed by the pledge.

[00:18:29] I pledge allegiance to the flag of the United States of America, and to the republic for which it stands, one nation, under God, indivisible, with liberty and justice for all. Okay. First order of business is the approval of the minutes from the October 19 and 20 meetings of the board.

[00:18:56] Is there a motion to approve or amend those minutes for 19 and 20? Moved. Thank you. Ms. Dutta, is there a second? Second. Thank you. Mr. Hanson, all those in favor, signify by saying aye. Aye. Aye. Any opposed? Okay. You know, we are delighted as a board to be back doing some resolutions of recognition.

[00:19:18] We had stopped for quite some time, both pandemic, and there just had not been, you know, just for concerns about, you know, that we had not done these in person, and they are particularly special to board members. Dr. Siebert, can you go to the podium to present the first resolution, please?

[00:19:38] Good morning, Mr. President, Superintendent Velo, colleagues. I am very pleased to be here today to recognize two outstanding Virginia educators. The board is delighted to recognize the most recent Milken Family Foundation National Educator Award winners, Ms. Kimberly Collins, Ms. Taylor Goodson, and I'll ask them both to come forward at this time.

[00:20:06] Ms. Collins is the coordinator for the Advancement Via Individual Determination Program, known as AVID, at Virginia Beach Middle School with Virginia Beach Public Schools. Ms. Collins is regarded as a champion for her students and has consistently designed rigorous learning plans that challenge students to continue growing to reflect on their work while remaining focused on the social, emotional learning.

[00:20:30] She helps foster a school culture based on trust and compassion, not only supporting her fears through leadership and collaboration, but by taking the time to attend extracurricular events, athletic events, and performances. Ms. Goodman is the assessment and compliance coordinator at Coventry Elementary School with York County Public Schools and has been described as an innovative educator who constantly seeks learning opportunities and explores research-based strategies to employ in her classroom while remaining focused on social-emotional learning.

[00:20:58] In addition to demonstrating in her collaborative spirit with her colleagues and taking on numerous leadership roles, Ms. Goodman is admired for leveraging her enthusiasm and passion to create an environment in which students feel valued and respected and are motivated to succeed.

[00:21:14] The Milken Educator Award is an initiative of the Milken Family Foundation. For 35 years, they have celebrated excellence in education by honoring top educators across the country. They look for early to mid-career educators who have a record of impressive achievements already, but more significantly, demonstrate great potential for future contributions to the profession. Each year, recommendations pour into the Milken Family Foundation. And although the selected winners represent all parts of the country, no state is guaranteed a winner. There is no given here. After the expected pandemic-related delays of 22, Virginia has seen two of our very

[00:21:52] own educators honored by this surprise announcement. There they learned in the presence of their students, colleagues, Superintendent Bailo, and other leaders that they'd been named Milken educators and would now have access to an elite network of Milken educators. But that distinction comes with an award, an award of $25,000. I imagine it was quite a shock for both Ms. Goodson and Ms.

[00:22:14] Collins, but clearly a very well-deserved honor. I speak for the board in saying that we share the Milken Families Foundation's mission to bring attention to classroom heroes to validate motivate and inspire current future educators this morning we have miss stephanie bishop from the milking family foundation miss bishop is herself a product of virginia public schools and for serving as a teacher and principal for 25 years and being named a milking educator in 2001 she joined the milking foundation miss bishop i invite you to come forward say a few words and present to the honorees lovely introduction thank you and good

[00:22:50] morning virginia state board members and superintendent baylow and thank you for inviting me to be with you today as you honor the newest Milk and Educator Award recipients in Virginia, Kimberly Collins of Virginia Beach and Taylor Goodson of York County. Again, I am Stephanie Bishop, Vice President of the Milk and Educator Awards in 2001, Milk and Educator from Virginia, and I am honored to be here in my home state. Superintendent Balo, your participation and support at their assemblies was deeply appreciated, along with Secretary Guadera and Deputy Secretary Mary Snow, who was with us in York County, and on behalf of the Milken Family Foundation,

[00:23:29] I would like to commend Superintendent Baylow for her support of the Milken Educator Awards program. She handled the surprise assemblies like a pro thanks to all the behind the scenes top secret planning and coordination by Dr. Meg Homer and Charles Pyle.

[00:23:45] Virginia joined the Milken Educator Awards program in 1999, and since then, over a million million dollars has been awarded to the greatest asset in the state of Virginia, its educators. The awards provide recognition and unrestricted financial awards to exceptional educators like Kimberly Collins and Taylor Goodson who are advancing excellence in Virginia schools.

[00:24:10] This past June, we welcomed Kimberly and Taylor to our national network of excellence at the Milk and Educator Awards Forum in Los Angeles, where they participated in panels and round tables with other Milken educators from across the nation. This school year, we are presenting up to 40 Milken Educator Awards across the country. We value your partnership with the Milken Educator Awards program, and we look forward to many more surprise announcements in Virginia in the future. So now it is my honor to present Kimberly Collins and Taylor

[00:24:45] goodson with their milk and educator award obelisks we have your resolutions

[00:25:26] we haven't done this in person with you guys yet have we people over here yes just get between somebody is the deal get between them

[00:25:54] you're too happy to be happy to need it thank you so much congratulations congratulations thank you thank you uh mr president colleagues the the recipients would like to share a couple

[00:26:31] words oh gosh um so we want to thank you for coming i guess first of all we do need to make it official, so we'll let the board actually authorize the resolutions I just presented you with. Is there a motion from the board to adopt the resolutions? This is a tense moment for you guys, you just don't know. Thank you Miss Creasy, is there a second? All in favor signify by saying aye. Okay, tense moment through, happy to hear from you guys. Yes, and we thank Miss Bishop for being here today, we certainly appreciate you having had a dear friend and colleague and in school where I serve receive a Milken Award. The network

[00:27:10] is legit it is an opportunity you're going to enjoy professionally throughout your career being connected to that that network of educators so welcome and congratulations so good morning thank you so much for this incredible honor I never could have imagined that my efforts in education would lead to being recognized in such an incredible way when I show up each day it is always with the students in mind the Milken Award is a wonderful celebration of this Educators don't just show up for the words of recognition, but they show up

[00:27:45] because kids matter. What many see as everyday mundane moments are actually the heart of education and what we do. These are the moments that spark ideas, plant seeds for growth, and progressively create positive change. These are the reward. I have dedicated many years on how social-

emotional learning, SEL, and curriculum can increase positive academic outcomes for all students. It is imperative to me that all educators understand what SEL is and what it isn't so that hard work of changing lives can truly be effective. My recent recognition has inspired me to collaborate with other educators to

[00:28:24] provide rigorous coursework without sacrificing the nature of the learning environment necessary for student happiness and overall success. Even before education began to feel the impact of COVID-19, there was a growing national teacher shortage now the profession is in a full-blown crisis my recent participation in events with the Milken Foundation coupled with my networking efforts has given me insight into what next steps might look like specifically I have been researching methods which with which districts can recruit and retain those invested in the teaching profession to begin my work I

[00:29:00] work daily to elevate the profession by showing joy in what I do building hope in others and encouraging students to consider teaching as a career if teachers exude love for this job it will pay dividends in the future it's no secret that the past few years have been difficult for all those involved in education rather than focusing on these difficulties i am choosing to elevate what is right educators stepped up during a global pandemic persevered through the recovery and have adapted to the aftermath why did they do this because kids

[00:29:35] matter. Teachers know that every kid in every classroom deserves love and acceptance in order to be challenged, enriched, and inspired through academics. All teachers deserve to be celebrated just as the Milken Foundation has done for me. This could elevate and activate a generation of powerful educators which will affect the change we wish to see. Thank you so much.

[00:30:01] Good morning and thank you guys so much for having us here today and recognizing our Milken awards so i just wanted to kind of start out and just share a little bit of history and kind of move into some really important things to me so i always wanted to be a teacher and i'm sure that people like me have shared that with you all before i remember being in second grade and people would say what do you want to be when you grow up and of course i said a teacher

[00:30:38] so as i went through college and started my early career i really learned that teaching truly is my passion um i think that it is the most important job in the world we have the place every single day to work with children to empower them to inspire them to engage them to just be their best selves so when i won this award um i always reflect back on the kids as miss collins shared um that day there was kids who cried tears one of my children actually cried for the rest of the day happy tears of course but the rest of the day other kids hugged me and just congratulated me

[00:31:17] made cards. Some kids asked if I was going to buy a Lamborghini. They also asked if I was going to retire. So, which I shared, no, neither of those were going to happen. But that excitement has not ended there. And that's what's so amazing to me. So, at the beginning of this school year at Open House, one of my families from last year came up and found me and we were having a conversation.

[00:31:43] And the mom said to me, do you know what my daughter wants to be when she grows up? I said, yeah, she wants to be a teacher, she told me. And she said, that's true. But after last year, she wants to be a third grade teacher just like you. And she wants to win the Milken Award just like you.

[00:32:03] That moment, I'll never forget. It was so powerful to me to inspire a child to want to do this amazing work that we get to do every single day. So I leave you with this. Right now is a critical time in education.

[00:32:19] we all know that it is our job to find recruit and keep amazing teachers who want to be here working with our children who want to help them be the best that they could be every single day so the student i spoke about earlier i know that one day she is going to be the one standing right here sharing with the board of education after she's won the milken award so thank you guys so much for your time i really appreciate it again thanks to both of you all of you for being here with us today it uh you know never hurts for the board to be reminded about you know what we do here that

[00:32:58] impacts actually what goes on where it matters in the classroom so thank you very very much um mr rotherham slightly different perspective uh mr president i have a resolution to commemorate november 2022 as family engagement and education month i'm pleased to present this board the board's resolution to commemorate november as family engagement and education month the board recognizes that strengthening relationships between parents, schools, educators, and communities

[00:33:37] is critical to meeting Virginia's commitment to high expectations and excellence for all students. This month and every month, the Board encourages schools to plan for ongoing family engagement and assist families in learning effective ways to engage in their child's education. The Board and the Department are committed to helping develop innovative ways of collaboration with families to ensure that every parent feels valued and respected to benefit their child's learning and achievement. To promote effective family engagement, the Board will continue its efforts to ensure that parents and educators know about a child's successes and where there's challenges by providing honest timely actionable and accurate information uh if family engagement

[00:34:14] month again reminds us that every child deserves an excellent high quality education that prepares them for a life of choices and to thrive in the global economy please join me in recognizing as family engagement education month in the commonwealth and mr president to that end i'd like I'd like to make a motion that we adopt a formal resolution.

[00:34:31] - Thank you, the resolution's with the board book. Is there a second? - Second. - I didn't think this one would be hard. Thank you, Ms. Dutter. All those in favor, say aye. - Aye. - Any opposed? Thank you. - Thank you.

[00:34:49] - All right, I guess we have one more recognition. That is just to tell you that we're so proud that the superintendent made it through that Richmond half marathon. - As well as the president. - Yeah, setting an example for all of us. - He was the blur on the course.

[00:35:06] Everyone saw me because I was going slowly. - Okay, we are at the public comment portion of the meeting. Standard comments we make from the board are, the board welcomes members of the public to address us during the public comment portion of the business meeting.

[00:35:21] Speakers will be recognized in the order in which the request was received. Speakers are asked to limit the remarks to three minutes. When your time is up, please close your remarks promptly. We ask that you please provide your name and affiliation at the beginning of your remarks. I should note, as we do every month, that the board does not respond to comments or ask questions from the dais.

[00:35:40] All comments are shared with the appropriate staff person for appropriate follow-up after the meeting. I will call each speaker to the podium and provide the name of the next speaker so that you're prepared to come to the podium. I will say, you know, we have an unusual number of people signed up for public comment, and I meant it when I said the board does in fact welcome public comment.

[00:36:00] A substantial majority of the folks who have signed up signed up on the same topic i'm going to ask a couple things number one to the extent possible try not to just be repetitive the board has also taken written comment on this and there is a substantial amount of that number two to the extent you can if you can limit the comments to two minutes i would be appreciative we are not going to implement that as a rule yet but i do ask for some courtesy given the number of speakers that we have signed up we can anticipate close to four hours of public comment and that is before the board begins its full agenda you know and

[00:36:40] there are a lot of items that are important moving forward on that agenda so to be clear we welcome the public comment we appreciate the public's interest in the work of the board but we do ask i do ask for some consideration as we move through this process to allowing us to move on you know with the business portion of the meeting as expeditiously as possible so uh with that having

[00:37:06] been said uh first speaker candace lucas followed by melissa sadiki good morning board members and dr balo barlow bailo i'm sorry my name is candace lucas and i am an advocate on behalf of children with disabilities specifically children of color i come before this board been coming before this board for about eight years i want to read a quote to you this quote says let me state this

[00:37:42] i think all schools that receive federal funding public charter and private should be required to meet the conditions of the individuals with disabilities act don't you agree with me that statement was made by senator timothy kane to your husband to betsy devos on january 17 2017.

[00:38:07] so my question becomes do you believe that right now in virginia that is not the case at all on In September 1st, 2022, and this is why we requested that this board demand monthly updates regarding special education from the special education department, Dr. Balow received a letter from the Office of Special Education, okay, federal, the FEDS, documenting that Virginia is still not in compliance with protecting parents' rights, still not in compliance with making sure that parents receive the services that they need for their kids, still not in

[00:38:43] compliance with making sure that parents have a right to an independent evaluation still not in compliance with ensuring the procedural safeguards of our families are protected we do understand that the idea is a civil rights law it is a civil rights law if you don't know that please educate yourself so when it's being violated civil rights are being violated and we can't say oh it's a denial of faith it's child abuse it is child abuse i need this board to stand up was that two minutes i'm going on to three please can i have my three minutes thank you okay and the bottom

[00:39:20] line is that we need you to stand up because i keep having to come back and things are not getting done you keep it's insane to expect things to change and keep the same people in place children are dying and you know chris jones the young man that murdered the three football players He went to Verina High School in Henrico and Child Find failed him.

[00:39:45] Child Find failed him. Chris Jones, the young man that last week shot and killed three of his peers, went to Verina High School where my daughter graduated from. Child Find failed him.

[00:40:01] And you guys are failing so many other children. I want to know when the next Chris Jones is going to come across the TV because you're not implementing IDEA. So we can have a moment of silence for the kids, but why don't we have a moment of action, okay?

[00:40:17] We can go ahead and talk about family engagement. That was just words to me. I don't stand for the pledge because we don't have liberty for all. So I need this board to do your constitutional duty and supervise education in the Commonwealth.

[00:40:40] - Ms. Siddiqui, followed by Ms. Halverson. - Good morning, board. I'd like to start by apologizing because I've sent numerous emails none of which was ever responded to.

[00:41:00] So I wasn't even aware that I was allowed to speak this morning. So I made this poster, Stop Perverting the IDA. This is what Chesterfield County, Henrico, really all of your school divisions in Virginia are doing.

[00:41:18] Like Ms. Lucas said, this woman saved us in 2017 because our county would do nothing for us. Our county still will do nothing for us. I am not able to enroll my children in public school.

[00:41:35] That is a right of taxpayers in any county. I should be able to walk in an elementary school with my children's record and enroll them. We are still waiting for our enrollment to be finalized and we're going on three and a half years.

[00:41:54] So that's illegal. It's criminal and it falls at your feet because all of you know this. You've been sent the emails. You know that my children are not allowed in public school. Explain that. It makes no sense.

[00:42:11] That's their right to be educated. This woman not only has gotten us through due processes, which, yeah, we lost, but thank God in appeal in federal court, that judge looked at me and said, you know what? I don't see you making up all of this, going through all of this for no reason, so I'm going to order private evaluations.

[00:42:35] Well, damn, those private evaluations showed that my 13-year-old's reading and comprehending on a third and fourth grade level, Cheshawil County, told us they evaluated him. He was perfect. Those are the words that they gave us. He's right on track. For what?

[00:42:52] For a disability check? What is right on track when you're 13 reading on a third and fourth grade level? I have begged for interventions. My child has now been suicidal twice on your watch.

[00:43:07] We just pulled him out of a hospital three months ago. I told you guys last meeting, I'm not gonna do this. I will not bury a dead child. And if I do, I swear to God, you will never get rid of me. I will be in your face every meeting going, why didn't you do it?

[00:43:27] Why didn't you do something? Why didn't you do something? Why not you? Do something. - Ms. Halverson followed by Ms. Bolton.

[00:43:48] good morning board i'm back again this month um about my son alexander halverson from powhatan county i've sent multiple emails received the letter from jillian baloe for the correction

[00:44:21] action plan i'm here today to try once again to get my son into private school he has been out now over a year he is he will be 11 in december this is a travesty my son once again cries every single night why can't he go to school and the one thing that is holding up this form right here csa

[00:44:52] for him. I'm asking why, why for my son to be educated, do I have to divulge what my HIV status is? What my financial history is? What about my mental health? Why? This is my child's right.

[00:45:18] I pay taxes, lots of taxes. My son is dying. So we want to talk about family engagement, month let's talk about this let's get these kids educated my son was in fourth grade they retained him once again he was doing lat two years ago august simple math we're talking about math and

[00:45:51] reading people he's been doing multiplication since he was two why in the fourth grade is he doing i asked they said oh it's a refresher class why because our grades are so bad and i have one last thing to say from the start of the first iep and through the whole process the only thing consistent with the willingness of the schools is to lie we have proven this time and time again

[00:46:28] as parents and citizens we are required to follow the laws of the state and the nation but the school systems feel free to break the school systems the laws because there is no consequences for doing so plain and simple there are no real checks and balances for these people this has no change this has no change this will change it has got to change for our children as miss lucas she's been advocating for me also with many others things have got to change or we

[00:47:06] will have more students over the news of more shootings mental health has got to be taken seriously this travesty everybody needs to wake up wake up okay melissa bolton followed by doris nick doris nick here okay so real quick i signed up under my maiden name because i didn't get a

[00:47:43] response to my my other email um really quick i just want to say um we need to get the pornography materials out of schools okay so i'm trying to i'm really trying to teach my child reading and comprehending on a third and fourth grade level um where he should be reading with um school books and and currently we have a book in churchville county public schools that literally i'm not going to say the word because i'm not that kind of but the p word the p word iep excuse me p p p i am saying p so please do not because this is in a middle school library in four of them

[00:48:21] hold on a minute hold on hold on i'm just saying it's very inappropriate and there's no educational purpose for pornographic materials to be in our schools. Now, if you wanna sit here and debate that with me, please, by all means, go ahead. - I don't wanna debate anything with you.

[00:48:37] I wanna move on to the next speaker. - No problem. - Thank you. - Good afternoon, good morning. I would not wanna be in your shoes. The reason why you have four hours worth of comments is because parents are mama bears and they wanna protect their cubs.

[00:48:57] And what we've been asking, just have to listen for just a few minutes it's there is no action holding these school boards accountable and we need you to be accountable as elected officials you should have even more integrity and we should be able to hold you accountable you some of you are new in this position but what we understand and what all the parents here need to understand is that you all have taken money to do all of these things you have taken the esser and the arp money and the funding and there's a book it's called the ed coveted 19 handbook parents if you haven't seen it go take a look it explains all the things that they've been doing all across the united states

[00:49:36] between the social emotional learning pushing of the lgbtq the extra technology the jab push and masking our children compromising their immune systems all of this has been funded by the u.s department of education that's why we are in this mess okay we are concerned we we do not like what has been what has been happening and we want to hold you accountable you don't respond to emails all these parents are saying the same thing i sent an email also we want our children protected that is the unifying message of everybody in this room

[00:50:14] okay i want to know miss ballo you were given a zip drive filled with evidence back in march when i was here something that annie and i had worked on a ton of evidence about chesterfield what is being done to hold merv doherty accountable how many parents in this room are in chesterfield alone you know what counties are misbehaving you know what superintendents are not doing their jobs do something about it and you will not have four hours of public comment it's unexcusable and you need a process what is your process to hold people accountable i sent an email i didn't get a response so y'all want to know what the process is it's timely foia apparently

[00:50:52] family foia to get answers that we've been looking for protect the children and stop choosing to take funding that harms our children thank you thank you david berringer followed by scott braebrand good morning and thanks for allowing me to speak to you this morning my name is david berringer and i currently live in flubana county and for the past almost 40 years i've been working in

[00:51:31] this broad field we call the public humanities which is history it's virginia's cultural traditions and all their richness and variety working in partnership with colleagues with organizations with agencies in every city and county in virginia yes and that includes teachers and school systems statewide i've also had the privilege of working with the state department with colleagues in the state department of education we built virtual programs for teachers during the pandemic and i've been involved as a member of the external review committees

[00:52:08] for both the 2015 and the current standards revisions there's one lesson i've learned through this work over the past 40 years it's that history is complicated far more complicated than i ever realized when i was growing up it can be controversial it is sometimes divisive as everybody in this room knows and it's fraught with challenges especially for the men and women who have the responsibility of teaching it to the young i know it isn't easy to teach

[00:52:42] math or science but i believe that teaching history is a far more difficult challenge because we're not just teaching facts they have the responsibility history teachers of shedding light on these very complicated stories stories of virginia the united states and it's not simply providing information it's creating informed citizens who understand the past and can use

[00:53:16] these lessons to make decisions in the present so i think almost everyone in this room would agree that teachers and that is history teachers especially need all the help they can get so i'm familiar i'm closely familiar with the process that produced the first draft of the 2023 standards the one that was produced by your doe history program staff it involved consultations with literally hundreds of qualified education professionals content experts thousands of public comments and i know how much work went into the development of this document i have deep respect

[00:53:55] for the qualifications the people who put it together how seriously they took the work the experience the spirit of service they brought to it and most of all for the breadth of input they sought when they were doing that by contrast the final what's called the final redraft that's under considers under consideration today was produced very quickly over a period of months by just a small number of individuals with minimal if any public input its flaws are apparent on the first page when it refers to native people as the first immigrants and then

[00:54:29] it does it again on page two i can't imagine one more second i can't imagine who would say a thing like that today knowing what we know and it's just the beginning of what's wrong with this document so we have a lack of transparency we have an exclusionary nature of the process we have content issues

and that's the reason why i'm asking you to table this version turn again to the one that was developed by your staff send that forward for appropriate public comment and eventual adoption no document like this is ever perfect the work of your staff has been diligent and it's exemplary

[00:55:07] in my respect the american historical historical association thinks so they've urged adoption in any case and i'll close with this i think the people of virginia deserve to see this document that our public employees produced to have the opportunity to recommend changes and eventually to adopt it thank you very much okay scott braebrand followed by ed ayers good morning president gecker superintendent baylow and members of the board of education my name is scott raybrand i'm the executive director for

[00:55:43] the virginia association of school superintendents i'm here to say thanks and to offer some feedback on a couple of items before the board first i want to say thanks to superintendent baylow president Gecker and board members Grace Creasy and Alan Siebert for joining us at our fall conference.

[00:55:58] We talked on several important issues before the board and we reaffirmed the importance of collaboration with stakeholders across the Commonwealth on educational issues. We hope Superintendent Bailo and President Gecker can return for our winter conference right here in Richmond, Virginia, January 9th, and we will be putting invitations out to all of the board members to come. We need to continue to have close collaboration as we move forward. Second, I want to provide feedback on the timeline presented yesterday around accreditation and accountability revisions. This important work must be done in collaboration with key educational

[00:56:34] stakeholder groups and VAS stands ready to work with you. It's important to know though that VAS remains strongly opposed to any changes in accreditation and accountability this year, including any changes this year in SOL cut scores.

[00:56:49] As discussed by President Gecker at our fall conference, it's important all topics before the board follow the standard protocols and procedures already established by this board so that we can work together and that strategic communications and engagement is critical for any changes in accreditation and accountability.

[00:57:07] Any changes to cut scores need to involve our teachers and educators who know the SOL content best. We know that high expectations agree that high expectations are important and teachers and educators need to know that VDOE and their school districts will provide the professional development and support for them to meet these high expectations. Finally, we appreciate your thoughtful review of attendance data for accreditation. Please know that chronic absenteeism remains a significant issue right now in many Virginia school districts with COVID, flu, SRV. My time is up. Please look at that very

[00:57:43] carefully as you look at chronic absenteeism. Happy Thanksgiving, and we'll see you in the new year. Thanks for all that you do. Dr. Ayers, followed by Amanda Grinnells. Good morning, everyone. Thank you for giving me a chance to speak with you today. I speak from the perspective as a historian of the United States who has taught in Virginia for more than 40 years.

[00:58:07] Throughout that time, when I served as president of the National Organization of American Historians, I have worked to foster collaboration among academic historians and teachers in our schools. Why? To help our young people in schools across Virginia to understand the past and its full humanity and complexity. And to do so, they have to care about the past, engage it, and even wrestle with it. I contributed to the curriculum frameworks for the proposed standards that were reviewed in August,

focusing on African American history. It was satisfying to help rectify the many omissions and misrepresentations that have marred history education in Virginia for

[00:58:46] generation after generation and it was gratifying to see the impressive ways even during the pandemic the department coordinated the insights of so many virginia teachers historians parents and community members as the doe considers displacing that document in which so many virginians have invested so much i urge you to consider the advice of the american historical association the aha represents 12 000 historians of every political persuasion expert in every moment of American history, in every era and region of world history. The association has worked for decades with teachers around the nation on their state standards. The executive director and staff of the

[00:59:25] AHA have twice offered to come to Richmond to talk with the DOE about what they have learned in those collaborations, but the AHA's offer has not been acknowledged. The letter made points worth considering nevertheless. The AHA praised the integrated and aligned instructional program laid out in the collaboratively produced document from August.

[00:59:45] They said the results are robust and should be a point of pride for the board and the secretary, as well as for the hundreds of other Virginians to contribute to them. They noted that cognitive research have documented that history students need extensive structured practice in considering multiple perspectives.

[01:00:03] Like mathematics, biology, and other disciplines, history has core concepts, such as context, contingency and causation that require practice to master. The AHA expressed no concern about the length or complexity of the August version of the standards. Indeed, the document is long, they said, because it admirably contains and integrates materials that provide easy reference for trained educators and districts.

[01:00:27] Teachers can rely on it as a central and shared resource. A simpler digest, the AHA suggested, might be composed to communicate to parents and others, but the standards themselves should not be truncated. So here's what I draw from my own experience in that commentary. It is important to remember that a broad and representative body captained a progressive chart of skills, carefully building from one year to the next.

[01:00:51] The people serving in that work called for the scaffolding of information to build understanding over time and from one course to the next. They collaborated on a broad document so that teachers in one class could see what teachers and others were teaching, so they could review the lessons from the previous year and lay the foundations that followed.

[01:01:09] suggested open-ended questions and instructional detail to teach students how to think historically how to confront the past in human foundation and complexity in short the people who worked on the august draft composed a workable practical guide to offer a coherent approach to the enormous complexities of the world's and nation's history and many have continued to contribute to those draft standards and frameworks in the month since august addressing previous concern that rich resource is, in its sophistication, inclusion, accuracy and specificity, superior to what is being presented to you.

[01:01:46] The list presented today offers only the illusion of efficiency, burying ambiguity and confusion in the minds of young people rather than accountable principles. The August document, in short, takes advantage of decades of collective commitment to and experience in Virginia school.

[01:02:02] Equally important, the open and inclusive process that created that document embodies the democratic participation that the standards rightly celebrate. I urge the board to adopt the revised version of the August document as the basis for your important work before you. Thank you for your commitment to our students and our Commonwealth. Thank you. Thank you, Dr. Ayers.

[01:02:25] Amanda Greinels and then followed by Susan France. I apologize for the mispronunciations. It's okay. President Gecker, Superintendent Balo and Board, my name is Amanda Greinels, a mother of two and a registered nurse with experience in community health, oncology, and critical care.

[01:02:48] I urge you not to add the COVID-19 vaccine to the school schedule. In August 2021, the FDA granted approval to Pfizer's Comirnaty vaccine after vilifying any early treatment options that would have excluded these novel injections. Most vaccines currently being administered are still under EUA authorization and therefore remain experimental.

[01:03:09] State Health Commissioner Dr. Norman Oliver sent a memo to his colleagues in august of 2021 warning them to avoid any off-label use and strictly adhere to the prep act guidelines which covers them with blanket immunity why is our state's top health official urging providers to maintain immunity from damages at all costs if they are safe and effective i am not willing to bet my son's healthy heart or my daughter's future of reproduction to a company that holds absolutely no liability the approval and promotion of these vaccines have been pushed

[01:03:43] based on their ability to prevent and spread the contraction of COVID-19. On October 11, 2022, top Pfizer exec Janine Small admitted to the European Union that their vaccines were never designed nor tested on transmissibility. Based on the number needed to treat, how many Virginia athletes dropping dead or developing lifelong heart damage will it take to prevent one case?

[01:04:05] Let's not forget Pfizer's criminal past. In 2007, Pfizer was criminally charged for illegally testing a fatal drug on unsuspecting nigerian citizens again in 2009 the same company agreed to pay 2.9 billion for illegally and fraudulently promoting its products sound familiar the underreporting in the bear system has largely gone ignored as has the rise in all-cause mortality in 2021 after the rollout of the vaccines i encourage you to educate yourselves with early treatment protocols and their outcomes listen to stories like dr paul Merrick's heroic efforts in saving the lives of ICU patients using early treatment. Madeline

[01:04:45] Daguerre, a 12-year-old girl, left debilitated after participating in the Pfizer clinical trial. I am not here to tell anyone what to do with their bodies. I am here to remind each of you that Virginia law provides that a parent has a fundamental right to make decisions concerning the care of their child. I am here to oppose Virginia children as test subjects from companies that hold absolutely no liability.

[01:05:08] I am here to remind every Virginia family that you have a right to a religious and philosophical exemption despite any decision made on this issue. I am here to remind Virginia families that you have a right to informed consent. I am very well informed and I do not consent.

[01:05:23] Thank you. Susan Franz followed by Dr. Monica Mann. Good morning.

[01:05:47] It seems that we are all here to protect our children and so I am appealing to you today behalf of the children of Virginia based on your biographies almost every one of you has children and some of you have grandchildren i'm asking that you do everything in your power as members of the board and con as and as concerned parents and grandparents to prevent a covet immunization from being put on a child

on the childhood immunization requirements for entry into virginia schools um you've already heard that the advisory committee recommended that this be put on the

[01:06:21] immunization schedule despite their vote the vaccine is dangerous and it is not effective I want to introduce you to Maddie de Grey she was 12 years old when she entered the Pfizer trial for the vaccine in 2020 immediately after her second shot in January of 2021 she had severe chest and abdominal pain her symptoms progressed to paralysis of her gastrointestinal tract seizures and and other neurological difficulties such as loss of bladder and bowel control and fainting.

[01:06:55] Currently, she's paralyzed and receives most nutrition through a feeding tube. At this time, there is no indication that she will ever return to the happy, active, smart young lady that she was prior to taking the vaccine. These situations are real, not rare.

[01:07:14] In June, Senator Ron Johnson of Wisconsin held a press conference to highlight these devastating situations. There are many more stories I could tell you of devastated lives and deaths, but I'm limited by time. The information is available if you choose to see it. It would be a travesty if Virginia children are required to take this vaccine for school entry. Once again, I appeal to you as mothers, fathers, grandparents, and public servants to do your research and do what is in your power to prevent this from being required for school entry. While I understand you do not have the

[01:07:51] power to make this particular decision you do have a voice and a position of influence I've been taught that silence is consent if you stay silent you are consenting to allowing our children to be maimed or murdered thank you and one more thing as I was driving down here I heard that the Midlothian high school is having a transgender appreciation week this does not belong in education And I'm not going to get off on that one.

[01:08:24] You've heard my medical testimony, and I hope that you will seriously consider this. I have papers for you all to look at. Dr. Monica Mann, followed by Dr. Sheila Furey.

[01:08:41] Hello. Hello. My name is Dr. Monica Manns, and I humbly request that you implement the original proposed revised 2022 history and social science standards of learning. That included recommendations by the African American History Commission.

[01:08:59] The original standard designs team and the commission were compromised of historical scholars, social science and history educators, museum scholars, diverse parents and community members from all parts of Virginia. These should be the entities that design our standards, not those who do so under the cloak of night and have an agenda that is not student and community centric and is not responsive to the diversity experiences within our community.

[01:09:22] I stand before you not as a person who has spent most of my 25 spanning years, spanning career as an educator, working with complex children from Virginia's most underprivileged communities, but because of all the hats you do not see. I wear the hats for those who I do hold dear to my history and my heart.

[01:09:40] My ancestors are enslaved people from Virginia plantations, and I am a manifestation of the enslaver's rape or of a forbidden love based on the color of my skin and the texture of my hair. The granddaughter of a World War II veteran who returned to unofficial servitude in segregated Southwest Virginia.

[01:09:56] The daughter of parents who both attended segregated schools until their graduation. The daughter of a father who did a two tour Vietnam Marine veteran who served on the front lines but could not find work when he returned home. The daughter of a mother with dyslexia who was belittled and maligned by her brilliance of ideas and capacity for the application of concepts.

[01:10:16] I am the wife of a man whose forebearers were enslaved Geechee people. The Geechee people were highly sought after by the enslavers because they had the skills to grow rice and brought those skills to America, enriching the lives of people who did not look like them. I also wear the hat of my chosen family, a family of young people who were past students and part of our state foster care system, who I have loved and been loved by and who have now given me five amazing godchildren.

[01:10:40] My chosen family also includes two best friends, now family of Asian origin, who both attended Virginia schools. They have shared how harmful it was to them that they never saw themselves in their history books, outside of the one-liner about Asian people building the transatlantic railroad.

[01:10:58] The families' immigration experiences, nor the historical contributions of people of Asian orientation to America were never examined. That is not okay. I provide my background to ensure that you understand the significance of why I stand in opposition to your decision to curate a document of standards of learning like those proposed.

[01:11:16] The newly proposed standards are predicated on the expectations of rote memorization and exclude opportunity for students to contextualize historical facts. As a teacher who had to implement similar rote memorization standards in the past, where quantity over quality was used to diminish the opportunity for critical analysis, I know intimately how this is.

[01:11:35] As a recognized, innovative educator, I made the lessons as engaging as possible, but due to time and expectations, the students were not given an opportunity for thoughtful discussion, analysis, application to current events and perspective taking. I saw their flames diminish.

[01:11:52] For students to be truly engaged in social sciences and history, it requires not only verified historical facts, but inquiry, analysis, application, and thoughtful discourse. Due to time, I will not end. I will give my information to record.

[01:12:08] - Thank you, ma'am. Dr. Sheila Fury, followed by Emily Mathon, good morning. - Good morning, I'm Dr. Sheila Fury.

[01:12:23] I'm the president of the Virginia Medical Freedom Alliance. It is disturbing to sit here, to listen to the pain of parents and educators. And as a physician, I have been feeling their pain my entire career because i'm a child psychiatrist and i've been particularly feeling that pain during covid19 and the missed dis and mal information that was propagated by our government

[01:12:55] the virginia department of health and those who were in charge with the duties to protect us and they did none of those things and they silenced the people who were working to save lives and they continue to silence the people who are trying to save lives. We have been sold a crock about the COVID-19 jabs. The data from the VAERS site is being hidden from us, and now in the hands of the Virginia Department of Health, they may choose to add the COVID jab to our children and make it

[01:13:35] mandatory for our children to be jabbed with a toxic substance, all in the name of it's going to protect grandma. Never has our medical community been so compromised. And it is disturbing for me as

a physician to speak to you about how corrupt my community is. But I will stand and I will speak against those physicians who continue the lie and continue the mystic and malinformation against the

[01:14:08] people who are saving lives. Maddie DeGarrius, who you already heard about, is one child of many. children are dropping dead on the basketball field, the football field, the soccer field. It is criminal. And if you just follow the rules, because following the rules is easy, let me remind you of history. The people who followed the rules ended up in a concentration

[01:14:39] camp and 6 million died. So you can continue to follow the rules and you can continue to not look at the information that is readily available, or you can watch our children die. Thank you.

[01:15:01] Emily meth on followed by Basia Gartenstein morning. Good morning I'm speaking today to you an opposition of the overhaul of the history and social studies standards the draft of which Superintendent Baylow shared last week just last month Baylow assured you as the school board and us as the public that we want to hear all voices Which is why she requested a delay?

[01:15:28] but in reality she wanted to include a small number of voices those of a consultant and small team that have a particular and specific set of viewpoints. Removed is the expertise of the Virginia Commission of African American History Education. Erased are the voices of thousands of parents like myself who submitted public comments. Dismissed are the years of work put in by the Virginia Department of Education staff, national experts, and the diverse range of individuals that invested in this effort. The proposed revised 2022 standards were thoughtfully crafted by experts in education in the fields of history and social science. They were created with students and their

[01:16:05] Education at the forefront this final redraft reads it reads as if party and votes are the made audience The Virginia code states that the standards of learning in all subject areas shall be subject to regular review and revision To maintain rigor and to reflect a balance between content knowledge and the application of knowledge in preparation For eventual employment and lifelong learning the board of education shall include in the standards of learning for history and social science The study of contributions to society of diverse people for the purposes of this subsection diverse includes consideration of disability, ethnicity, race, and gender. By undermining the

[01:16:41] years of work already invested by a large range of stakeholders, this current attempt at revising the standards is disrespectful and problematic. I urge you to reject this current overhaul and return to the draft proposal in summer 2022 to bring to the public engagement sessions and public hearings. Don't compromise the education of Virginia students. I'm a white parent of two white public school students in virginia i want my children to have a complete and accurate understanding of history so that they can not only not repeat the atrocities of the past but help

[01:17:12] create something better thank you thank you and you'll be followed by megan farency thank you thank you so much my name is basia gardenstein good morning and thank you for allowing me to address you i proudly represent the jewish community federation of richmond for a non-profit that functions as a convener and hub for jewish life in richmond which is the home of 16 000 jewish residents and we're part of a network of 146 jewish federations across north america

[01:17:46] i am a bit shaken by the comments that were made um by the woman two two times before me as someone jewish i really request that comparisons about the holocaust are not made to anything without close consultation with the jewish community today anti-semitism is on the right thank you anti-semitism

is on the rise and while jews make up barely two percent of the u.s population the fbi's 2020 hate crime statistics shows that crimes targeting jews comprise of 55 of religious bias hate crimes last year the majority of those hate crimes took place in

[01:18:24] virginia a stat quoted in last week's meeting of governor youngkin's anti-semitism commission we are grateful for the anti-semitism commission that the governor established the first in the country and if we're continuing to shine a light on discrimination we must learn about the origins of this ideology to bring to life never again for jewish people and marginalized unrepresented groups in our midst part of the work of the federation is assisting local educators to teach the lessons of the holocaust in partnership with the virginia holocaust museum we also respond to incidents of anti-semitism in local schools by providing educational resources to teachers and

[01:19:04] and administrators. Additionally, we educate on Jewish religion and peoplehood to promote understanding and exposure. These standards undermine our work. The new standards of learning are vaguely worded and will negatively impact the teaching of the Holocaust and its important lessons, as well as the Jewish tradition and people.

[01:19:22] Learning about the Holocaust and other dark chapters in our history, including slavery, Jim Crow, and their enduring impacts on our society is crucial to ensuring that these historic mistakes are never repeated. Understanding Judaism and ancient Israel are also essential components of addressing antisemitism.

[01:19:40] Without our essential comments in September and August Standards of Learning being accounted for, our attempt to address hatred toward the Jewish people in the Commonwealth is undermined, as I said before. Please consider using the edits sent on the August draft of the Standards of Learning, instead of the November 12th draft.

[01:19:58] We appreciate your service to our schools and are here as a resource if there's anything you need. Thank you very much. - Thank you. and you'll be followed by Dr. Perrigan. - Good morning, my name is Megan Ferenzi and for the past nine years, I have had the honor of being the Director of Education at the Virginia Holocaust Museum here in Richmond.

[01:20:22] I'm also the proud parent of two children who attend public school here in the Commonwealth. Reading through the recent redraft to the history and social studies standards, I was shocked to see that the standards in the first proposed document had been drastically changed, leaving out the critical thinking piece that is important when studying history.

[01:20:39] History, as we know, is complex, and specifically speaking to my area of expertise, learning about the Holocaust is just that, complex. Working with thousands of students and teachers, I ask people why we study the Holocaust. The first answer, 100% of the time, is so we learn from it and not repeat what happened.

[01:20:57] How can we learn from the event and the complexities of the Holocaust when the standards for the Holocaust are vague, incomplete, and severely lacking? For instance, one of the newly proposed standards states that students will apply history and social science skills to analyze major causes, events, and effects of America's role in World War II by examining the consequences of the Holocaust, including anti-Semitism, Nuremberg laws, restricting civil rights, resistance efforts, Nuremberg trials.

[01:21:25] This standard is incorrect and problematic in that it states that anti-Semitism is a consequence of the Holocaust, when anti-Semitism is one of the causes of the Holocaust. anti-semitism existed before nazism and it was through fear-mongering open discrimination rhetoric and normalization of racial and religious hatred and violence that led to the murder of millions of people an important fact to teach as it helps students to understand the conditions and attitudes present in germany to allow for something like the holocaust to take place furthermore this specific standard in the redraft allows for it fails to mention the nazi regime does not mention the word

[01:22:04] Nazi at all. The government in Germany is being the driving force behind the removal of rights of citizens. The standard also mentions restricting civil rights. Whose rights are restricted? That's never mentioned. The same problem is seen with resistance effort. Who is part of this resistance effort? Nothing is mentioned. The same vagueness and randomness with a choice of topics are seen in other history standards focused on the Holocaust in this new redraft. There are also key terms and topics that are left out such as the final solution changes within the redraft allow for superficial learning no critical thinking is involved at all

[01:22:40] we can all agree that Holocaust education is important but it needs to be of high quality and that is currently not present in the redraft as a parent I want my child to be learning about history all of it the good the bad the uncomfortable we can be proud of certain aspects of our history and at the same time, examine our past and be critical about it. How are we supposed to learn and grow as citizens of this country and of this world without it? I ask that the state board vote to reject the redraft rewrite and request the original proposed draft developed by Kristania Brown in the History

[01:23:19] and Social Science Office and reviewed by thousands of parents, teachers, historians, and museum professionals like myself move towards first review. And the Virginia Holocaust Museum is here as a partner as well and we would be happy to welcome you down for a tour thank you very much thank you dr peregan followed by katherine carter good morning president gecker dr balo honorable members of the board of education i'm keith perjan i'm superintendent of schools for bristol virginia i also serve as the president of the coalition of small and rural schools of

[01:23:55] virginia the topic i'm here to speak about today is not nearly as heavy as what you've heard other speakers speak on today however it is a very important topic for students in high poverty school divisions like our coalition represents and especially the city of bristol virginia i'm here to provide comment on item j the school construction assistance program as supplemental information you should have a copy of several recommendations that our coalition and other education groups have submitted to you for the last five years our coalition which is made up of 80 of the 132 school divisions in the commonwealth has been advocating for the commonwealth to return to the pre-great recession practice of providing just modest assistance to localities for the purpose of

[01:24:34] improving school facilities during the summer of 2021 our coalition hosted a statewide crumbling schools tour that highlighted a deteriorating school in each of virginia's eight regions in a locality that was struggling to fix the issues without some state assistance that tour in conjunction with recommendations from the commission on school construction and modernization which dr decker and i mr decker and i both serve led to the budget language that you're are considering today. Although we are thrilled that this opportunity now exists, the current recommended language is restrictive and will prevent some of Virginia's most distressed localities from taking advantage. Bristol is one such locality. Bristol currently has the fourth

[01:25:13] oldest school buildings in the Commonwealth and has been working to find a solution to replace some of these buildings since 2011. Unfortunately, Bristol has reached their legal debt capacity and is struggling financially because of bad decisions by former city leaders. However, because of the hope that Delegate O'Quinn's legislation provided that actually led to this budget language and along with creative financing that was provided by our Industrial Development Authority, we were finally able to get a project approved that will shutter and consolidate three of the oldest school buildings in the Commonwealth of Virginia. Unfortunately, this decision will cause our school division and our students to sacrifice in the future in other areas because of our city's continued financial stress. Under the

[01:25:52] current budget language, we would have been eligible for this assistance had we waited for the Board of Education to act before we applied for the assistance. However, the feds had announced last May that interest rates were going to be raised and we had already seen the cost of the project go up by four million dollars due to increased construction costs and supply chain issues. We chose to lock in our rate and our total cost and close the loan with our Industrial Development Authority in May. Governor Youngkin attended a ceremonial groundbreaking in June and we received our final construction permit on August 15th. Even though the state budget, which did not include the requirement that this be for only projects in the end of the biennium was

[01:26:30] approved on june 1st and became effective on july 1 the current recommended language would prevent bristol from being eligible because of the date the board of education approved this final language in essence any project that start in the first quarter of the biennium will not be eligible which i do not believe is the intent of the program as prescribed by the general assembly had we waited to receive the final rules of this program our interest rate would have risen four additional time since may and cost skyrocketed almost a little over 10 million dollars i hope the board of education will consider the recommendations made by vsba vast vaco and cozars specifically to consider any project that starts or finishes in the biennium for which this

[01:27:09] program was approved thank you very much thank you uh katherine carter followed by kathy hicks good morning i am katherine carter i am opposed to forced vaccination of children the vaccines are fda approved for emergency use however the president of the united states has declared the covet 19 pandemic is over therefore there is no need to coerce parents into vaccinating

[01:27:42] their children for an illness they are hardly most unlikely to contract in addition there's a conflict of interest with incestuous relationships circulating money within a circle consisting of cdc pharmaceutical companies at the taxpayer federal government funds to pad the covers of entities sponsoring the distribution and administration of their patented vaccines for which they earn humongous profit furthermore any clinical trials of the covid19 vaccines are

[01:28:17] still in progress and there are no independent clinical trials. Clinical trials consist solely of those conducted and interpreted with bias by the pharmaceutical companies that produce them. These companies enjoy and distribute a hefty profit to entice educational bureaucracies like veto to implement potentially life-altering and threatening irrelevant vaccines to children for a so-called pandemic disease that does not exist the burden of funding these vaccines that can cause

[01:28:51] both local and systemic adverse reactions such as myocarditis falls to the taxpayer also in event of chronic lifelong debilitating reactions the burden of extended care for vaccine injuries sits squarely on the shoulders of parents many of whom struggle to afford food and fuel what At risk is each member of the

board who votes to make forced COVID-19 vaccination a requirement for school enrollment and attendance willing to take.

[01:29:26] Is veto aware that 18 U.S. Code, the Nuremberg Code equivalent, requires full informed consent and absence of coercion? The code holds individuals accountable for each offense with prison terms up to life and fines under $100 million commensurate to the extent of harm inflicted, I strongly encourage you not to demand forced vaccines as a criteria for school attendance.

[01:30:04] - Okay, Katherine Hicks, followed by David Walrod. - Good morning, President Gecker, board member, Superintendent Ballou. My name is Kathy Hicks.

[01:30:20] I currently live in Orange County. I have spent over six decades in Virginia schools, First as a student and then as a proud social studies teacher. I was also a supervisor of social studies for a district and also served as the president of the state social studies supervisors.

[01:30:41] I would like to express my concerns about the proposed draft of the Virginia social science standards that we presented today. There are so many troubling aspects of these new standards. And the first is the bait and switch maneuver to get them to the board without the public knowing.

[01:31:00] These new proposed standards could not be found on the history and social studies VDOE webpage only if you search through the board agenda page. They were not up there and put on until a few days ago. That is outrageous and disrespectful.

[01:31:18] It is disrespectful of the process for creating the original standards. That process included partnership by hundreds of educators, historians, professors, museum organizations, parents, teachers, and VDO staff, considering over 6,000 public comments, and they were crafted over a period of two years.

[01:31:43] It's disrespectful to the highly regarded history and social studies staff at VDOE, who had this draft delivered to them without their ability to provide input. It is disrespectful to the truth. There's so many glaring omissions and misstatements that it is too lengthy for me to even cover within the time that I have available.

[01:32:08] It's disrespectful to Virginia's diverse groups and voices who have been removed from this document. A key example of this is the absence of Martin Luther King Jr. in the elementary curriculum until it was hastily added to kindergarten within the last few days.

[01:32:26] If Dr. King has been left out Who else's story is not being told? It is most disrespectful to the students of Virginia who deserve better. The board today is being asked to adopt a series of standards that is more appropriate for education in the 1960s.

[01:32:43] Back when students acquired knowledge primarily from books and asking students to memorize was the main teaching strategy. The problem with that kind of education in the 21st century is that all those facts that students had to dig for can now be found in five seconds on their cell phone.

[01:33:02] Kids are bombarded with information. They need the skills that have been removed from this draft to make sense of all the information they receive. The teaching of skills has to be an essential component of social science instruction.

[01:33:18] We are not preparing our students in Virginia to be Jeopardy contestants. The only job I can think of that requires a need for an overload of facts. we're preparing our students to be critical thinkers in

the 21st century. I urge you as a board to reject the draft that is being presented today and adopt the original history standards that were presented in August.

[01:33:41] Those standards represent many diverse voices of Virginia, incorporate best practice and social studies instruction, incorporate diverse perspectives, allowing all of Virginia children to see themselves in the curriculum, and prepare our students to be critical thinkers who experience success as they develop to be our future leaders.

[01:34:04] This is the only path to have world-class standards in Virginia. Thank you. - Thank you, David Walrod followed by Tricia Stahl. Good morning.

[01:34:21] - Good morning, President Gecker, Vice President Mann, members of the board. Thank you for providing me the opportunity to speak to you today. I come before you wearing many hats. I am the parent of a fifth grader in Virginia schools. I'm a current special education teacher with Fairfax County Public Schools who spent many years as an elementary classroom teacher.

[01:34:41] I'm a PhD student at George Mason University. I'm also the president of the Fairfax County Federation of Teachers. I'm here today representing the history and social studies teachers who know all too well the truth of the George Santayana quote, those who cannot remember the past are condemned to repeat it.

[01:34:59] As a teacher who has primarily taught math over the past several years, I was really jealous when I first saw the new proposed history and social studies standards over the summer. this was a robust document with rigorous standards but it was also a wonderful pedagogical tool beyond just the standards it provides a strong foundation for yearly and unit planning the understanding supporting questions and knowledge and disciplinary skills could have been invaluable resources for our teachers seeing a well-constructed 400-page outline of a k-12 curricula get paired down to a 50-page document with a listing of standards and no elaborations

[01:35:37] feels like a huge downgrade moving beyond that into the content um these new standards reflect a proposed whitewashing of history the only elementary school reference to martin luther king jr occurs in kindergarten and that was snuck in the past couple days ago that wasn't originally there um virginia students are going to spend more time learning about robert e lee than they do learning about dr king the third grade curriculum slashes ancient china ancient egypt and the African civilization Mali, instead extending the units on ancient Greece and Rome.

[01:36:13] Our third graders will no longer learn about any place other than Europe. Our third graders will learn about Odysseus and Aeneas. They'll learn about the emperor who built a wall keeping the picks out of Scotland, but they won't learn about a single person of African or Asian descent.

[01:36:35] Mali was part of the third grade curriculum since the 2001 revision when Jamestown moved to Virginia studies. For years, grade three has been an introduction to world history. So is the world only Western Europe? I urge this board say no to whitewashing, say no to the downgrading of our standards, and return the August framework. Thank you. All right, Tricia Stahl followed by

[01:37:12] Brendan Gillis. Good morning. Good morning. I hope that every one of you really do believe this. every child is a promise every child is a promise we must remember that during this difficult time i did not know i hope you'll never have to use this as an excuse to comply again we shut this nation down

the world down over this we've seen the falsehoods associated the data in the research clearly showed that the risk to children of kobe 19 is lower than the common winter illnesses and

[01:37:51] that children are a marginal factor in the spread of the virus the experimental biologic does not work. In fact, it is common that those who have had the experimental biologic have a higher incidence of contracting the disease and doing very poorly with it because it attacks the immune system. There is scant knowledge on the safety of the vaccine. We have to remember that the FDA approved this and received a permit for emergency use only. Biden said we're over COVID. FDA approved this for the permit only. Data shows a link between the vaccine and incidences of myocarditis

[01:38:29] in our children. Ninety percent of cases occurred after the second vaccine. There's plenty of professional opinion that exists today to show that the vaccine's authorization should not be extended to children under 16. In fact, under 65 in some states, or some nations, I should say.

[01:38:47] In recent weeks, calls have been made that preparation should be made to vaccinate the children. That would be irresponsible and neglectful. I'm a pediatric nurse. I'm alarmed when you look at the inserts in the scheduled vaccinations in America. The number of consequences and side effects are listed right there. I graduated in 1976. All of a sudden, Big Pharma started advertising on TV and pediatric facilities were popping up everywhere. And when you look at the inserts in the vaccines, you see why. The risk to children who contract the virus is extremely low.

[01:39:24] For children, the risk is even significantly lower than the risk of the common winter illnesses, such as influenza. And I will close by asking that each of you, please read the first 30 pages of Robert Kennedy's The Real Anthony Fauci.

[01:39:42] You will learn everything you need to know in that first 30 pages. And Big Pharma controls America, the CDC, the VDH, and I hope not each of you. And I know you don't feel like you're in a position make a decision about resisting or or not complying but i'm telling you we have got to stand up for these precious children you you may know that the uh mrna technology is absorbed in the testes and in the ovaries do you know what that's going to produce in future generations there won't be any it produces sterility and this is population control bill gates who funds the cdc his father

[01:40:21] was the Director of Planned Parenthood. Please don't forget that. And I have a little gift for each of you. Face, mask, pose serious risks to the healthy. So I hope that if you will get this, thank you.

[01:40:36] Who may I give this to, to give to you, 'cause I'm sure I can't approach you, right? Thank you. - Okay, Brendan Gillis. - Thank you. - Followed by Tessa Schumann. - Hi, my name is Brendan Gillis.

[01:40:52] Thank you very, very much for making time for us to share our feedback on some of these important issues. I wish this wasn't necessarily the only four hours that we would have to weigh in on these new standards. So I'm here to you today.

[01:41:07] I'm a historian. I'm an assistant professor of history at Lamar University in Texas. I'm on leave this year living in Virginia. I'm a Fairfax County resident. I've made my career as a history educator. I've been teaching history for the last 10 years or so.

[01:41:23] And I stand before you as a member of the American Historical Association, and as a parent, my son is gearing up to be affected by these curricular changes. And I share all of these different roles that

I inhabit with you, because I just wanna stress, I'm not the sort of person who normally comes to state school board meetings.

[01:41:43] Usually on a Thursday morning, I'm teaching history. And there are many, many like-minded people out there who share concerns about the process through which this newly revised set of history standards is being pushed through, and also the content of those standards.

[01:42:02] So let me just say the American Historical Association, as you've already heard, wrote a letter addressed to the board encouraging you to consider adopting the August standards, but also offering help and support in terms of revising any new standards that you do wish to adopt.

[01:42:23] And I really strongly encourage you to take advantage of that opportunity. As you can see, there's a lot of teachers, historians, community members, and parents out here who really want to be part of this process and didn't necessarily see that there were new standards announced on Friday night.

[01:42:41] So this is a very, very important process. We take it very seriously. And just a couple of points I want to stress. You've heard about some of the contents it's missing here I just want to reiterate as an educator inquiry is not an afterthought there is a promise throughout the new materials the inquiry and skills will be addressed more fully in the curricular frameworks that may be but it's also as many of us know a key principle of what history education is all about so please don't shove inquiry to the side and lastly

[01:43:19] transparency the original August document was the result of years of conversation and interaction between experts community members and whatever happens going forward we want to be part of this process so please include us thank you very much for your time thank you and I know I say we don't respond to anything but I would like to make it clear because you made a comment that this was the only opportunity you thought the board is required but would do it anyway to go out for public comment around the Commonwealth and public

[01:43:55] hearings that are noticed 30 day before 30 days before each hearing so this is a first review item for the board it is not the final review and you know as I said we're required to but by inclination we would do it anyway we do go around the state seeking public input and the superintendent reminds me the department is doing community engagement sessions on this also so Tessa Schumann

[01:44:24] followed by Crystal Parker yeah okay Randy O'Neill good morning board I'm gonna make this quick I'm hoping that I solve some problems in 2000 Virginia Tech built the mobile chemistry lab it rode around to four divisions in Southwest Virginia in the city of Richmond right here it made those sites those school sites that are a hundred years old and fallen down and full of asbestos into a

[01:45:04] a state-of-the-art education platform. On that data, when I was injured in an industrial accident, I realized that the children and the workforce here in Virginia, look, we don't have 15,000 state employees returning to work. You got 33% drop in people looking to be teachers. So I started a small business, and you're not engaging small business in the state of Virginia or nationwide to solve these problems you want us to hire everybody and then train so in 2002 I built this mobile chemistry lab so when the governor runs around talking about

[01:45:40] labs nobody knows what he's talking about and I wonder if he does so a chemistry lab okay that ran around and lifted the grades all the boats in Richmond Public Schools by 32% I've got the letter right here sadly the school saw that as a threat and they discontinued it and they sold it to University of

Pittsburgh and they've been rolling with it okay so what I do is I'm because I'm all about data because I'm a small business and I have to produce this stuff so I'm published by the CDC I am recognized as a practitioner in and out of school with community health I am also a presidential fitness

[01:46:19] partner okay so I roll not only to occlude school but to the corner wherever there's a hot spot where there's trouble now my son Roman is in a second grade at Charles City Elementary School, and one of his classmates brought a knife on Monday. Second grade. My kid wants a gun now. I'm really concerned with some of the money y'all are spending up here. I just have to look right over here to this school board office here in Richmond.

[01:46:44] The Barrington Family Foundation with Mr. Farrell, Dominion, former Dominion president, started a not-for-profit called NextUp. The Richmond mayor has paid NextUp $1.5 million. The schools over there in Richmond are paying NextUp $450,000 a year for a program that costs $250 for one hour of food cooking classes per student. I've worked in all the schools in Richmond. I bill $3.33 an

[01:47:20] hour i'm k through 12. my pre-k first grade i teach them about resting and accelerated heart rate my second third graders i teach them about resistance training and interval training my fifth graders sixth graders we talk about the heart rate sols okay so when you want to put a skill to a vocabulary your children cannot read that's it you do it through physical exercise physical exercise you get to read my kids read inside this rig not to mention watch educational

[01:47:58] videos we have got to take the health of the children far more seriously pe is a joke you keep investing in these sports stadiums and and the communities keep spending hundreds of millions of dollars on these travel teams they're perverting sports and little kids for a revenue stream you all keep looking to kids for a revenue stream i'm looking to help them yeah i need to make a little bit of money and you're looking at this milking you know no one's ever invited me up to this building i've worked in 1300 schools i've had hundreds of thousands of children through my

[01:48:37] trailer in the last 22 years it's brand new you keep investing in a in a bike path you're safe routes to school you are paying for an employee and in most cases they're just you know that's okay thank you have a great day Virginia is for education okay Virginia is for education that's the name of my

[01:49:07] business delegate Bagby I'm sorry about that I didn't see you stand up and so we kept going but thank you for reminding us. Absolutely. My name is Crystal Varner Parker. I'm a Presbyterian minister in the Presbyterian Church USA. I am a product of Virginia Public Schools, a mother of two Henrico County students, and I have already sent you a letter addressing my concerns with the 11th hour

[01:49:43] substitution of these standards, but I would like to address a few things within them. This new draft is cloaked as being politically neutral, whereas it presents a politically biased and narrow version of history. These standards Students rely heavily on materials and framing from the classical schools movement, which holds a narrow Euro and Christocentric set of values, which does not represent historical accuracy or include the diversity of Virginia students, the teachers, or the district leaders.

[01:50:13] These standards perpetuate a situation in which countless students are left being and feeling unseen in the classroom and curriculum. As a multiracial student of Japanese and Native American ancestry in Virginia public schools, I knew firsthand how it feels to be unseen in our curriculum and classroom.

[01:50:33] It was through a book discovered in a library by Yoshiko Yuchira that I learned the incarceration of Japanese-American citizens. This was not taught in our curriculum in 1980s and 1990s, and I should hope that the incarceration of Japanese-American citizens would receive more content than the mere effects of the war on the home front in our Virginia history and social science standards.

[01:50:55] considering Japanese Americans were placed in a relocation camp in the homestead resort in Virginia. We have taken many steps forward in regards to how we teach history and social science in Virginia, and the work of the Educators Committee was set to help us take many more.

[01:51:12] These standards proposed for first review today take many steps in reverse. Native Americans are referred to as first immigrants, with the underlying implication that they had not been here for 10,000 years and that perhaps our land was just up for grabs.

[01:51:27] We are also returning to the language of the benevolent slave owner and happy slaves who are happy in their former homeland. We cannot hide from the fact that human beings were brought to America, sold to the highest bidder without care or concern for their humanity or family of origin, and that these enslaved persons were simply trying to cope.

[01:51:47] The original standards that educators had been using for the last seven years made needed updates based on research and best practice. And Virginia, like many states has been stated prior, in the midst of a critical teacher storage adopting these new standards which would be filled with inaccurate inaccuracies would require teachers to overhaul their curriculum stands in direct opposition to cheat addressing teacher attrition and retention i'm asking and urging

[01:52:17] you to not go forward with this first august of 2022 thank you thank you followed by lisa guernsey i don't see him and so what another mishap on my part please come on up uh all by holly means um hello and thank you very much all of you for your service and for the opportunity to speak to

[01:52:55] you today my name is lisa guernsey i'm a long-time virginian and i'm a parent of two daughters who are graduates of our public schools and are now at our state's public universities i'm also an education policy analyst and a journalist who has spent two decades reporting on educational media and teaching and learning around the country i'm here to urge you to vote no on first review of this new draft of social studies standards you've already heard many eloquent reasons why this draft won't work includes embarrassing omissions and it could lead to major disruptions

[01:53:34] in staffing with middle school teachers being asked to teach what has been elementary school content and vice versa but most importantly it appears to have been developed without public input in an administration that has staked its reputation on parent input on openness and transparency and on giving students an education that prepares them for the future this draft misses on all three counts the previous draft was not perfect but it was getting us close it emerged from the time and expertise of more than 200 people on nine committees they came from all

[01:54:13] corners of the state they included business leaders and a parent advisory committee many committee members spent hours examining the standards line by line debating and coming to consensus on what was most accurate and what was developmentally appropriate for each grade in addition the department has taken in more than seven six thousand suggestions and that's not even taking into account the input from the year prior in which public meetings held in many regions across the state and online brought Virginians together to improve the way african-american history is taught contrast this with what

[01:54:52] you have before you and it feels like this comes out of nowhere earlier this fall I wrote for the Richmond Times dispatch about how Virginia's standards could make us proud now I worry that we will be a national example of what not to do. Please don't move Virginia backwards. Thank you. Good morning. I am a Virginia educator of over 26 years who holds degrees in history, education, education leadership, and political

[01:55:30] science. I'm a member of the VSSLC, and most importantly, I'm a parent of children in the public school system. I am here to speak about the social studies standards of learning being presented today and i beg your attention i would like to speak i would like to speak about how the standards are wrought with errors from historical to grammatical how they are developmentally inappropriate for k through three how they glaringly omit and overgeneralize content especially those involving marginalized groups like the jewish african-american and aapi communities

[01:56:04] indigenous peoples not immigrants and women or about how the standards address a curriculum framework that has not even been created yet instead i want to talk about the review and revision process and my role in it as an educator i have been a part of the standards review process several times and in many different capacities from developing standards to reviewing public comment i am a teacher who is part of the process who then taught the standards i had been a part of creating. I had full faith in this document because together we had built

[01:56:42] standards through a democratic process in which I had a role and a voice and I beg your attention this morning, please. This process amounted to almost two years of consideration and included extensive review and revision by professional educators and historical experts and the input of thousands of people in every review cycle we have done the finals the final standards document was fair balance and nonpartisan how because of the many voices included in the review allowing for accuracy and diversity of

[01:57:18] content from their varied perspectives and lived experiences in fact the process i am talking about is the very one that created the 22 2022 revision standards put forward to the board this past August. You spoke earlier of public comment being open. We've already had public comment and we created those standards in a democratic process and those are not the ones you are presenting here today. Your standards were not a part of a process. They were not reviewed by citizens, not vetted by content experts, not discussed by educational professionals, and did not even

[01:57:53] include our state history and social science coordinator and her team. As a pedagogical and content specialist i would never suppose to write a document of such consequence as this without seeking advice and input from professionals and stakeholders like parents this speaks to why your standards document is so flawed in so many ways developmentally historically and in its lack of cultural inclusivity as i spoke to earlier to conclude i am in fact i can emphatically say that in my capacity as an instructional specialist i do not have faith in your standards document not

[01:58:32] only because i have carefully reviewed it and see its eurocentric nature but it was not created with a process it is a document without input transparency review revision or diversity of perspective instead it was made with political motivations purposely undermining the contributions of viewpoints of people like me show you value virginia educators parents and citizens and go back to the review and revision standards created within the process guidelines you passed a resolution for the milken award winners and for commemorating family engagement

[01:59:07] let your actions honor this thank you zoe aquino followed by ha tang i think after those two the board may want to take a quick break all right well good morning mr chairman members of the board and superintendent my name is zoe aquino and i'm here once again on behalf of humke center a community-based organization organizing with asian americans in virginia this time i'm joined here by my colleagues community organizations like mine and virginians from across the state to talk to you once again about the history sols it took about two years

[01:59:45] for the department of education to get the original sol revisions ready for you in july it took about two months for the superintendent baylow to get you this draft which has been defiled by places like fordham institute and hillsdale college organizations with known ties to the trump administration and it took me a former virginia student a little under two minutes to read through the standards that the superintendent prepared for you today and see they were rewritten in a racist factually incorrect and heavily biased way and i was horrified by what i read you've heard and will continue to hear many points of view today and for now i'm going to focus on the asian american community content which was stripped significantly to just two mentions and i'm so personally insulted by this erasure and the violent erasures of my fellow

[02:00:25] virginians in the black brown jewish latinx lgbtq indigenous and more communities who came out here to talk today my grandfather filipino-american veteran of this country for over virginia beach for 50 years was about to rest three weeks ago sorry i don't mean to cry he was born during the american occupation of the philippines and he joined the military like millions of others like him because of restrictions like the loose cellar act of 1946. he lived in major events of the mid late 20th centuries in hampton roads which is the third largest filipino-american community in the

[02:01:01] the United States. And this is just a really small fraction of what our state holds. And the superintendent doesn't think that these events impacted people. People like this are important enough to be core standards in our state. Honestly, if you approve this document, he's died twice to me, and you've killed him. I want you to remember my face in his name when you do this. His name was Luciano Kovu-Ton. And I just want to say, speaking as a Virginian, i'm just tired i'm tired i love my state so much and i'm tired of being on the wrong side of history we were the capital of the confederacy we were leaders of fast resistance and now the 2022 history

[02:01:41] sols it's embarrassing and shameful to be associated with these things and please just put virginia on the right side of history and set an example for our state and our students reject reject the standards that will be presented today and go back to the july draft for original first review it had input from over 200 experts and 6 000 public comments already or just be condemned to go down in history as the folks that allowed racism to win in virginia once again today either way if the recent press and social media bus and the folks who have come out here to speak are any indication our voices here in virginia will not go unheard especially not when it comes to our

[02:02:16] education ha tang good morning superintendent bailo and members of the board my name is ha tang My pronouns are she/her, and I am a community organizer at Humphrey Center.

[02:02:43] I will be using this time to uplift a comment from a high school student community member of mine who was not able to be here in person. Hello, my name is Samantha Wang, a Chinese American high school student from Blacksburg, Virginia. It would be an absolute shame and embarrassment for Virginia to implement the 1776 curriculum in our education system. This curriculum is a whitewashed and

untruthful version of history and by supporting it you are supporting indoctrination but but instead of telling you all this reasons why the curriculum is harmful i will paint a picture of our school system if we implement the newly proposed sll standards in first grade students

[02:03:21] don't know of martin luther king jr a man who represented equality for all regardless of skin color they won't learn about him until sixth grade instead these seven-year-olds are learning about Hammurabi's code, a set of laws that involve disassemblement, torture, and execution. The same students will continue on their education for another 11 years, only learning about Asian American community twice. Over 300 years of history and we are merely a passing thought.

[02:03:50] The centuries of racism, violence, and hardship we endured erased. But this scenario doesn't have to be our reality. By rejecting Superintendent Baylor's draft and supporting the original SLO draft presented in july we can keep the truth in our education thank you thank you uh as mentioned i think the board is going to take a break until 11. uh when we start back it'll be ashley elstad

[02:04:15] and hazel veneet thank you all we're in recess i'm going to call the meeting back to order

[02:16:38] uh ashley elstad followed by hazel veneet hello i am not ashley elstad i'm her co co-worker sukyung So, you know, I'm, dear members of the board, my name is Sugyeong Oh, I'm here today as the director of Hamke Center, a community group whose mission is to organize Asian Americans to achieve racial, economic, and social justice.

[02:17:11] I think you've heard from many in the room today about the egregious, shockingly egregious concerns about the content. I want to be really explicit also about the process.

[02:17:29] We have, this is, okay, this is November, right? Since August, we have heard the words from the superintendent, right? Oh, we need another month 'cause we need to clean up the, we need to clean up this draft or, you know, there are inaccurate, there's omissions here as well, right?

[02:17:50] Like George Washington, why isn't he named the father of, you know, a father of this country and whatnot. I just want to be very explicit around how are any of us supposed to trust the superintendent and the Yonkin administration at this point when it comes to what they intend to do?

[02:18:09] Again, how many times have we been misled about what they say they're going to do? And now we are here today with a completely different set of standards. You know, we haven't, and there's some other concerns here about, we haven't even seen the curricula framework, right?

[02:18:32] So for all the shocking omissions and inaccuracies we're seeing in the standards, we're not even going to see the framework until next year, which is then when apparently this is all supposed to be applied. I'm inviting the board to deeply, deeply reflect on what the public has gone through in these past few months.

[02:18:57] You know, if the Yunkin administration thought they could get away with promoting inaccurate and politically biased history and social science standards that were developed behind closed doors without a state actors, with known agendas pandering to Christian nationalism and white supremacy.

[02:19:15] You know what? They didn't factor in all of us and all the other people who have testified today to strongly urge that the board reject the Yunkin standards and to move forward, vote for first review of the standards that were brought to you in August.

[02:19:35] I also am, there are some other issues that I think hasn't been paid as much attention, but I'd like to just preview a little bit now around what else the guiding principles discussed around limiting teacher-created curriculum.

[02:19:51] That doesn't exist for any other subject. Why is it only for history and social studies? how how are teachers supposed to do their job you know trying to connect history with current events if everything that they have to do has to be um also um they have to go through additional administrative burden to have parents review the content potentially at the end the start of the school year before they can teach it it's taking away a lot of flexibility for teachers to try to make history and civics actually connect with students nowadays so you know i'm also here today

[02:20:28] as a parent living in norfolk virginia i want my child to learn about the great and awesome responsibilities of being american about civics that means learning about how government works the role that people like him not just great white men have to shape the course of history the responsibilities of voting volunteering and speaking publicly i want them to learn as dr newbie alexander stated in her written comments to you critical thinking civic debates and com classroom confidence he's not going to get that from the yunkin standards he's going to be this asian-american kid who once again is not going to get to learn about his history in his

[02:21:07] class in his classrooms so again i'm urging the board urging the board please take decisive action today vote reject these young can standards vote for first review on the standards that were brought to you at the august meeting thank you okay uh hazel vanit followed by uh jasmine batia good

[02:21:46] morning guys my name is hazel vanit and i'm a current sophomore at the college of william and mary and a graduate of the fairfax county public school system i'm here to say today that i'm disappointed in this sandwich presented by the new sol draft as a first generation american I grew up wanting to learn everything about both my homes here and in India, I was always deeply curious about the experiences of all Americans.

[02:22:07] I was raised to understand that my education was my voice, and this new proposed draft is taking a voice away from Virginia students. The standards presented in the new draft are not inclusive and simply just don't tell the whole story that Virginia students need to know to understand themselves and the world around them.

[02:22:23] Going into a specific standard, there are pointless and frankly age-inappropriate ideas presented in the drafted curriculum. ideas like the founding fathers being guided by judo-christian beliefs and the intense focus on patriotism are unnecessary and untrue the removal of mentions of martin luther king and racism do the students a disservice by not teaching them about necessary history that they need to know the original draft presented over the summer was more inclusive and actually talked about the true experiences of minorities in our country minorities make up our country i encourage the board to review that draft and consider the curriculum that hundreds of people put so much time and work into. Our country has an intense focus on patriotism, but to me

[02:23:02] patriotism is knowing and recognizing our country's history and addressing what we can do to be better. For the future of our students and our nation, I urge you all to reflect and listen. As students, we need representation, we need a voice, and you all have a power to make that happen. Thank you.

[02:23:22] Jasmine Bhatia, followed by Manpreet Kaur. Good morning, board members. My name is Jasmine Singh Bhatia, and I've been living in richmond virginia for last 10 years i have a son who goes to first grade in henrico county and i'm concerned about the social studies uh curriculum being developed by the board here but i would first first like to start by thanking you for giving me an opportunity to speak here uh and being open to hear uh the public comments i'm here speaking on as a member of the sick

[02:24:00] community, which is the fifth largest religion across the world, with 25 million Sikhs across the world, and Sikhs contributions to the United States have been dating for the last 125 years. I'm here to urge Virginia to join 14 other states in the country to include Sikhism in their social studies standards and curriculum frameworks. Like all parents, I want to ensure my child is safe in the school and as you can see my identity i look different i wear a turban on my head my son also wears a smaller turban which is called a patka and wherever he goes he looks

[02:24:40] different and for him uh for his to for his classmates to know about his history about who he represents is very important for his safety so to a lack of inclusion translates into ignorance and ultimately it breeds animosity i've been to public schools earlier before my son and i've heard comments which were shocking to me as to like where are the kids learning that from and i what i've learned now it's not where they're learning it's about lack of learning of those things uh they're not being aware of uh other things upon reading the recent most version of the draft i was glad to see that sickism is still being continued to be included in world history

[02:25:19] and geography standard at the high school level but i'm but that's not enough sickism must also be included in the curriculum frameworks moving forward research by the sick relation which is a organization faith-based organization in the country has identified 67 percent of turban six are being bullied in the school it's the intent the turban is an intention where six are accountable to behold for greater purpose of fighting for justice and maintaining our uncut hair however it is being misinterpreted sadly due to this ignorance six have faced significant violence

[02:25:55] discrimination in post-9/11 America. Unless these changes are made to start representing marginalized groups like ours, the standards will not be culturally relevant or inclusive. Students will not be prepared to encounter diversity. I would also like to express my concerns about the continued delays we have seen. I am disappointed to hear reports of delays on the curriculum frameworks as they are necessary to truly weigh in on the standards document.

[02:26:22] We would also encourage that these standards are released earlier so that communities like ours have time to review and provide feedback i implore you all to include sickisms in the standards and curriculum frameworks to provide transparency as to the status and review process of the curriculum frameworks and to recognize the concerns of marginal communities who are unhappy with the updated standards drop thank you for your time and consideration and being open to listen to

[02:26:52] our feedback thank you thank you have a good day good morning everyone i am manpreet core and thank you for giving me an opportunity to speak at this hearing today i have been in virginia for last 10 years and most two aspects of me that i want to share with you today one i'm part of a sikh community i'm a member of the world fifth world's fifth largest independent religion that

[02:27:27] is Sikhism and the second aspect is my education i am a data analytics professional with a master's from vcu and most importantly the third one that i would like to highlight i'm a mother of a sick

child who wears a smaller version of turban on his head and he goes to school every day he's part of the hcps system and he's been going to school preschool since like two and a half years

[02:27:58] old since that point onwards he has felt being he has felt the emotion this the insecurity that comes when somebody looks different with that with that being said i would like to say six also have a unique visible identity which i've also mentioned with my son and often wear five articles of faith for many six students just like my son this often means being misunderstood being marginalized in the class. Research by the Sikh coalition, which I'm here representing today, shows that Sikh

[02:28:36] students are bullied at more than two times the national average. By looking at that figure, my heart just sinks because I'm insecure that one day my son may also feel the wrath of bullying, and he may not be happy with that. According to Sikh students who experience bullying, one of the best ways to keep them safe is to educate their teachers and classmates about the Sikh tradition in an accurate and constitutionally appropriate way. For this reason, I urge Virginia

[02:29:11] to join 14 other states to ensure continued inclusion of Sikhism in the world history and geography standard at the high school level and to also ensure inclusion of Sikhism in the curriculum frameworks which are yet to be made public. The classroom is the starting point at which students learn about the world around them and how to interact with it and we have seen that happening when we when we have gone to our kids classroom and talk to the other kids how things have shifted how their camaraderie has shifted just by knowing who he is and what is his identity representation

[02:29:49] of diverse groups fosters awareness and understanding of our world in the case of Sikhism it is vital for Sikhism to be included in the study of the development of India within the curriculum fair frameworks not just one standard i implore you to take note of the recommendations made by the sick coalition who have submitted an official response to the virginia board of education i also urge you to ensure social studies standards and curriculum frameworks are inclusive and representative of the diverse communities of virginia with transparency i just

[02:30:26] want to make one last point here as soon as we make our schools safe we make kids open to learning and becoming more peaceful citizens of the world thank you for your time and consideration thank you thank you yashnor core followed by anad singh hello my name is yashnor kar sandhu and i'm a

[02:31:01] student at virginia commonwealth university i'm majoring in biomedical engineering and prior to attending vcu i was a student in the virginia public school system right now virginia is presented with a critical opportunity to include the untold history of the sick community i'm glad to see sickism's inclusion in the world history and geography standard in the most recent draft but maintain that that is not enough i urge you to include sickism in the curriculum frameworks as we move forward here in virginia the sick community is robust and vibrant the sick student

[02:31:38] Association at VCU, as well as the local Sikh community, have engaged with the greater Richmond area through service. Just to mention a few examples, we've done meal preparations at the Ronald McDonald House, food service at elderly care homes, and donated masks and meals to frontline workers during the height of the pandemic. As the fifth largest independent religion, Sikhs believe in the concept of one God, the creator who loves and sustains the whole of humanity. Sikhs believe that everyone is equal in the eyes of God, regardless of gender, ethnicity,

[02:32:16] race, or identity. The phrase mirrors, windows, and sliding glass doors was coined by Dr. Rudine Bishop. Dr. Bishop argued that education can serve as a window, offering views of worlds that may be real or imagined. Education can also serve as a mirror, reflecting back our own lives and stories as a small part of the grander human experience.

[02:32:41] And in the best of conditions, education can be a sliding glass door, allowing students to enter a new world full of possibility and growth. Inclusion of Sikhism and other diverse communities can be the sliding glass door that we want education to be.

[02:32:57] But this most recent draft fails to be that. Instead, it takes a step backward from the August draft that was designed with the expert feedback and community collaboration. I urge the Board of Education and Superintendent to listen to the concerns of community-based organizations to ensure there is meaningful inclusion of diverse perspectives in the standards and curriculum frameworks. Just as the Sikh community would like inclusion, so too would many other groups and communities that have been historically ignored and marginalized.

[02:33:33] Their experiences and stories matter and deserve to be told. Please take note of the changes recommended to the current standards by the Sikh coalition who have submitted an official response to the Virginia Board of Education and to consider the specific recommendations I have provided to the board. Transparency and inclusivity are sorely needed. Thank you for your time and consideration.

[02:33:57] Thank you. Anad Singh followed by Gursamal Dhaliwal. Good morning. My name is Anad Singh Sandhu. I'm a 13-year-old eighth grader at George H. Moody Middle School. I'm here today to talk about being a Sikh and why it is important for me that my religion and identity is taught in classrooms.

[02:34:20] As the fifth largest religion in the world, Sikhs believe in the concept of one God. For Sikhs, everyone is deemed as being equal in the eyes of God. We are taught to live honestly, share resources with others, and meditate often times. Sikhs are recognized by our articles of faith. As you can see today, I am wearing a patka which covers my uncut hair. This is a decision many Sikhs make to stand out and stand for Sikh values and principles.

[02:34:48] Including a visible identity along with the lack of teaching on Sikhism has led to ignorance that harms our community. From an early age I have had classmates call me a girl because I have long hair or have called me a terrorist and a bomber because of my head covering. Some of my peers have even taken it a step further and removed my parka without my permission or threatened to cut my hair.

[02:35:12] including Sikhism and state standards is a great first step to reduce bullying and a lack of awareness about my community. This would help in ensuring Sikh students are safe by making both educators and students aware about Sikhism and its practices. What we learn in school is what will shape our perspective in the future. I want to ensure that future generations of Sikhs do not see and experience the bullying and hate we have seen and that all students feel safe and feel like like they belong in the classroom.

[02:35:43] I hope Virginia will join 14 other states and including Sikhism and their social studies standards and curriculum frameworks, and that other communities that have experienced hate and violence that have been victims of ignorance are also represented in social studies standards.

[02:36:01] Our voices matter, my voice matters, and we can't afford to go backwards. Thank you and have a good day.

[02:36:18] - My name is Gershman Daliwal and I'm here today to express my perspectives in the Virginia standards for learning. As a Sikh American, I've called Virginia home for more than 12 years. I'm here today speaking as a college student and as a previous student of the Virginia public school system. I go to Virginia Commonwealth University, and I'm a biochem major and a pre-med track.

[02:36:39] Here in Virginia, the Sikh community continues to grow as we have more than seven graduars, which are our houses of worship. I'm here today because I care about Virginia, and I care about what our students learn. This care directly relates to the philosophy of Sikhism. Sikhs are called upon to live a life of integrity and advocate for the betterment of all.

[02:36:58] Unfortunately, my classmates never had an opportunity to learn about Sikhism in our social studies classes, as fifth-largest world religion was always excluded. So, while we're encouraged that the most recent draft include Sikhism in the World History and Geography Standards, we are deeply concerned with the possible delays and lack of transparency with both development of and timeline for the curriculum frameworks.

[02:37:23] I urge Virginia to stay on this path join 14 other states that have included Sikhism in their social studies standards as this is a critical opportunity to teach students of Virginia about the Sikh community. In doing so, it prepares students to encounter diversity and religious minorities like ours will no longer experience rates of bullying at twice the national average due to our identity. As a resident of Virginia, I've also heard from many community members who are unhappy with the lack of transparency with the review process thus far. Outside actors stepping into the review process at this late stage and rewriting standards significantly is not the way to build trust and faith.

[02:38:01] Many marginalized communities are concerned and their voices must be heard. Sufficient feedback was already provided by Virginia's educators, historians, community members and parents. There was no reason to delay this process and we urge you to hold a timeline that has now been proposed.

[02:38:17] Alongside my statement, please also take into consideration the concerns of groups that represent our diverse communities who are concerned with how they are represented in social studies standards and how they may or may not be representing the curriculum frameworks thank you for your time and consideration today thank you uh simran singh and grace chahal hello my name is simran i use she her pronouns and i'm currently a student at virginia commonwealth

[02:38:52] university i'm a psych major on the pre-med track and i'm a graduate from the fcps school system i'm here today to talk about being a sick and why it's important for the virginia social studies standards to include teaching about Sikhism. Religion has always been of great interest to me, and it used to be the unit I looked forward to the most in the social studies classes in my schooling in elementary and middle school. That is, until I realized a disturbing pattern, that Christianity would take up a full lesson. The next lesson, they would squeeze together Judaism and Islam, and the last one, they would just squish together all of the Eastern

[02:39:27] religions. Despite being the fifth largest religion in the world, Sikhism is often excluded from classrooms when students learn about world religions. The only time I've ever heard Sikhism talked about in a classroom, they got the name of our founder wrong. They got the language our scripture is written in wrong, and they mistranslated two major pillars of our religion.

[02:39:53] Excluding Sikhism from social studies classroom leads to ignorance, misunderstandings, and far too often bullying of Sikh students. Time and time again, we see Sikh students feeling isolated, marginalized, and bullied because of their faith in our very visible identity.

[02:40:08] It is frustrating and entirely preventable, and you have the opportunity to reduce these instances of bullying. You can join the 14 other states, which include Sikhism and social studies standards, and you will be contributing to the safety of Sikh students. The National Council for the Social Studies argues that the aim of social studies is the promotion of civic competence, the knowledge, intellectual processes, and the democratic dispositions required of students to be active and engaged participants in public life.

[02:40:40] Our students cannot be active and engaged participants in public life without learning about the diverse communities of America and the world. The draft released last week fails to properly tell the stories of these diverse communities, and we cannot have faith that the unreleased curriculum frameworks will achieve this either.

[02:40:58] I urge you to listen to the concerns of Virginians who are alarmed with the most recent draft and are dismayed with the continued delays and lack of transparency with the curriculum frameworks. Ampletime is needed for community members and experts to weigh in on the curriculum frameworks, and that cannot be done when they're separated completely from the standards.

[02:41:20] Thank you for this opportunity and your consideration. - Thank you. Grace Chihau and Ting Yi. Sorry, I'm not even gonna try to pronounce this, and I apologize for that, go ahead.

[02:41:38] - Hello, my name is Grace G. Chahal, and I currently attend the University of Richmond. Prior to attending UR, I was a student at the Colorado Public School System. Here in Richmond, I found a community at the Sikhs in Midlothian. Sikhs have contributed to the history and composition of the United States for more than 125 years, and I'm here to discuss why the inclusion of Sikhism in the state standards is crucial.

[02:42:02] Having attended public schools, I never had the opportunity to see my community my faith represented in social studies classrooms alongside other major world religions. Sikhs believe in the concept of one God. For Sikhs, everyone is deemed as being equal in the eyes of God, regardless of gender, ethnicity, race, or identity. At its core, Sikhism calls on adherence to live honestly, share resources with others, and meditate. As members of the large and ever-growing Sikh community in Virginia, we are often recognized by our visible identity and our articles of faith.

[02:42:32] Many Sikhs can be distinguished by their turbans, as speakers before me have discussed. The visible identity coupled with lack of education on Sikhism fosters an environment in which Sikh children are often susceptible to bullying. Sikh Americans are also impacted by the sentiments of xenophobic and Islamophobic nature, which have impacted South Asians in a post-9/11 America for far too often.

[02:42:55] While Sikhism is included in the draft released last week, I urge the Board of Education to ensure Sikhism is included in unreleased curriculum frameworks. Inclusion doesn't just mean being included in a list, it means meaningfully teaching students about communities, and that cannot be done without the mention of Sikhism in just one standard.

[02:43:14] Along with urging you to keep Sikhism included in future drafts, I would like to express my concerns with the sudden involvement of external parties, resulting in a brand new standards draft. We

are lucky to have amazing educators, historians, and experts here in our own backyard who just spoke to you earlier.

[02:43:30] And those experts and educators have already spoken and provided their best feedback. Ample opportunity has been given to organizations and experts to provide feedback alongside other members of the Commonwealth in months prior. Additionally, I find it unacceptable that there is a lack of transparency in when the curriculum frameworks will be available to the public.

[02:43:50] We deserve to be notified of when curriculum frameworks will be released, how they are being developed, and who is involved in the process. Once again, I thank you for this opportunity and consideration, and I urge you to listen to the concerns of groups such as the SIG Coalition and others who are calling on you to ensure the standards and curriculum frameworks are inclusive of our diverse communities.

[02:44:10] Thank you. All right. It draws Tingyi Uy. Good morning, Superintendent Bailo and members of the board. My name is Tingyi Uy, and I'm the Education Director of the 1882 Foundation.

[02:44:29] The foundation was created a dozen years ago to seek an apology from the United States Congress for the 1882 Chinese Exclusion Act, which barred entry of Chinese and later all Asians to the country for 60 years and denied those already here the right to become citizens.

[02:44:45] In 2011 and 12, the United States House and Senate expressed regret for those acts and their legacy. The Senate resolution says in part that it acknowledges that this framework of anti-Chinese legislation with the basic founding principles are incompatible, has recognized in the Declaration of Independence that all persons are created equal, and it is also incompatible with the spirit of the United States Constitution.

[02:45:09] The new draft of the SOL has no mention of this, only an anodyne reference that says students will explain "the contributions of new immigrants and evaluating the challenges they face, including anti-immigration legislation." The August revision did include it with considerable context.

[02:45:28] I believe I speak from important perspectives here. I have a mixed race background. My father's overseas Chinese from the Dutch East Indies. My mother was Dutch. I'm a Virginian of almost 50 years. I began teaching history in 1975 in Fauquier County.

[02:45:44] Later I taught in Fairfax and became a high school administrator and finished my career as an administrator in Loudoun County. I now live in Petersburg. I was honored to be a part of this standards review process as a result of our work with VDOE, the School of Visions, Virginia Humanities, the Library of Virginia, the Virginia Museum of History and Culture, to help create a more inclusive curriculum.

[02:46:05] One glaring difference in the philosophy between the original draft and the new one can be seen here. In the original, it says a locally developed curriculum should include a variety of instructional materials and be reflective not only of the local community, but also the diversity of the Commonwealth, the nation, and the world.

[02:46:22] Teachers are encouraged to go beyond the standards and select instructional strategies and assessment methods appropriate for their students. The new guiding principles to this revision now says the standards and state-developed curriculum frameworks, which we do not have, will serve as guides.

[02:46:39] The curriculum selected by a local school board should provide a level of consistency and comprehension so that, quote, teacher-created curriculum is unnecessary. The reinstitution of the discarded curriculum framework will likely, again, become a prescriptive document that eliminates opportunities for school divisions and teachers to tailor content and skills for their students.

[02:47:01] Lastly, I'm angry that the new draft fails to honor the work of so many over the past two years. Also concerning is the tone of the principles underlying the latest draft. The original draft cited several highly respected institutions guiding its work, such as Educating for American Democracy, the National Council for Social Studies.

[02:47:19] It also referenced Virginia's legislatively mandated studies that produced the profile of a Virginia graduate and Virginia's five C's, which this board is committed to follow. The newly revised standards lack such basis references for supporting its principles i urge you to adopt the original draft thank you very much

[02:47:38] oh thank you sarah on followed by elise sow hey guys hi my name is sarah on and i'm a foreign former virginia k-12 and public college student i was born and raised in virginia went through the entire school system i'm here because superintendent balo you need to move forward with the virginia history curriculum revisions process using the original revised version

[02:48:16] presented to the board on august 17 2022 the one that virginia-based experts historians committee groups and teachers worked on this new draft that you sprung on the public has been rewritten by people who aren't even from here for example hillsdale college which you pointed out by name at one of the previous meetings which i thought was especially weird because they'll still a college is notorious for spreading covet disinformation and also for having ties to right-wing dark money groups known to attack public health measures so you want us to

[02:48:50] trust trust them to influence our children's education i thought it was highly political sneaky and i want you to know that virginians are watching this process and superintendent baylow as you yourself are new to virginia i believe i would hope that you would want to listen to virginia voices in this process and speaking of virginia voices people already mentioned that the new draft removed most of the educational recommendations made by the virginia commission on african-american history education i thought it was worth mentioning that maybe you if you didn't disregard their edits maybe if you listen to the input of the committee groups that

[02:49:26] were formed the ingest the indigenous people of america wouldn't be referred to as immigrants in this new draft this process was supposed to be transparent and democratic but unfortunately it's been the complete opposite it's been politicized it's been subverted and um superintendent balo you have disregarded the integrity of virginia's public processes by blatantly throwing away the peer-reviewed work of hundreds of qualified professionals and the input of thousands of virginians so i please beg you to reject the new standards that were designed by

[02:50:00] outside actors with political agendas and proceed with the original draft presented to you on August 17, 2022. Thanks. Good morning. Good morning. Good morning, members of the board. I'm here today as a graduate of the Virginia Public School System. I grew up feeling invisible. As an Asian American woman, many will always see me as an outsider, despite the fact that I was born only a little ways away from Washington, D.C. I struggled to feel like I belonged. When I saw people on television

[02:50:39] or in books, or even crucially, classrooms, I felt alienated and excluded. This is especially when people wouldn't put in the effort to say my name or others, with all too common, I'm not even going to try to pronounce that one. So when I saw the initial draft of the New Virginia SOL standards, I was thrilled to see recognition of the Asian immigrants who built the railways or the Chinese Exclusion Act, which my great, great, great, however many great grandparents would have had to grapple with. Of course, I thought we could do better, but it's a start, right? Then I saw the draft released last Friday. Quite frankly, Superintendent, it's an embarrassment. I don't

[02:51:16] know why anyone would want to cut stories that have already been underrepresented from the beginning, but I know I'm tired of hearing a narrative that predominantly celebrates white greatness to the point of admitting others. Actually, I have a pretty good guess as to why. We're more than just Japanese internment camps or a brief mention of the 442nd Regiment.

[02:51:34] We deserve more than a footnote in history books. I urge the members of the board to vote and move towards the original version of the history SOLs for the first review. So yeah, I'm here today for my little siblings who are or will be in your school system. I'm here because I believe we can do better. Tell our story. It's important. Thank you for your time. Thank you. Brianna Diaz followed

[02:52:03] by Carl Carter. Thank you. Hi guys. My name is Arrington Evans. I'm an undergraduate student from Virginia Commonwealth University and I have come to speak today on behalf of the NAACP VCU chapter.

[02:52:26] I've also come to speak as a black student who grew up in the Virginia education system from kindergarten to 12th grade I come today to speak to the past the present and the future of Virginia K through 12 Because I recognize how detrimental the proposed changes will have to my community and others to speak to the past I grew up in northern Virginia and went to schools in Prince William County In kindergarten to 12th grade and to speak to my experience. I had enjoyed my time in grade school overall I made friends, did sports, and enjoyed learning.

[02:53:00] I grew up loving history and learning about the past, and more specifically, catered to my community's past. History has always been my favorite subject because growing up, history inspired me. The Virginia education system has given me so many opportunities, such as taking college credit classes, to enroll in AP, and committing to academic programs like Virginia Girls State and Intensive Law and Trial at Stanford University.

[02:53:26] but as great as the Virginia education system has been for me, it could be better. To speak to the present, there's not enough Black history being taught in K-12 Virginia, which is why there was an attempt to progress and expand the standard of Virginia K-12 education. In 2022, why wouldn't we want to expand education and teach history to be more inclusive and understanding of all communities in the Commonwealth of Virginia? In 2022, who is comfortable with these proposed changes entirely in 2022 this isn't about improving the narratives in history this is

[02:54:04] about suppressing people of color's voices in 2022 what is being proposed today is an erasure of history to speak to the future as a member and leader in the naacp organization i want to emphasize the fact this is not just about black issues this is not about just about people of color this is a ratio of history overall for future virginian youth growing up up in Virginia K through 12 education system.

[02:54:30] This erase is not just two years of work put in by countless individuals to create an original draft, but decades and centuries of work and civil rights leaders and other historical figures who have made a change in the world. So future generations can be inspired to progress the world further.

[02:54:48] This rewrite silences the voices of not just people of color, but gives a platform for history to repeat itself in the future. This creates room for entire generations of children to be miseducated in the future. I would like to remind you all in the words of Malcolm X, that education is a passport to the future for tomorrow and belongs to those who prepare for it today.

[02:55:10] Thank you for your time. - Thank you. Carl Carter followed by Carol Bauer.

[02:55:33] - Good morning, President Gecker. - Good morning. - Board members, Superintendent Bailo. My name is Carol Bauer. I'm a proud elementary school teacher, a nationally board certified teacher, and also the vice president of Virginia Education Association. On behalf of the more than 40,000 members of the VEA, I respectfully urge the members of this board to move forward with the review of the original version of the history standards as presented to the board on August 17th, rather than the most recently revised version.

[02:56:01] The draft history standards released on Friday represent the worst kind of politically motivated meddling with academic instruction. The standards are full of overt political bias, outdated language to describe enslaved people and the American Indians, highly subjective framing of the American moralism and conservative ideals, as well as coded racist overtures throughout.

[02:56:22] Equally damning is what has been specifically excluded. In particular, the removal of LGBTQ+ histories and the removal of historical figures are examples of the carelessness and bias with which these standards were created. In addition to the content problems, there are requirements for teachers to present histories of discrimination and racism as balanced.

[02:56:45] I wanna say that again. Discrimination and racism as balanced. to teach it without personal or political bias, and restrictions on the allowance of teacher-created curriculum. Teacher-created curriculum, which is allowed in all other subject areas.

[02:57:00] Teachers need the freedom to teach in a way that works in their individual classrooms with their individual students, and adherence to a strict script benefits no one but the bureaucrats and the politicians. As you've heard throughout this morning, the history standards presented earlier this summer were carefully and professionally created.

[02:57:18] What I want you to hear and what I want you to think about is that the sequencing by theme by the higher level of rigor for making connections the overall pedagogy were all designed in a thoughtful manner that promoted promotes rich discussions and critical thinking the quality of these two sets of standards and the process by which they were created could not be more different these new history standards do not reflect the commitment to academic rigor that have helped make virginia's public schools so successful nor do they reflect the values of virginians in fact there have been no comments today asking you to support these new

[02:57:53] standards the vea calls on this board to honor their commitment to the children of our commonwealth and to choose the standards that are written to help our children succeed not the standards written to help politicians succeed the virginia education association stands ready to assist the board in moving forward on accurate and appropriate set of standards in whichever way they can thank

[02:58:13] you so much okay uh colin apshire monica hutchinson hello good morning my name is colin apshire and i'm a chinese studies in asian pacific islander american studies double major at the college of william mary in my third year i come speaking with the hamkey center on my grievances with the virginia history slox curriculum as a resident of virginia from birth i have been a part of the

[02:58:50] system since before i can remember in high school i was a part of the commonwealth virginia commonwealth governor school virginia i expected to be enriched in brother terms of every subject and history is no exception however i was not enriched i was instead fit a large larger serving size of what 2018 to 2019 virginia thought u.s history looked like white hegemony i was not informed of the truth quota acts exclusion riots hate crimes coolie slave trades independence only for the case to reject citizenship asian american figures pacific islander representation and and independence, Asian American leadership,

[02:59:29] the myth of the model minority, secret wars, Vincent Chen, Afang Moi, Moro Bay, Begat Singh Zend, stop API hate. I could go on for hours for what is missing. But the thing is, is that I had to go to higher education to find out the truth of American history.

[02:59:49] Only 63.8% of Virginia high school students go on to higher education. That leaves more than the third clueless of the people that actually built America. Furthermore, the proposal that is on the table at present runs counter to pedagogical research, fact-based epistemology, and peer-reviewed work.

[03:00:06] As an ally to the APIA community and scholar in this field of research, it is necessary to call out the blatant incorrectness that the superintendent is praising to be a significant improvement. The original 402-page draft encompasses correct standards of learning for an America that is developing into a nation that represents everyone's values, identities, and histories.

[03:00:25] Whereas the most newly proposed 53-page draft discounts Native American identity, downplays the roles of many marginalized communities, and on a whole, erases the actual history of Virginia in the context of slavery and on the founding principles of this country. Last semester, I read a quote from a book that said, "China was not in the Bible," and the same may be said for the newly proposed SOL curriculum.

[03:00:49] It is with all of this in mind that updating the history of SOL is key for the future of Virginia's psyche to understand that to be American is not on the basis of skin color, which is what is implicitly seen in the standards put forward by the superintendent in Youngin. Native American history is American history, not first migrant history.

[03:01:05] Asian American history is American history. Pacific Islander history is American history. African American history is American history. These communities are the builders of the past in America and are America's future and need to be represented in the classroom. I urge the members of the Board of Education to vote and move forward with the original August version of the history as well as first review.

[03:01:26] Thank you. - Thank you. Monica Hutchinson followed by Christine Truck.

[03:01:42] - So my name is Monica Hutchinson. I am the first vice president for Henrico County NAACP, and I am here to ask the board to reject this new revisionist whitewash version of the proposed standards and adopt the original standards presented that was inclusive, diverse, and while not perfect, was a much more accurate and complete standard.

[03:02:00] Teaching a true and inclusive history is a must. As the mother of three black children, do I not matter? Does my black children not matter? These new proposed standards are disrespectful and harmful to many families that look like mine. The erasure of Black Americans in these new proposed changes is disrespectful and harmful.

[03:02:19] Teaching history in a truthful way doesn't make our children victims, but shows them how far we have come, but also how far we have to go. Black history is American history. Ever since our ancestors were first forced to these shores, our Black ancestors have helped build our country every step of the way.

[03:02:38] Many speak of patriotism, but what is more patriotic than loving your country even when your country hasn't always loved you back? These new standards revert back to teaching history from a very white-centered point of view, full of white savior complex. Where is Harriet Tubman, Frederick Douglass, Dr. King, and others?

[03:02:55] Juneteenth was taken out of these new whitewashed standards, but has since been hastily added back since the backlash started. But will the teaching of Juneteenth address the fact the Emancipation Proclamation stated for the first time that black men could enlist in the US military and that 200,000 black men did enlist overwhelmingly the union or that when general granger made it to galveston texas he had with him 2 000 union soldiers many of whom were black union soldiers the fact that black union soldiers were the ones to tell enslaved black people they were finally free is powerful and empowering for black americans freedom is and always has been complicated well our children learn the truth about the 13th

[03:03:34] amendment the fact the words abolish slavery are not in the constitution or how about the slavery loophole that allows slavery for those convicted of a crime this past election cycle five states has slavery on the ballot to once and for all close the slavery loophole in the 13th amendment alabama louisiana tennessee oregon and vermont sadly louisiana but actually voted it down our children deserve to see themselves reflected truthfully and accurately in the pages of the history books when discussing topics such as slavery the civil war reconstruction jim crow the civil rights movement and more we must allow the space for critical thinking to ensure the the lived experiences of our black ancestors are shared and centered.

[03:04:13] Black history is American history. The fact we have to fight and defend our very existence shows how we have failed past generations and that failure must not continue. We had to have a law passed that says it's okay for our hair to grow out of our head the way it does naturally.

[03:04:29] Our hair has been criminalized. Our skin has been criminalized. Teaching about Madam C.J. Walker may not make sense to you, but it does to me and is a learning opportunity for all. White supremacy must not be allowed to thrive any longer. We must stand together. We must fight back against anti-blackness, racism, white supremacy, white nationalism, anti-Semitism, xenophobia, homophobia, sexism, and all forms of hate.

[03:04:55] I am proud to be a member of the NAACP and first vice president of Henrico NAACP, where our theory of change states, we are committed to a world without racism, where black people enjoy equitable opportunities and thriving communities. Our work is rooted in racial equity, civic engagement, and supportive policies and institutions for all marginalized people.

[03:05:15] While I can only speak to a black lived experience, I proudly stand with the beautifully diverse communities from across Virginia. We stand on the shoulders of giants. We are our ancestors' wildest dreams. We are the threat to the system of white supremacy, and it's time for all of us to dismantle it once and for all.

[03:05:33] Thank you. - I signed up to speak, I was given a number in the 30s, And then I was given the number in the 40s, and now I'm being put in the 70s, all right?

[03:05:57] So I don't know why a member of the state NAACP that was supposed to speak a while ago has been put back so much. Thank you. Christine Trocht, please. Good morning. Good morning.

[03:06:13] My name is Chris Trocht, and I'm here to speak as a parent, a grandparent, and a public school educator of 28 years. Currently, as a division leader in social studies education, I understand the process that it takes to revise standards in this great commonwealth and i want to speak primarily to that process the work of revision values the contribution of hundreds of stakeholders and thousands of public comments it is done in an open and transparent manner it is done over months of

[03:06:49] tireless efforts that process culminated in a set of standards of which to be proud and was to be presented in august this year delays were requested for various reasons and at the 11th hour on november 11th only days before today's meeting the new draft came out and clearly did not respect or represent the individual individuals of diverse groups across the commonwealth who worked through

[03:07:24] this process the august august document included expertise from highly respected and qualified individuals starting with christonya brown and her ddoe team it included teachers historians museum partners university and college professors community members parents who dedicated time and

[03:07:54] energy to this work their time and expertise has been dismissed this is a dangerous precedent to set who decided that virginia code can establish a process and stakeholders who work through and maintain integrity to that process ultimately cannot present the work of that process meanwhile a new and unknown committee in a matter of a short time can usurp the process and present

[03:08:29] their version this suggests an utter lack of honor and ethics there are additional questions how did you allow the attention to the details of student readiness and appropriately leveled content in the august revision become so corrupted in this november 11th draft why were the edits from the african-american history commission mostly missing from or when present very generalized

[03:09:02] in this new set of standards shared on november 11. the process was completely set aside for this new draft which have omissions inconsistencies and inaccuracies in it there are too many to note but you have already heard i know that various news outlets have asked you to comment my hope is that you consider the parents and families and communities who had no part of the process in the development of these recent set of poorly and hastily created standards i hope you consider

[03:09:40] the many groups who were again marginalized by distortion minimization or elimination of their voice you may have noticed many of these groups organized outside today in protest in these recently proposed standards i urged the board to return to the standards that were presented in august and prepared with care and centered students and the development of critical thinking skills those august revisions were done through a process that paid attention to the

[03:10:19] developmental appropriateness of the students that focused on skills imperative to a healthy citizenry and that encourage students to engage in question and understand the vast history that shapes us and how they have a role to play in shaping the future thank you thank you uh tiffany

[03:10:46] lewis followed by jonathan lewis to the board good morning and thank you for this opportunity to speak i am here in support of the original proposed revised drafts of the virginia social studies standards not the current revised redraft i stand before you as the descendant of virginians who survived enslavement in this country and who rose above its confines to invent to construct to

[03:11:26] create to read to write to speak to preach and to educate i stand before you as the great granddaughter of a woman who in the 1960s worked the voting polls and welcomed black voters to the registration tables to exercise their rights. I stand before you as the granddaughter of a man who in the 1960s as a college student at Virginia State University participated in sit-ins at Woolworth's lunch counter and who stood flat-footed and recited the preamble to the constitution of these United States of America as he had to prove his natural born citizenship before exercising his right to

[03:12:00] vote as a young man in his not in his 20s. I stand before you as the granddaughter of a war veteran who in the 1960s left his wife and six children to defend this country in the Vietnam conflict. I stand before you as the great niece of a black female schoolteacher who in the 1960s found herself in the front of a classroom of white and black students at a newly integrated elementary school who conversed with white and black parents and worked in a school of predominantly white teachers where she had to face question, discrimination, and projected doubt on a daily basis.

[03:12:33] i stand before you as the daughter of a man who in the 1960s integrated his elementary school and was one of the only black children in his fifth grade class this is virginia history virginia history is american history when you see me you see them when you hear my voice you hear theirs i stand before you in 2022 as an educator who has had the honor of teaching students of various races ethnicities religion sexual orientation socioeconomic statuses and abilities i have designed and delivered lessons that connect students lived experiences with the unfamiliar content with which they are expected to demonstrate knowledge i have seen students productively

[03:13:12] struggle and grapple with information and i have seen students engage in dialogue healthy dialogue compose written responses and articulate connections between historical figures events and contributions of people who in fact look like them and they themselves in an effort to to elevate curriculum and comprehension.

[03:13:29] I stand before you today as a wife and mother of three who cannot allow my children and their peers the unfortunate mistake of not learning the full history that their parents, grandparents, great-grandparents and great-great-grandparents, many of whom are still alive and well today, sacrificed for them to reap the benefit.

[03:13:47] I contributed to the public commentary of the original edits and it is offensive to know that the time and effort that other citizens, including myself, provided, are being discarded. The social studies standards are just that. They're the study of society, of all of society.

[03:14:03] It is insensitive and unacceptable to attempt to extract standard information about history and diverse historical figures from the curriculum in a society of taxpaying citizens of diverse races,

ethnicities, religion, sexual orientations, income levels, and abilities. A society that contributes so much for so many.

[03:14:21] I owe it to my ancestors and to my descendants alike, to stand in this moment and to speak our truth. In the vein of Langston Hughes' iconic poem, "I Too Sing America," I say to you today, I too am a parent, and it has become apparent, no pun intended, that perhaps the only parents' voices that actually are heard are those who share likeness with certain historical figures that have been identified as significant in the redraft edits.

[03:14:46] I compel you too to sing America, all of America. Thank you for your time. I would like to also go on record with stating that Jonathan Lewis is my son who's in fourth grade. He is in school at this time, so he was unable to speak.

[03:15:02] Thank you. - Thank you. Courtney Nguyen, followed by Ann Tatis.

[03:15:17] - Good morning, President Gecker, members of the board, and Superintendent Balo. My name is Courtney Nguyen, and I'm a state government relations professional here in Richmond, Virginia. But today, I come to you as an enrolled citizen of the Chickahominy Indian Tribe of Charles City County, Virginia, and as a proud product of Virginia's K through 12 public school system.

[03:15:35] I come to you to ask you to reject, with prejudice, the recent proposed curricula standard changes in Virginia's K-12 history and social science curricula. The proposed kindergarten history and social science standards being considered for first review today egregiously mislabeled Native Americans as first immigrants, asserting that Native Americans immigrated from Asia.

[03:15:58] This is a harmful misrepresentation and revision that will contribute to a further erasure of the existence of not only Virginia's indigenous peoples, but indigenous peoples on the North American continent at large. Indigenous people are linguistically considered the earliest known inhabitants of a particular place.

[03:16:17] Modern day indigenous peoples, such as myself, are descended directly from those ancient people. Indigenous is a specific term that differentiates Indigenous people from the settlers who came here to colonize the land, enslaved peoples brought here by force, and immigrants who come later to an already established nation.

[03:16:35] Indigenous people have resided on the American continent, a land that Indigenous North Americans have traditionally called Turtle Island, for somewhere between 15,000 to 40,000 years. The exact number is actually not known. to categorize these peoples as first immigrants effectively conjoining them with another group entirely erases the ancient ties they have to this land the sovereign nations they have built and the continuous stewardship they have shown to this continent through time immemorial to categorize them as such as shameful but to do so during native american heritage month

[03:17:12] um time in which we celebrate a time in which we celebrate and learn more about indigenous cultures around the United States is deeply offensive and disrespectful. In the guiding principles slide deck prepared for today's review of these standards, VDOE describes immigrants as people from around the world who have come to our shores seeking freedom and opportunity to build a better life, contribute to our communities, and add to the rich history of achievement in our country.

[03:17:42] While this is indeed a noble definition, simply put, Native Americans and Indigenous people are not this. Indigenous peoples have already inhabited, thrived, governed, lived, and died on this land long before the Commonwealth of Virginia or the United States of America was even a thought. To implement this language would directly violate the improvement benchmark outlined on slide nine that seeks to implement presentation of content in an unbiased and dispassionate language. This language is not unbiased or dispassionate. In fact, it is weaponized.

[03:18:17] to implement a revisionist historical narrative. In addition, while this Department of Education seeks to promote consistency in the content taught at each grade level across the Commonwealth, inserting falsehoods into our history and social science standards would move Virginia farther away from the established history taught around the country and around the world.

[03:18:40] This does not help make Virginia the best place in the country to get an education. It actually moves us further away from that goal. As such, in the future, I urge the Board of Education to firmly reject these proposed standards, but to correct this misstep, I would encourage the Department of Education and the Yunkin administration to create an ongoing dialogue and forge direct relationships with Virginia's tribal leaderships so that such an egregious historical misrepresentation never again makes it to the page of an official state document.

[03:19:12] Thank you, and happy Native American Heritage Month. The status will be followed by Joseph Douglas you can go ahead and pause that because I'm going to take more than two minutes My name is Ann Tatis. I'm the co-founder of Virginians for Children's first and I am a Half German quarter Dutch Jew quarter Iroquois Indian. So what does that make me?

[03:19:44] It makes me an American and a Virginian is what it makes me okay I'm standing up here and I'm listening to hours of people talk about Something that they don't even know about. The framework for the August is literally should be called Socialism 101.

[03:20:01] Everybody missed the mark. C3 framework for college career and civic life for social standards is what they use for that. This is an improvement. This is removing us and taking us further away.

[03:20:16] You may not like it, but go back and read it. Everything is about global citizenship, okay? And the word pedagogy, read Paulo Ferreri, pedagogies of the oppressed before you start reusing the word pedagogy, competency-based education, inquiry learning, critical thinking, top-down learning, teaching critical thinking in kindergarten, and then teaching the facts at the bottom is the reason why, and I am ashamed of everybody who came up here and raged at the history standards and nobody mentioned that yet again Virginia is the last in the nation in reading

[03:20:54] and in math especially for the historically marginalized that you all come up here as saying that you represent and speak for not one single person brought up the fact that we are 50th again in the nation our children cannot read our children cannot write and our children do not know how to do math. And yet everybody up here that's so enraged is so proud of where they came from. Not one of you mentioned those children. That's embarrassing. And I am proud that I am

[03:21:29] not a party, a member of either political party. I would rather be on the moon than be a part of this bipartisan swamp. So let's talk real quick. What I came here to talk to you about is this unesco mahatma gandhi institute look it up okay the un goals for 2030 social emotional learning let's talk about

that it is literally education not experimentation it is literally a social experiment on our children that we have allowed forever there's no proof that it works yet it is

[03:22:06] embedded in every single curriculum let's talk about oh more miss balo's like this because Institute, Panorama, you know what I'm talking about. But the UNESCO, Mahatma Gandhi Institute, it literally says SEL for SDGs, dissonance and SDGs. Why do we need SEL according to UNESCO?

[03:22:31] Because of dissonance. Since dissonance is an unpleasant emotive state, subjects of dissonance require emotion regulation capabilities to navigate the behaviors and prerequisite antecedent attain to attain the sdgs the article builds a case for how the united nations sustainable development goals can be achieved through social emotional learning do any of you understand what globalism is our governor does certainly you recently put out because i get the teacher direct

[03:23:04] top 10 skills identified by the world economic forum for our children to learn there's no math there's no reading none of that is required according to the world economic forum for our children to learn because who's deciding what our children learn chamber of commerce the people who need cogs in a machine no matter what color your skin no matter where you come from to fulfill what the virginia economy as i said two months ago out of amy gadara's mouth needs to fulfill for their

[03:23:41] workforce education that is not the role of children and i'm so tired of coming up here telling all of you how you are failing every single 1.3 million children in this state. Joseph Douglas followed by Jeff Cartwright. Originally I was going to say good morning, but good afternoon, President Gecker, members of the board, Superintendent Ballow.

[03:24:09] I'm Joe Douglas, and I'm speaking on behalf of Virginia ASCD. You probably know it as VASCD. And I want to talk today about our opposition to the proposed social studies standards of learning. I had prepared remarks, but I don't want to go through and reiterate all of the eloquent remarks that were said today in opposition to the standards.

[03:24:30] VASED stands in support of all the opposition to the proposed revisions to the social studies standards of learning. But I do want to jump down into some of my prepared remarks and just say that VASED believes the content and timeline considerations that accompany the current revision will be detrimental to our schools.

[03:24:51] In fact, the American Historical Association, who's been mentioned many times here today, and if you don't know about AHA, it is the most prestigious historical association, not just in the United States, but in the world. And they took time out of their busy schedule and wrote letters to this body.

[03:25:12] And what they said to this body in quote, "If you throw out the draft standards considered in August or substantially revise them, you risk doing significant harm to students your state i know this body does not want to take the risk of harming our students in any way and in that same letter they go on to say the initial document is good work and the state should be proud of it and again this is the american historical association who does not have a direct affiliation with the commonwealth of virginia i really encourage this body to take those documents

[03:25:49] and those letters and really read them and take them to heart this is the cream of the crop in the world and leading historical thinking and skills. VASED is confident that you take your role in setting and revising standards very seriously and we strongly recommend the board reject the updated revision

and return of those submitted to you in August. On behalf of VASED, I thank you for your time and consideration. Thank you. Jeff Cartwright followed by

[03:26:23] Arrington Evans. I'm sorry, Jeff Cartwright followed by Arrington Evans okay so um my name is Isabella de Fulvio and I'm an Asian and Pacific Islander American Studies major at William & Mary and I also grew up in

[03:27:03] Lowen County and went through the Virginia public school system and as a student in the Virginia public school system I never saw myself represented at all I didn't learn Asian American history I never read a book centered on the Asian American experience and never had discussions on race and diversity and this left me feeling really confused about my identity as I didn't have a of a place in the classroom.

[03:27:22] And this was especially concerning, considering my high school, Rockridge High School in Loudoun County has a 40% Asian American students. So now as an ethnic studies major, I'm very passionate about diversity and providing students with the histories and perspectives of all marginalized communities. And it wasn't until college where I learned about history of the people that looked like me, where I learned about the hardships of the first Chinese immigrants who came here and built the railroads, the murder of Vincent Chin, the US is forceful over the kingdom of Hawaii, community leaders, third world liberation front, immigration acts, and students shouldn't have to attend higher education to see themselves represented in the public education system.

[03:27:59] This should be standard. The new Virginia SOL standards drafted by Superintendent Baylow are unacceptable. And it's clear that whoever drafted it completely disregarded the expertise and times of qualified educators in Virginia. Baylow's version removed the original emphasis on diversity and placed it with making students learn patriotic songs as an education standard.

[03:28:20] The version reads like a poorly researched facts sheet and it's largely Eurocentric, erases LGBTQ history and does not mention people of color and people of leaders in this country. We need to improve education for our children and not regress backwards to outdated and factually incorrect material.

[03:28:38] I would also like to note that most people here do not support the Youngkin standards and the Board of Education should reject the Youngkin standards and proceed with the original draft was developed by qualified educators and presented on august 17th um thank you thank you kathleen levitt uh followed by aaron winston are either of them here kathleen levitt aaron winston

[03:29:14] wingapo i'm dr aaron winston i'm indigenous to this land wingapo means hello in our very indigenous language welcome to senacomaca this is what we called our home right here where this building is for centuries. Senna Comica, not Richmond, not the James River, the Powhatan River.

[03:29:44] This is our home. We're not immigrants. Let's face it, immigrants got to come from somewhere, right? Nobody's trying to say the English didn't come from England or the Chinese didn't come from China. Why are you telling us that now we come from somewhere else? Guess what? I'm here. I'm a native american from the pamunkey tribe you know the same tribe that's been coming to our governor for the last hundreds of years to offer and present a tribute and now i'm an immigrant in my

[03:30:21] own land i'm not an immigrant not yet i'm still here i'm still here how are you going to get out calling me an immigrant i am also a scientist a scientist this draft is not science it's not factual if you follow

the science as long as there's been homo sapiens sapiens homo sapiens sapiens that means human beings like us right as long as there's been homo sapiens sapiens walking

[03:30:55] upright making tools and living in civilizations we have been here not anywhere else did you talk to xi xi ping and say oh we're a part of his group now is that what you're trying to tell me have you talked to xi xi ping i'm thinking no i'm absolutely thinking now so i'm also a part of the virginia tribal educational consortium wow what a neat opportunity to get

[03:31:29] educators in virginia to can actually consider me and my family and my tribe also i'm a father of four school-aged children. When I told my oldest nine-year-old daughter this morning what I'm about to do today, she said, well, Daddy, how do you mean we're immigrants? All anybody has to do is read a book. Are you going to take all the books out of the libraries now? Are you going to shut down Google? I mean, this is absurd. If you want our children to have the best education, this most

[03:32:05] recent draft of the sols sets us back tremendously we will be the laughing stock of the world oh oh my goodness they're immigrants now you know the rest of the world be like oh my gosh what are they doing don't don't do this guys i mean my goodness i don't know what this contingency you've led out to the native community because i haven't seen a superintendent i haven't i haven't seen you in my tribal lands you might want to fix that thank you and win goppo learn that word it's the

[03:32:43] indigenous word of this land and you are now in senecomica senecomica okay isabella de fulvio followed by cheryl binkley cheryl binkley is okay uh my name is cheryl binkley good afternoon ladies and gentlemen thank you for the work you do and i'd like to offer a thank you too right now to the

[03:33:22] folks who have been in the back of the room if you would share our gratitude for listening and for helping us get here and transporting us back and forth that your security has done an excellent job today and thank you for helping us get here um my i am a retired teacher and instructor in your community college system and have graded over the course of my career many many papers And I have to tell you, you've heard a lot of reasons today, ideological reasons, for

[03:34:01] not confirming Superintendent Balo's rewrite of our standards. But the one I have to give you is the worst news of all. All of those reasons are valid and important and way more important, but it's going to be very embarrassing to each of you as professional individuals in this country and the state of Virginia, if you vote yes on a paper, on a document, that would get an F in your freshman community college courses.

[03:34:36] This paper, this document is fraught with problems. It is disorganized. It's filled with factual omissions and misrepresentations, typos, and formatting errors. You know what it reminds me of?

[03:34:54] I've seen these papers before, and when I started to read it, I said, I know this paper. It was the kid who kept saying, I'm working on it, Ms. Binkley, I'm working on it. And then the night before it was due, they would go to the Internet and cut and paste a bunch of stuff together, give no citations to it, and hand it in as though it were their own work.

[03:35:16] That's what our current superintendent has done and Ms. Bird Carmichael has done at the consultancy. In 15 days, they've cut and pasted something together to have something to turn in, and it would not pass muster in Virginia colleges or high schools, and we don't want any part

[03:35:39] that thank you hey barb zedler followed by michael carabinos okay uh we'll come back to that robin allman is she coming okay that's fine thank you i can't see around that corner so it's a little

[03:36:14] more challenging i appreciate that good afternoon i'm dr barbara zedler a physician in powhatan virginia and i want to speak today about first principles in the upbringing and care of our virginia's most precious asset our children in virginia by law a parent has a fundamental right to make decisions about the upbringing education and care of their children parents choose how they will be educated the state's role is to make a public education option available and accessible

[03:36:50] to its citizens parents choose how to provide for their bodily needs such as food shelter and health care. The state's role is to make health care available and accessible to its citizens, not to mandate or require any specific treatment, pharmacological products such as vaccinations or drugs. Each individual has a fundamental God-given right of bodily autonomy, my body, my choice,

[03:37:22] and the right to private, voluntary, and informed medical decision-making about what is done to our bodies and the bodies of our minor children. Vaccine mandates and discrimination based on vaccination status should be prohibited even during a time of declared emergency or public health epidemic. So why does Virginia even have an entire chapter of administrative law called Regulations for Immunizations of School Children? This chapter has a schedule of required or mandated

[03:38:01] vaccinations for school children. It includes responsibilities for administration of those mandates, largely through the Department of Education via school admissions officers, and it contains serious penalties for parental noncompliance. The Virginia Department of Health has suddenly undertaken a regulatory review of this entire chapter that began less than three weeks after the CDC approved the COVID-19 vaccination on the schedule of required vaccinations for school children. Parents should be alarmed at the possibility that this is a ruse for adding

[03:38:40] the vaccination or the shot to Virginia's schedule of required vaccinations. This could occur through a change in Virginia law that took effect last year and empowers the Virginia State Board of health with a regulatory pathway to directly change any of the immunization regulations, including the vaccination schedule. I would encourage all concerned parents to visit the Virginia Medical Freedom Alliance website to learn more, including how you can submit

[03:39:16] a public comment expressing your views about this before the public comment opportunity closes on November 28th. Thank you. Thank you. Michael Karabinos, followed by Robin Allman. You know, perhaps with improved social studies standards, we'll get away from the time when everybody says anything they don't like is socialism. I'm Michael Karabinos. I'm a Chesterfield dad. I support medical science, including like George Washington, compulsory inoculation when

[03:39:52] necessary. I support librarians, teachers, the First Amendment, and the rights of all students to be respected. I oppose censorship and the bullying of trans kids. I'm a descendant of an enslaver and my ancestors fought for the Confederacy, the 5th Georgia Cavalry, the 48th Georgia Infantry.

[03:40:13] Some of those battlefields can be seen out these windows. I say this because before you can know where you're going, you have to know where you come from. That is why it's vital to teach a complete and accurate history to our children. Now, others have addressed the content of these phoned-in standards already. Quite frankly, if you're trying to sneak white supremacist indoctrination into education, I think you'd make a little bit more effort at

[03:40:47] sneaking it. So I'll add some numbers. Two years of collaboration for these original standards that we saw in August. A two-week rush drive for what was presented on the 11th. 211 experts across historians, educators, and members of the public versus the work of a private contractor bluebird aligned with

[03:41:24] conservative Fordham Institute 400 pages of detailed guidance versus 53 sloppy pages of vague suggestions poorly edited with the promise of more detail to come I say to the board that if I were in your shoes I'd not only completely reject the submission and returned the August draft I would ask bluebird for a refund for the work it's done. For two years, I listened to manufactured moral panics generated

[03:42:03] by right-wing dark money groups screaming about indoctrination of our children. And I now can see nakedly that all that was set up to enable the actual right-wing indoctrination being attempted here. The arc of history bends towards justice, but it is bent by the back-breaking work and the fire of those who fight against odds to do so and then that once bent, that hot metal is quenched in the blood and the tears of those who have fought. Don't forget the blood and the tears of American

[03:42:39] history. Thank you. Robin Allman followed by Jennifer Pergett. Good morning. My name is Robin Allman and I come before you today as a member of the Virginia Coalition for Human Rights.

[03:42:59] We advocate for Palestinian human rights. Arab Americans are yet another group ignored by these new standards although there are over 150 000 arab americans in virginia alone many who have been here for more than a century dropping the rest of my remarks i will move to our conclusions we support the american historicals association call for the adoption of the draft standards of learning that you considered in your august meeting i ask that you reject these newly proposed standards of learning i urge the board to adopt the previous version of the proposed social

[03:43:35] studies standards that was the very careful work of countless educators and historians over the course of the past two years according to the process detailed in the virginia code thank you very much thank you good afternoon i'm i sent an email to all of you but i'm sure you only get like four a day and so you're all over mine um i'm pretty sure you get a couple hundred um so finding

[03:44:07] finding mine may be difficult right away. I wanted to put on to record the Pfizer documents, and in the email I did send a link for you, and also the DMED data from the Department of Defense, as well as information from the FDA. I have copies for everybody here as well.

[03:44:34] I'm Jennifer. I'm a mother and a grandmother. Is anyone here aware of the Pfizer documents for the covid 19 vaccine i've personally spoken with five doctors and they were unaware the fda tried to have the documents sealed for 75 years until 2096 a texas judge ordered the release and the first set came out on march 1st i've read some of the first 55 000 pages and i'm following the doctors that are going through the documents i'm a strong supporter of informed consent there

[03:45:10] There are nine pages of adverse reactions that were known by February 28, 2021, over a year ago. Within these nine pages, there are approximately 40 autoimmune diseases. Should your immune system be compromised, your body cannot protect itself properly.

[03:45:29] Has anyone here heard about the hepatitis outbreak in children? There are six different types of hepatitis listed in these documents. Not being talked about is shingles. It's also called herpes zoster. I know five people, actually seven now, that have gotten shingles.

[03:45:48] Two of them were in their 20s, and their doctors told them that it was because of stress. But the doctors were not given this information. This normally occurs in people over the age of 50. There are over 50 types of herpes in these nine pages.

[03:46:06] To find these adverse events in the Pfizer documents, go to www.phmpt.org. click on Pfizer documents, put in 5.36 in the search bar for the adverse reactions, go to page 30 to 38. And these are only the side effects known as of February 28, 2021.

[03:46:26] I beg you to look through them with two personal family members that are vaccine injured and one that died. Okay. Sandy Phillips, followed by Sally Johnson.

[03:46:49] I'm Sally Johnson. I'm addressing the board this morning, or this afternoon, as both a mother and a grandmother of children in the York County public school system.

[03:47:11] My youngest is still in high school. My oldest grandson's getting ready to go into kindergarten. So first of all, I want to say that the Virginia Department of Education, their response to the COVID pandemic, which was a huge overreaction to a disease that was not dangerous to children, has failed our children the online school the wearing of masks the degradation of learning and

[03:47:45] the lowering of standards has damaged a generation of children and we can't get that back there are children who learn to speak and read wearing masks and the teachers were wearing masks the peers were wearing masks and now they speak in mumbles because that's what they heard and that's what they learn we can't get that back my daughter had to wear a mask in high school and she had panic attacks and headaches and she got to where she just refused to go to school it was horrendous

[03:48:21] she did not pass her sols but guess what they lowered the standards so she got she's gonna get to graduate anyway so but what i want to talk to you about now because we can't get that back is the COVID shots. And I am asking you to do everything in your power to ensure that the COVID-19 shots are not added to the immunization schedule for Virginia public schools. Children are simply not at risk from dying from COVID. They typically exhibit mild or no symptoms and hospitalizations

[03:48:54] for children are extremely rare. These shots are neither safe nor effective. None of the COVID shots have gone through the extensive testing required for vaccines all of them the mrna and the more traditional novavax showed severe side effects in their brief clinical trials seizures other neural neurological problems blood clots strokes myocarditis pericarditis autoimmune diseases especially in children one in 200 toddlers showed serious side effects in the clinical trials

[03:49:30] children have virtually no risk for covid but now they're dying from the shots and are they effective studies have shown there's a brief minimal protection they provide but that wanes quickly and within four months children who have had the shot are actually at a higher risk for getting covid than if they hadn't had it and their cases tend to be more severe how is that affected i know there is tremendous pressure on you to mandate these shots for everyone. The pharmaceutical companies stand to make literally trillions on these shots with booster after booster paid for

[03:50:07] out of our taxpayer dollars. I beg each of you, put politics aside, follow your conscience. It is not normal for young, healthy people to be having heart attacks or suddenly dropping dead. Don't let our children's blood be on your hands thank you Holly hazard followed by Diane Jones thank you so much for this opportunity to address the board my name is Holly hazard as you mentioned I am the founder and a chair of a nonprofit organization for public education I'm here speaking in opposition to the

[03:50:45] revised proposed standards of learning the perceived hijacking of our children's understanding and competence in history by the proposed new SOS isn't merely about their education although that is critically important of course, but it's also about us, who we aspire to be as a nation and the Commonwealth. No one will win, not those of us who want to take us back to a time when we didn't tell the whole history about Native Americans, about enslaved people, about civil rights leaders, and not those who embrace a reckoning with our past, even if it makes people uncomfortable. No one wins if we toss history into a political pot. I'm old enough to know that wherever we are on the political

[03:51:24] spectrum whomever has quote won the latest election we will shift the other way if our children are then tugged and pulled with one set of quote truths and then another when the other party is in power they will become not educated at all but cynical about the most basic lessons who we are as a people and what lessons we've learned virginia had an intellectually honest set of standards for our children before this current board set out to work by most accounts this body of work has been dismantled in favor of warping and understanding of our past to fit a narrow political agenda. Please don't do this to our children, to our commonwealth and to our

[03:52:04] future. Please adopt the SOLs as they were drafted after years of work by thoughtful professional experts in the area. Please respect the intellectual honesty and provide our children with an honest history of our country and our commonwealth that they deserve and that from which our nation will continue to thrive. Thank you. Thank you. Diane Jones, followed by Frank

[03:52:26] Callahan. Is Diane Jones here? And what about Mr. Callahan? Grace, can you see anybody moving over there? Okay. No. Thank you. All right. That exhausts the list of people who signed up, as is our habit and practice. If there is anybody who has not

[03:53:00] yet spoken who would like to speak, you are welcome to speak now. So let's please, you line up or i know we can do this in an orderly way i did sign up anyway whatever uh got to come up early because i signed up with the crowd downstairs anyway my name is paul teal i'm from mechanicsville virginia lifelong virginia resident i have eight grandchildren which is what concerns me the most what they're going to learn my youngest uh granddaughter getting ready to go

[03:53:39] to kindergarten this past year had a picture taken with her best friend. And her best friend was a little black girl, beautiful girl. So are we going to poison my granddaughter with critical race theory and other teachings? My real reason for speaking here is I know we all remember the great Vince Lombardi, the coach of the Green Bay Packers for years and winning coach. When he first became the coach of the green bay packers he had a meeting with his team and you know what he did

[03:54:14] he took out a football this is elementary guys this is a football this is where we're going to start well this this is our football it's the constitution of the united states you all have the authority to make decisions which you do and i'd like to ask a question of everyone how many times in this constitution is the word democracy mentioned i wonder who all knows that it's zero we are a constitutional republic let's get this out and send it to the kids the next thing i'd like to say is and i've had this discussion with a number of people uh and i only have this to say

[03:54:51] as a result of listening to what i'm hearing from the naacp i played college ball lots of black teammates and friends i have not not one ounce of prejudice in me so don't keep slapping me around because i'm a 70 year old man and a white man that i'm prejudiced the the facts are the first slave owner in America shortly after the time we landed in America within 25 years the first slave owner was a black

individual. His name was Kason. He came here as an indentured servant. He bought a farm after his indenture was over and he started hiring blacks when he had to farm. So

[03:55:28] listen the chiefs in Africa sold their own people into slavery to come here. They made money off that issue so my my last comment is let's if i'm a black person i want to look at the great black people people like uh dr carson people like thomas uh soul people like uh our supreme court uh justice these people look at the positives dr carson had a very disadvantaged childhood his mother made him read books he had to do a book report so anyway you can do you can educate yourself you can pull

[03:56:08] yourself up by your bootstraps. The other thing is how many hundred million people came to this country after the Civil War that had nothing to do with slavery? England, Ireland, Scotland, Spain, all these countries, Italy, Poland, they came here as Americans to wave the flag as did my father. Thank you for your time. Nice to see you all today. My name is Jody Cole. I work for VTAC, Virginia Tribal Education Consortium. I live in King William County. If you all know anything

[03:56:45] about the Native Americans, you know there's three Native tribes in King William, Virginia. You're taking their history away by calling them immigrants. They can prove back to Pocahontas that they were there before the others. Do not take this away from them in their history. One of the chiefs of the tribe told me this story. The reason why the immigrants, the white people, brought African-Americans to these shores here is due to the fact because the white man could not hold the

[03:57:21] Indian as a slave because they knew their native land and they could not hold them because the natives knew how the terrain was. They knew how to get around and how to escape. They went to other countries and bought the African-Americans at the Africans and brought them back here. They did not know the terrain. They did not know the territory. So they were easily enslaved. So do not tell falsehoods of any sort to do with this. And it is embarrassing being in King William. And in our history, we tell these kids they know where they come from. And then you are going to tell them

[03:57:59] that that is a falsehood, that they're an immigrant. That is a slap to the face. And you ought to be ashamed of yourself shame on you that's all i have to say wengapo that's hello for in algonquian language that is our native language here in this area i am deborah ironfish adams

[03:58:33] also citizen of upper matapani indian tribe that is located in king william virginia i also represent vtech here today virginia tribal education consortium i am the secretary of of the executive board of VTEC.

[03:58:51] VTEC is made up of representation of the seven federal recognized tribes here in Virginia, Upper Mattapanai, the Pamunkey, the Rappahannock, the Monacan, the Chickahominy, the Chickahominy Eastern Division, and the Nazman tribes.

[03:59:09] Have you consulted with any of those tribes on the new draft of the SOLs? If not, shame on you, shame on you. you are standing on our land, our land.

[03:59:27] For years, we have been looked over, silenced, and erased from Virginia history. No more, it will not happen, no more. We are here, we're still here, we have always been here, and we will continue to be here for many centuries to come.

[03:59:52] We are the stewards of this land. that is us learn about us do not erase us from the sols i encourage you i encourage you to promote the draft that was written back in august it is a shame that we

even have to be here today to defend

[04:00:18] our history and our culture and our heritage no more thank you for your time thank you for your time today my name is donna richardson craft i live in hanover county i have four children all four of my daughters attended hanover county schools i myself have taught 15 years in hanover

[04:00:55] county schools and special education i am from the pamunkey tribe and king william i never ever was an immigrant to my homelands that my father god creator jesus christ gave to my people i will not stand here today and accept this we are not immigrants i ask that you keep in place the august

[04:01:32] proposal that you do not revise that we need to build upon that and add more history clarity about our people about our virginia tribes here we're educated individuals there's many of us we're doctors. We're lawyers. We're educators. Treat us as such. Come to us. Learn. Learn our heritage.

[04:02:02] Learn our history. We're here to help you. I am also a part of VTech. I go into our schools. I speak to our second attendants. I give them information about our people so that the teachers can educate their students. My oldest daughter, when she was in school, in elementary school, they were

[04:02:34] studying I for Indian. We're indigenous. We're First Nations people. I am not from India. The teacher, my daughter has dirty blonde hair. Her teacher told her, you have to color the hair black. Indians don't have blonde hair. How dare she? We need to get history taught. Virginia natives,

[04:03:10] we don't look like Western natives. We don't all have black hair. Some of us have curly hair. Some Some of us have light blonde hair.

[04:03:25] I ask you to come to us native people here of Virginia, first indigenous people. Ask us our history so that we can teach you.

[04:03:41] I am not an immigrant and you will not sit up here and have my grandchildren to come, to have to sit in Virginia schools where I taught students and my grandchildren have to now listen to that they're an immigrant we will not stand for that wengapo my name is kerry

[04:04:16] will welcome candidate i'm an enrolled citizen of the chickahominy indian tribe i have taught in the virginia school system since 2003 having taught grades two through seven most recently teaching second grade at etrick elementary school in chesterfield county i resigned on november the 7th and i'm now a full-time employee of vtech i'm here in support of the original revised 2022 history and social studies standards of learning.

[04:04:47] I beg you to please accept those. I know that my daughter is one of the ones that worked on that. She holds a master's degree in special education. I would love to see y'all include our history. When I started school in Charles City County, schools were still segregated.

[04:05:06] I'm 61 years old. I started Samaria Indian School. They integrated when I was going to the fifth grade. I had never gone to school with a black kid until then. they integrated most of the white kids in Charles City and teachers left. People need to know our history. My relatives up until 1958-1959 that got a high school diploma was sent to Oklahoma from seventh grade on. They were sent to Oklahoma to get a high school education. The only way they could get one in Virginia was to change their birth ticket to black and go to a black school.

[04:05:42] We fought hard for our identity. Walter Plucker tried a paper genocide on us to eradicate and get rid of us and now it seems if you're doing the same thing and we need that to stop now we are here

we're not going anywhere we've always been here we always will be here i come from a family of chiefs our great grandfather was one of the chiefs of the chickahominy tribe and we're not going to go down without a fight please please listen to us we're still here you have a chance right now to change something in history virginia has the largest

[04:06:18] number of further recognized Indian tribes east of the Mississippi. I'm sure that's not in a history book. The only thing I ever saw in a history book about Virginia Indians was the massacre of 1622 when Opie Cancun, who supposedly massacred white people. But what about the massacres that occurred to my people? I need to know, my children need to know, my grandchildren need to know that we're still here. And like I said, we're not going anywhere. Please go back to the original

[04:06:47] standards listen to us I thank you for your time and hope you all enjoy the rest of your day I do thank the board for this opportunity to speak and I guess I'm the last speaker of the day so I'll try to be brief I'm here to as well to express a disappointment in the in the current draft of the standards and I would also advise the board to reconsider the August framework and standards

[04:07:23] i think uh really what it what that document did was it it it started to show a direction in which uh virginia students were asked how to think not what to think um and i think that's really important and so you got in that document uh some glimpses as to a direction that was very promising and one that uh that was aligned with a commitment to the virginia um profile of a graduate uh and the five C's critical thinking, collaboration, communication and dear to my heart is citizenship.

[04:07:57] And so it's not clear in this document to what extent the board is committed to the profile of Virginia graduate and the five C's. This isn't really, I mean, the social studies standards were sort of an embodiment or an attempt to bring the lofty goals of Virginia down to the curriculum level and specifically into the social studies. But it raises questions for me as to how committed the board is to the profile of Virginia graduate, which I think is your North Star.

[04:08:34] And it's not clear from the content standards that the spirit of the profile of a Virginia graduate are carried down in based on many of the comments that have been presented by everyone who has preceded me today. I seriously question whether that's the case. The August document had conceptual learning, inquiry, principles, themes. It was evidence-based. It referred

[04:09:07] to EAD. It referred to the National Council on the Social Studies, and it was a good document from which to work. In terms of citizenship, it embodied a multiculturalism here. That is evident in Virginia today. My comments to the board earlier was that in addition to diversity and multiculturalism, that we think about it as well in terms of plurality. The plurality is really what makes America great. We don't all think alike. Kids need to deliberate. They need to make decisions together.

[04:09:46] They need to collaborate, yes. But when I read the standards from the early grades, it seems to be all about compliance, about following the rules. It isn't really about using student voice to influence decisions that affect their lives.

[04:10:02] And so I really question whether we're really getting an agency and an engagement through this curriculum. And it's really hard to, it's very hard to evaluate the document that we have without looking at the framework itself.

[04:10:21] And so I would ask the board to reconsider the standards to see the connection between the curriculum framework and this document, as well as the profile of a Virginia graduate before moving

forward.

[04:10:38] And furthermore, to speak about process, and we're talking about democracy, we need to model it for our students. And I don't think that this process modeled it for our students. So thank you.

[04:10:54] - Okay, I think that covers everybody who signed up or expressed the desire to speak. Thank you all for being with us today. We appreciate the comments. The board is gonna be in recess at lunch until 1:25.

[04:57:02] I don't know, motion's been made. Is there a second to that? - No. - Okay, we are live, folks. So rather than have the thing devolve into something it shouldn't, let's get going. All right. First item is the consent agenda.

[04:57:20] We're pulling B, C, and D. So is there a motion to adopt A, E, and F? Oh, hold it, hold it. Ann, do I need to move E and F for you? No, I just want to. Oh, you know what? I'll just express my, it's only F.

[04:57:36] Okay. But I'll just express it when we get to it. That's fine. All right. Well, this is a consent agenda. Is there a motion to adopt A, E, and F? Or do I need to pull it? No, you don't need to pull it. I'll just -- I'll still express it. That's fine. So, AENF? Yes.

[04:57:52] Thank you, Ms. Dotto. I appreciate your paying attention. Is there a second? Too many of them over here. Thank you, Mr. Hanson. Do you have any discussion before we vote, Mr. President? Sure. I'm going to vote affirmatively on the consent agenda, but just want to note that I don't mean to be opining on the matters having to do with George Mason University within ENF, But rather than go to the trouble to separate them out, I'll just note that I recuse myself as to those pieces.

[04:58:20] - I appreciate that. Okay, all in favor signify by saying aye. - Aye. - Any opposed? Okay, item B, C, and D, can we take them together, Ms. Dutta, do you think? - Absolutely. - All right, Ms. Dutta asks that they be polled, and I don't think, or do we require more staff presentation, or did you just want them polled?

[04:58:38] - I don't know, and I know I've had conversations with the superintendent about this, and I wish she were here, but-- - Well, then we can wait. I'm not gonna make you do it without her here, if you want her here.

[04:58:53] - I think at this point, I get the feeling it's just gonna be a comment from my side, but yeah, it would be great if I-- - Okay, so we'll move on to item G, final review of James Blair Middle School Accreditation Indicator, and we will come back to BC&D. - Thank you.

[04:59:08] - Of course, yeah. Good afternoon. I was hoping to be able to say good morning, but that just didn't work out that way. good afternoon president gecker members of the board and superintendent baylow at the october 20th business meeting the board was presented a first review of an appeal submitted by williamsburg james city county public schools to change the performance level of an accreditation indicator the board was presented with the justifications from the school division for the appeal

[04:59:45] as well as the responses from an internal vdoe committee that reviewed their appeal and unanimously felt that there was insufficient evidence to grant it during the first review of the item the superintendent of wjcc public schools requested a change in the processes and procedures for accrediting schools that do not have three years worth of data and therefore do not have the option of calculating a

three-year rate she indicated that she was coming forward to respectfully ask that accreditation be waived not only for James Blair middle school but for

[05:00:21] other four schools that opened in the 2018-19 school year like james blair had in response to that request there's no statutory or regulatory basis that allows the board to waive accreditation for a particular school in addition regulatory code requires each school to be assigned an accreditation status based on the current accreditation model it is the recommendation of the superintendent of public instruction to deny the appeal submitted by wjcc public schools for james blair middle school since the appeal did not contain sufficient evidence to warrant a

[05:01:00] change in the performance level for the indicator listed in the appeal and additionally there is no statutory or regulatory basis available to the board to grant an accreditation waiver at this In this final review, VDOE staff is asking whether or not the board approves or denies the appeal of the performance level indicator submitted by WJCC.

[05:01:23] Okay. And the superintendent would like us to deny that. Yes. Okay. Is there any discussion on this before we look for a motion? Is there a historical context of things like this in the past from divisions that could, you know, it's obviously appealed to something that is in the state board's purview.

[05:01:46] So is there any historical parallel or precedent? - I think the only one I can remember, Alan, is Roanoke with Dr. Bishop. And I'll be honest, I don't remember the details of that, but I do remember we effectively, I wouldn't say gave accreditation, but we upped where they were based on an appeal.

[05:02:11] And that was, I think, when Dr. Cannaday was still president of the board. - President, if I can speak to it, and staff I'm sure can too, But there was one year when we granted one or two, and then we did something that changed the, tinkered with the standards a little bit, such that we didn't think that it was, that those precedents were no longer relevant anyway.

[05:02:37] And then the next time we had a bunch of appeals came up, I don't think any of them passed. Not to say that we shouldn't ever grant an appeal, but we tried to make it such that they would be rare. The necessity for same would be rare. i totally botched that and shelly you guys can tell us yeah somebody who actually remembers these things good afternoon hello i think what you all are remembering was under the previous accreditation model and the request from roanoke city at the time was to appeal the school so that it would be

[05:03:12] reconstituted that was available under the old set of standards but it's not available under the current soa but is available or the current soa is the appeal of an actual indicator and the issue with james blair middle school's appeal is that it does not provide sufficient evidence for the indicator that's being appealed nor do you have any authority under as amy said the code or regulation to waive accreditation for a school i'm just want to make sure i'm on the same page

[05:03:47] so they're asking for four schools to have this waiver as well or why did she include those other three she was saying that they don't have three years worth of data because they were a new school in 2018-19 and there are four other schools in the state that were also new that particular year so she was asking for accreditation to be waived for schools in her situation any other questions and the school already has is already working on an improvement plan which whether granted or not

[05:04:26] they're still going to have to work on uh their academic improvement plan correct correct um the the difference being um whether this indicator is a level two or a level three just differs in terms of

what they would have to to do this would not change their uh particular accreditation status because they did have another level three indicator okay any other discussion or is

[05:04:59] there a motion i would be happy to entertain a motion to deny the appeal how about that we'll make it easier so moved thank you is there a second okay uh it's creasy thank you all right uh any other discussion so you know all those in favor of the motion which is to deny the appeal signify by saying aye aye any opposed thank you thank you all right uh one more time final

[05:05:33] review the board of eds 2022 annual report on conditions and needs miss webb good afternoon mr president vice president mann members of the board and superintendent baylow i'm pleased to present to you today for final review the board's 2022 annual report on the conditions and needs of public schools in virginia this report is required by the constitution of virginia and 22.1-18 of the code of virginia which outlines that the annual report will be submitted to the

[05:06:09] governor and general assembly that presents the conditions and needs of public education in the commonwealth the current draft of the report includes sections on learning loss staffing challenges student achievement the impact of principal leadership and support for new teachers enrollment education funding and an update on the board's work over the past year since first review the sections have been reorganized for a better flow additional data points have been added based on your october discussion and an executive summary has been drafted for your review since our work session yesterday a section has been added on chronic absenteeism and student

[05:06:48] behavior and clarifications have been made throughout the document as you requested language has also been updated that dr mann put together as it relates to parent involvement all edits made since yesterday's work session are highlighted in green in the word document in your board book so again please be sure to click on the word document not the pdf document also since first review all of the supplemental technical reports have been finalized and are also included as the supplemental reports they will be combined into one full report when it is submitted to the governor and general

[05:07:27] assembly the superintendent of public instruction recommends that the board approve the annual report for final review and allow staff to make technical edits in advance of the december 1 submission date i'd certainly open up the floor for additional edits comments feedback on the edits that have been made i know you're just seeing them but certainly happy to keep discussing them here this afternoon okay we have the one paragraph dealing with the importance of parent educator partnerships is that one resolved i believe it has been fairly resolved um i know

[05:08:03] that a couple Dr. Mann had sent it out and a couple of folks had responded to that email as well with some clarifications that I've tried my best to make sure that those were also included and Mr. Hansen had sent an additional sentence to be added as well that's also highlighted in green the sentences that Mr. Hansen added are underlined and that is on page 25.

[05:08:33] so on the bottom of page 25 and the top of page 26 and if we mr president if we need to give folks additional time to review and i need to come back in a little bit i'm happy to do that as well

[05:09:11] the sad part is of course i know here during the whole time you know we've already had substantial documents added to the board book while we were doing public comment and you know i just assume if it's okay with the board get this one done and through and and i will note on the chronic

absenteeism and student behavior section it is highly footnoted because a lot of that information comes directly from the jlark report that we were discussing

[05:09:40] yesterday everybody had a chance to look at this and of course prior to final submission I will do one more review for any punctuation grammatical errors

[05:10:13] things of that nature is there you know general consensus or something like a motion to adopt this as our annual report i appreciate staff's uh willingness to take on sort of a final edit i would like to be included in the final edit if it's the board's will you know that i get one final shot also not to make substantive changes but again uh you know just go back through it one more time with staff and mr president i don't one more thing to point out that i forgot to mention um that i just want to be sure i captured it correctly this is on page 32 in the

[05:10:52] looking ahead section I added a sentence in there about the board exploring the uses of multiple measures to better understand student achievement including discussing the implications of the standards of learning NAEP and other national assessments I know we had a conversation about that yesterday I just want to be sure it's captured appropriately okay so everybody on board and is there a motion therefore to adopt this is our report subject to final edits by staff and by me.

[05:11:27] And again, edits like last time, not the substantive piece, but just trying to make sure everything we think is in there is in there. If so, is there a motion? Thank you, Dr. Mann. Is there a second? Thank you, Mr. Hanson.

[05:11:42] All those in favor, say aye. - Aye. - Any opposed? Okay, before you leave the podium, let's just say this. - You've got to come back one more time. - No, but this is the one I wanted to do that. okay uh you've done over the last x number of years i don't even know how many because it seems like forever right now uh just an incredible job guiding the board and you know doing everything we wanted and frankly telling us what it is we ought to be doing when we didn't want to so uh the experience you know with having you with us has been just incredibly great and

[05:12:21] you understand that you are moving on to a different if not better job we'll say different here you can you can say better when you leave but a different job one which will also give you a chance to serve the children of the commonwealth for which all of us i know are grateful to have somebody of your capacity intellect and skills you know advocating for our kids which is really you know at its heart the mission of this board is to advocate for the kids and so you know i wish we had had time to do a more formal sort of say goodbye, but I just want to tell you again what

[05:12:59] a great experience it's been for me to have had the opportunity to work with you. I think of the board members, it's likely I've had the chance to work most closely with you just because of the nature of the various roles and I can tell you, you know, you're the best and it makes me very sad to have you leaving uh and i thank ms holton yes just a few words to add and then a a couple of things from all of us emily we're heartbroken for our personal sake that you're departing from this job uh the public may not have yet heard but that emily did let us know yesterday

[05:13:39] that she is ending her time at the virginia department of education i think it is safe to report, maybe you want to elaborate more, but that she's going to a newly created position as Vice President of Education and Workforce at the Virginia Chamber of Commerce, which I think is a brilliant move by the Chamber. Touché to Barry Duvall for having stolen you away from us, but it's also a wonderful thing for

the Commonwealth. You will do great things there. I've had the pleasure to work with you in varying capacities over many administrations.

[05:14:12] you know, everybody here knows you've worked in this position with three different gubernatorial administrations. You also served in a previous role in the McDonald administration. So I've watched you serve with Republican and Democratic administrations, work with the public, work with the stakeholder groups, work with all of us. I remember well when I was secretary, you came in and shared your wisdom with me early on as you were having been in the prior administration and me coming in green as I could be and and you've been that kind of kind and welcoming throughout and we'll just miss you terribly thank you for your service

[05:14:51] to the department and with others may have things to add but I've got on behalf

[05:14:55] of all of us a couple of things thank you don't ever cry in public I've been

[05:15:34] with in this position a little over or almost six years now six years in December and it has been the honor to serve the board I'm incredibly proud of the work that we've done and I know that that will continue so please don't hesitate to reach out to me my new role I'm still here for a couple weeks for department staff but I'm looking forward to the new challenge with the chamber and continuing to serve the students of the Commonwealth so thank you thank you i thought those last few weeks were to finish jillian's training

[05:16:11] no matter where she is yes thank you okay item i first review the proposed revised 2022 history and social science standards of learning mr president it's okay i'd like to step off the of course yes this is the second first review the second first review

[05:16:59] do i have to like quicker there it is all right well uh yeah i too uh wish we could say good morning but but we can't it's afternoon um and thank you this is a very different vantage point i asked permission from the president to step down and to present from here um because in part i want to make sure that i introduce you to sheila bird who is sitting to my left who helped on this um

[05:17:39] on this final leg of the uh standards preparation for you today so um thank you also for uh um just i know that that some of the materials uh were were changing even as of today this morning I woke up nice and early, as the president knows, and I wanted to make sure that we continue to be as transparent as we possibly can be, because the intent on the standards review process is never to be anything but transparent.

[05:18:14] So that said, let me just go ahead and get started through a few slides that I have, and I am going to pull those up on my computer as well.

[05:18:26] Bear with me for just a minute. Okay. So I'm just going to start by acknowledging a couple of things. First of all, you all have heard me say many times, you heard the governor say, we want the best in class history and social science standards. We want students to learn all of Virginia and U.S. history. We want to make sure that students learn how to think, not what to think.

[05:18:54] that is still the goal and even there was nothing about this morning's comment that that made me think that we're not all sharing that that as a common goal going forward it's a matter of making sure that we get this right and have best-in-class standards going forward certainly we we heard from a number

of folks across the Commonwealth this morning that that have concerns and they're valid and i want to publicly acknowledge as i already have that uh that i apologize for

[05:19:30] not just the omission but the air of calling indigenous peoples of virginia immigrants they were here long before any other settlers or any other um any other groups were and i apologize for that air so that said i want to just let you know that there is work to do today and going forward to make sure that we do have best in class standards and um and i appreciate the again the diversity and the passion that came into the room this morning as they shared concerns as they um

[05:20:05] as uh as they exercise their first amendment right and what we hope is a very public and transparent process up to now and going forward so as you know uh today i'm asking for a first review of the standards document and this happens every seven years standards revision is every seven years going to switch maybe there we go here's a current snapshot in 2015 the SOL document the standards document that came in front of you was about 48 pages long and one year later those were

[05:20:44] adopted in 2015. In 2016, one year later, the curriculum frameworks were released. They were not released at the same time. Once the standards document was accepted for, as the standards document, then the work began on the curriculum framework. It was divided into 13 separate frameworks that totaled a little over 700 pages. Fast forward to the 2022 standards that have been the works for almost two years and and as we heard this morning are inclusive of many voices across

[05:21:19] the commonwealth and really across the nation and the decision was made early on to combine the curriculum frameworks and the standards document into one document that was a little over 400 pages and you saw that but did not move that forward for first review in august but rather i asked i we had a discussion and support from the board to pull that document into two separate documents one being the standards document and one being the curriculum frameworks the curriculum frameworks were parking they went into a parking lot they're not lost and and i think that that's

[05:21:57] really important to understand today that we're looking at two different documents so let me let me just show you where we are now on this timeline here's here is this timeline really depicts two simultaneous processes up until this point we have the standards and there's an arrow that says here's where we are now the creation the comment that's today going forward should a standards document be accepted for first review there will continue to be edits and and

[05:22:33] those can be substantive as of this week we've already engaged multiple communities some of which were represented here today to talk about making sure that they are represented not only in the standards document but also in the frameworks i also commit to you today that um i'll reach back out to the groups that were here today to uh to help them understand where um where some of the information is in the curriculum frameworks and also for me to understand whether it needs to be represented in the broad learning goals of the standards document once the standards are adopted

[05:23:11] we will move move forward with implementation in the year 24 25 meanwhile the curriculum frameworks are developed the assessment is developed and teacher professional development also moves forward now let's juxtapose that with the with the curriculum framework work if i could make another arrow which i can't we would be from here or if i had a laser pointer which i don't unfortunately um we could make an arrow that is between the first and the second circles on this

[05:23:46] slide we are between um we are between creation and comment and that's because that standards document that you all saw in august that did not move forward was the standards as well as the curriculum framework so let me just say again we took the standards out of that they were incomplete and we built onto those we built content into those we built those out in different ways which I outlined in a memo but I'm happy to go into more detail about and then the curriculum framework we really parking

[05:24:22] lot it that information and that's sitting in the curriculum framework document now that I believe you all have access to and we will build our curriculum frameworks from there those are also subject as traditionally has been the case those are subject to input by this board adoption by this board and further public comment and transparency in that process as well it is really important to me that we reach out during the curriculum framework phase and engage teachers as one of our primary audiences and one of our primary

[05:25:02] communities that we seek input from because that's who uses the curriculum framework. It's the bridge between the materials that are used and the teaching that happens every day and the standards document which is much more public-facing and states the broad learning goals.

[05:25:19] So I'm going to just skip ahead for a moment because I think that this is really important to Talk about in the decouple. We'll use that term. That's the the separated document From august the curriculum framework and the standards document that was combined when we did a straight separation this is what Virginia u.s. History standard 14 looked like and I'm going to read it out loud The student will apply history and social science skills to understand the causes and effects of the civil rights movement by

[05:25:56] evaluating and explaining the impact of Brown v. Board of Education decision, the roles of Thurgood Marshall and Oliver W. Hill, senior, and how Virginia responded to the decision. B, explaining how the National Association for the Advancement of Colored People, the NAACP, and the 1963 March on Washington, the Civil Rights Act of 1964, and the Voting Rights Act of 1965 had an impact on all Americans, and C, Analyzing the input or the impact of the black power movement. So when we did the straight separation

[05:26:33] This is how that went into a standards document when we went back out for review over the last month The reviewers felt like this wasn't enough And so this is what it translated into into the standards document And I do not have my glasses on so let me see if I can pull that up and read from my computer Yes, much better. Bear with me for just a moment.

[05:27:11] No, here we go. Okay, so when we built those standards out based on the feedback that we received, same standard, Virginia U.S. history, now it's 17 because additional content has been added to the standards document.

[05:27:35] Same standard, students will apply history and social science skills to analyze the causes and effects of the civil rights movement by analyzing the origins of the civil rights movement the effects of segregation and efforts to desegregate schools transportation and public areas much more detail in the standards document evaluating the impact of the legacy of martin luther king jr including a letter from birmingham jail civil disobedience the southern christian leadership conference i have a dream speech

[05:28:07] comparing to the gettysburg address and his assassination analyzing key events including the murder of emmett till bus boycotts little rock central high school desegregation greensboro sit-ins freedom ride rides birmingham demonstrations 1963 march on washington freedom summer and selma

to montgomery marches with additional emphasis on events in virginia and d evaluating and explaining the impact of brown v board education decision, the roles of Thurgood Marshall and Oliver W. Hill Sr., and how Virginia responded with massive resistance with a focus on the critical role of Virginia communities and

[05:28:46] people such as Prince Edward County and Barbara Johns. E. Explaining how the National Association for the Advancement of Colored People, NAACP, the 1963 March on Washington, the Civil Rights Act of 1964, and the Voting Rights Act of 1965 had an effect on all Americans. F, analyzing the effect of the Black Power Movement, and G, describing the tenets of the Civil Rights Act of 1964.

[05:29:14] So this is just an example of what was built out and strengthened in the standards document, again, so that the public, as well as educators, can see it's not just a matter of a couple of sub bullets or sub letters under the standards but there are some distinct learning goals then in the curriculum framework we would build that out even more with resources and as we would as we always see in curriculum frameworks but those any other information from that combined document is sitting in the

[05:29:50] curriculum framework right now waiting to either be finalized or built out so I think it's important to know that the information again from that combined document is not lost in many cases it was built upon and expanded in the document that's before you today and then and if it wasn't it is put into the curriculum framework from which we will continue working let's see here let me get back here okay so moving on to oops we've got an extra two on the title

[05:30:30] slide of this the standards phrase or standards phase and the framework phase um i feel like i already went over this as i walked through the timeline but i just want to be really clear and depicted a couple of different ways um that again the standards or the broad learning goals for each grade level the framework documents are the course curriculum frameworks they're under development now include information from the august 2022 document they will be open for public comment The adoption of revised frameworks will come to you as they are completed, or we can send them to you all at once, and then we will implement at the same time.

[05:31:09] Yes. Oh, I can't do that. Yeah. - May I just ask for clarification? Some of the documents that were, some of what I read in the materials preparing for this board meeting suggested that, and I think you and I spoke about it, that you had some question about whether the curriculum framework would be coming back to this board for approval, or whether that would be something administration the department would take responsibility for so can you clarify that and also can you address when the curriculum frameworks will come back to us for a review yep so um if they will yeah thank you um thank you and for that question and so uh i want to

[05:31:48] be really clear and if there is any contradiction in the in the written materials um i i don't mean for there to be i didn't mean for there to be and um we the the curriculum frameworks will come back to this board for adoption they will go through a public process so that they can be vetted and and receive input from the public and we will also be reaching out to specific communities as well as teachers to help with those as we saw evidence this morning we don't want to rush this process we want to work quickly but we want to work carefully and we want to get it right

[05:32:23] and so uh you know i i said that they would be done i believe i said in august the curriculum frameworks would be done at the last board meeting i want to say that we already have a good start on them more than we did in 2015 because there was no sort of decoupled document in 2015 but we want to

make sure that we get them right um our goal is to get them as as to you as soon as possible and um and certainly within the next year um i would still like to shoot for the august timeline but i don't want to be rushed and if i may just if that means august is when they will be

[05:33:00] finalized when would you anticipate we would have a is there any way we could have a first draft of the curriculum framework before we vote on final version of the standards i think that would help the public so i i i agree and i think that that is um is important so one of the new documents that that was uploaded to your board book today was the framework for the frameworks, if you will.

[05:33:27] There's a document in your board book that has the 13 curriculum frameworks in it. There is a front page that says this is the information from the decoupled document. That's really important to get out there and thank you for the opportunity to do so. This is the information from the decoupled document.

[05:33:44] This is where that information went. in the curriculum frameworks waiting for us to pick up on that work once we have a standards document to move forward from if you know and we can continue to do some some work on the curriculum frameworks as we go but that is in there and the timeline is also on there as a cover page this timeline right here and we actually added an arrow that says we are here on the curriculum framework phase as well. So again, the intent is not to be secretive or shrouded with this process. It's to

[05:34:19] be very public and very inclusive with the development and the finalization of the curriculum frameworks. Okay, question for you. Am I right or am I wrong when I say, because I just put the two documents side by side. So I'm looking at August, what we saw, and I'm looking at the curriculum frameworks that are uploaded to the board book. Those are the same. I want to be really clear that the staff has been doing, LIDEOE staff, Crestonia, and her team have been doing a lot of work and have

[05:34:57] gone as far as they comfortably could go without a finalized standards document in starting to build those out. However, I just want to be clear, the content from August of 22 is within the curriculum frameworks i am going to um confirm that from my perspective but i'm also going to ask him or christonia if they are here to verify and if they're because the way i mean i'm just doing a quick side by side don't have my other screens up to be able to do it all together but

[05:35:36] from what i was able to compare it looked that way and i i think i can confirm that but i want make double triple shorts you know hello my dear hi how are you what's the question again sorry so looking at the curriculum frameworks the the k through i pulled i pulled kindergarten and just looked at k1 and compared to k1 from the august standards document that was before us they are

[05:36:13] the same the content is the same in the framework as it is in the generally the same in the framework as it is appears in the in the standards document okay so in other words we are not veering off of august completely we should not be no because when you look at the curriculum frameworks you should see standards correct and then at the top of the pages for the curriculum frameworks that same standard should be there yes thank you that's all i wanted to know that's an easy

[05:36:50] question but i'm sorry that requires me to make sure i'm not a misunderstanding because the frameworks that were uploaded an hour or two ago to our board work do not align with the standards we were given last friday i mean the the framework says 3.10 talks about slavery and the standards Say 3.10 talks about economics of tobacco or something in other words there The framework that we were given an

hour or two ago corresponds to the August draft not to the November draft Unless I'm drastically missing something. Yep. So remember and I have it up on the screen

[05:37:27] The timeline we have two processes we have the standards process and we have the curriculum framework process What you have in your board book is? Is is the decoupled side? The other side of the decoupled documents it Decoupled document it is the curriculum framework side. So once there is a standards document. We do need to align those And and we do need to make sure they they have work to do the curriculum frameworks And I put a cover sheet on that and they and Cristania and her team have Have indicated with a watermark on there. Those are draft

[05:38:07] frameworks we are not moving those forward today at least as i'm prepared to do because they are under development and they they require work okay so i'm going to move back to the um just again a depiction of the timeline from a little bit longer perspective in january of 2021 the board of education started this work in august of 2022 that is when videoe staff presented the uh the the combined curriculum framework and standards document and um and we we requested you all

[05:38:46] supported the uh further development of that document before acceptance for first review in september videoe staff engaged as well and we and sheila also engaged with additional additional subject matter experts on curriculum experts and historians and content experts on making sure that we had more eyes and fresh perspectives on that document and in october of 2022 the board of education agreed to decouple the sol from the curriculum framework i'm sorry

[05:39:24] that that was actually in august and then today that brings us to today which is the presentation of the history and social science sol document to for first review so let's move forward from here should they be accepted for first review today by this board what we will do is convene public hearings and input sessions. We have six public input sessions or community engagement sessions, we're calling those, and this is a new step in the process. What I've asked BDOE staff to do

[05:40:02] is cap the attendance on those on those community engagement sessions, give folks actually a survey to fill out, kind of like the students filled out that we saw back in August, as well as some homework to do and part of that is identifying what group what small group they want to be in to discuss the standards and continue to give feedback that feedback will come to the department from the community engagement sessions from the public hearings as well as we'll continue to take written feedback as we have throughout the process and we will continue to convene

[05:40:40] as an internal group as well as convene external groups who have been part of process to check factual check for factual accuracy age appropriateness etc so here is just a little bit more detail on what would happen between now and February acceptance again pending acceptance for first review of the draft standards by you today November 28th to December 16th are the public engagement

[05:41:17] sessions january 9th through 13th we give a 30-day um we give a 30-day uh we're running close to that but we'll give plenty of notice for the public hearings we may either need to adjust that it is or else i'm incorrect on the 30 days no dan's saying it's 30 days january of 2023 um our team will review and take additional input from our reviewers and then in february is when the final review and adoption of the standards document would be would come before this board

[05:41:52] meanwhile we will continue to work on the standards frameworks so um i'm going to make sure that i share with you where the public engagement sessions are tentatively scheduled we don't have

these publicly posted because we we this board hasn't acted to accept any standards for first review yet so I was reluctant to put these into a memo but I will say that

[05:42:24] they are in northern Virginia's central Virginia southwest Virginia and there is a virtual a virtual session as well so spread out across the Commonwealth and we want to make sure that as many voices as possible are heard throughout that process so just a you you all saw the the revised history and social studies science standards guiding principles I am NOT going to go over those again today for the sake of time and because I think that you all want to

[05:43:03] discuss maybe some things that are that are separate from the the guiding principles but I can certainly go back to that if you would like me to I do do also want to talk about just some of the high-level changes that were incorporated into into this draft today we we provided more specific and thorough treatment of slavery reconstruction Jim Crow era and civil rights movement in all three great spans you saw an example of that that I read out loud just a few minutes ago the impact of the United States

[05:43:41] Declaration of Independence and Constitution on other countries a fuller explanation of the Electoral College and an examination of the Federalist papers that are most essential to understanding the Constitution Moving through introduction to the Constitution and three branches of government in grades K through three Are the the reviewers the final set of reviewers felt like that was lacking and creating a staircase or a scaffold of standards that builds on students understanding of what citizenship is and details its rights and responsibilities also a revision of

[05:44:18] repetitive and vague skills based standards subject to multiple interpretations by teachers in the standards document we focused much more on the content and that was measurable and in the curriculum frameworks that's where we'll see much more of the inquiry based and the critical thinking and the the skills based activities in the curriculum frameworks also a presentation of the content in an unbiased and dispassionate language Removal of behavioral aspirations that are misplaced in history and social science social science standards document and a recommended sequence that promotes

[05:44:57] Consistency in the content that's taught at each grade level in the Commonwealth. I'm going to pause there and see if there are our our questions and then I have just a couple more comments and then I'd like for for Sheila to just speak for a little bit about the process thank you superintendent Balo one of the questions I have we heard a lot this morning about the who

[05:45:33] participated in the process for revision I would really like to really understand what the role of staff has been in this process and as much as there have been a year and a half history of experience with the writing with the work to what extent were they included in the opportunity to enrich or deepen the content as you've articulated i think it's very important to really clearly spell that out and as much as this morning we heard a number of public commenters question that understanding

[05:46:10] So that's my first question. Yeah, I think Sheila may speak to this a little bit as well And that's an important question and I want to acknowledge that the video that BDOE staff including Chris Tanya and her supervisor Christine and Andrea and Brandy have been wonderful to work with and they do have a rich knowledge I made a decision early on that we needed some fresh eyes on this and asked Sheila to work with us and Sheila has largely directed that work with uh with both staff and with additional reviewers um the staff has been involved in

[05:46:47] in this final leg they've continued to develop the curriculum frameworks that you have in front of you today and um have have continued to finalize the um the standards document um suggesting a number of edits as recently as late last week i believe it was and so um they have been part of the process but it's looked a little bit different on this final leg with with Sheila bringing a fresh perspective into the work and into into this this this final leg and Sheila will probably talk as well as the staff could attest to this

[05:47:26] this last leg of work this last leg of reviews has been fast-paced you asked us all at the last meeting to be very fast paced and we have and so this is certainly a draft in front of you that is ripe for continued improvements and continued edits throughout the public engagement process and as well as with input from our staff so we will continue to engage them until there is a finalized draft product or excuse me a finalized standards product as well as finalized curriculum

[05:48:02] frameworks we will also you know the the staff will be will be key in determining determining professional development coordinating professional development as well as giving input on the assessments that are forthcoming and the implementation of the new standards in the year 24-25 we also heard a number of comments regarding the people that were involved that you consulted with i think it is important that those names be made public the organizations we have not held

[05:48:36] back on all of the individuals that have been involved in doing this work prior to this pause and transition i think it's critically important to be transparent about exactly who was consulted and conferred with and the revision of uh the standards as they have been presented to us yep and dr. Mann I want to be I just want to be really clear in in my approach to this and that was to be consistent with the process so far so when kristania for example presented in August and presented the the slides about the

[05:49:12] process she named the different reviewers and the different groups but as far as the specific names those were available on request I've asked for names on a number of the committees and a number of the review committees and And Chris Tanya has has supplied those to me immediately and I appreciate that in the same vein you know that the the final group of reviewers is also named the the expert review committee and and so we Again being consistent with the process we didn't provide Names of those reviewers unless they were requested and what I'm hearing is that you're requesting them and

[05:49:53] um so we will provide those i did talk about a couple at the last board meeting i've um i've shared those with with multiple media outlets when requested so i think that they're out there and um and it's it's not a secret it's not it's not a secret i appreciate that but i i definitely feel like in light of what we heard this morning um public trust is at stake with the way this process has been handled that cannot be denied and i don't know these people but i think it is

[05:50:27] important that we make that public not just for myself but for the public that came here this morning and expressed concerns over exactly who the fresh eyes were that were invited into a process to offer feedback i just i think in the spirit of really wanting to make sure we are demonstrating the things that we're asking for and all other facets of of what this board and the way the VEDOE is operating transparency of you know sharing of that

[05:51:01] would be important and I'll certainly share that with the members of the board and and I also want to say you know just to just to paint maybe a little bit broader picture on this I was actually this morning looking back through some of the public comments that we received on the August draft and some of the concerns that were raised by members of this board regarding how they were confusing and

repetitive they weren't not accessible to either teachers or the general public as a usable document they were vague and sometimes miss

[05:51:40] prioritize skills over content that was you know the skills some in many cases would be difficult to measure with an assessment we heard from a number of national organizations as well including the National Association of Scholars Civics Alliance that that reiterated that and called out a number of irregularities and concerns that existed within the standards document so to say that we took and you didn't insinuate this but but the goal has always been to

[05:52:16] make this document the best that it could be in August we we did not have that today we do not have that through continued public input through continued work through sometimes difficult conversations and and comments and concerns like we heard this morning and we're having now we will get there and and this is part of policymaking and and this is part of the process and so I I want to be really really transparent about that and consistent in in my my commitment to

[05:52:52] saying that my commitment to making sure that all voices are heard both over the last two years and and more recently with with the facilitation by Sheila and a new group of reviewers and additional voices who did not feel heard some of whom are depicted in in our public comments some of whom we have reached out to for additional additional comment and expertise so there will be

[05:53:25] an offering of names that can be made publicly available i think the other one other point i wanted to uh just ask a clarifying question about because i really am trying to follow the tracks of what we've the reasons for the things we've done and and made adjustments and timeline etc and i think as we were talking um initially about the community engagement groups and i'm definitely not opposed to community engagement but i think in light of just not really being sure i understand

[05:54:01] the intent of these things i i'm just using this opportunity to get clarification because initially community engagement groups were recommended because there was concern that there had not been sufficient opportunity for input that you were getting questions from individuals that you really felt like it was important to create an opportunity for additional input um i as we're going forward and and the public hearings have always been a part of the process that we've used to gather input

[05:54:37] for these kinds of opportunities for revision processes i i think unless i can be convinced that a community input you know approach is going to be established in such a way that there is random groups or a random way to know who's getting opted in versus not i'm just that gives me cause for concern if we cannot articulate clearly why we need this next step when we had

[05:55:15] 5 000 people raise their hand and and and had opportunity throughout the process to weigh in and all of a sudden we we got to create more of that and and for people that do spend their time pausing to try and contribute i don't think you mean for it to feel like That doesn't matter. I just don't believe that's the place you're coming at it from.

[05:55:46] But I have to tell you what it can sound like, what it can feel like for people who have taken the time to make their voices heard. It sounds like, thank you, but there's some more people that we think need to weigh in here.

[05:56:06] And again, I'm not saying that that is the intention, but I have to articulate that that's what it can feel like. So if we're creating, if we're changing the need to continue to have community engagement

groups, I think it is really critical that we can articulate the methodology for which people are going to be opted into those kinds of experiences.

[05:56:32] Yeah, so I appreciate that and would push back a little on the term, thank you, but we want to listen to others because it's a yes and moment, right? We, again, looking back through the public comment, understanding as I've been out and about across the nation and the Commonwealth, as I've talked to my colleagues in other states who are undergoing standards revision, there were voices left out.

[05:57:00] And we wanted to add those to the process, not to replace, not to say thank you, but, but to add those to the process. One of those missing voices that I heard from very often or very early when I came on is there was no parent group and so Krystania and her team reached out to a parent group to The the parent teacher Association. We had a short zoom with them They they reviewed the standards and did not have concerns and for me I knew that there were other parent groups that we needed to reach out to

[05:57:36] in in my history or my tenure is as a state superintendent not just in virginia But but also in in another state i'm doing the community engagement sessions Was was a sim a symbiotic experience?

[05:57:51] It was an opportunity for interested to community members to learn more about the process learn more about the document and also to provide some To be part of a solution in a way that wasn't the clock is ticking at a public hearing you have three minutes to say your piece and then you must sit down and So it is it's it's a much different setting and And and it's important that that that we continue to engage those voices Please understand that I'm not suggesting the standards that came to us on August 22nd were perfect

[05:58:29] That's that's not what my comments are about my comments are about the process and how the process undermines the things that we say are important that's really what's at stake here if I remember the August presentation correctly wasn't there always the plan regardless to go to these community engagement sessions

[05:59:03] because I think if I'm not mistaken I think Cristania had outlined the process by which we would move, so was that instigated in the previous process, or was that instigated for this particular process?

[05:59:21] Yeah, perhaps I misunderstood Dr. Mann's question, but that was something that I asked for last spring, so well before the August meeting, again, wanting to make sure that we heard from voices that perhaps hadn't been heard before, and one contingency is the parent group you know and just to you know as we've gone through this process we've identified that that there you know there were issues not just with the August standards document but also our standards and curriculum framework document but also also you know we we learned today that there are some

[06:00:00] concerns as well and so how do we you know the the question is how do we continue to hear voices how do we continue to um to take feedback and input um and and and move forward move this process forward to get to best in class to get to the best standards that we can i think that offering a variety of ways to do that is the best way to do that hence the community engagement sessions the public hearings as well as opportunities for written feedback and um and not just after today but as i have throughout reaching out to um to our seat community to our

[06:00:39] tribal community and i will absolutely reach back out to them um earlier this week we had a a zoom call with um with the jewish community and um and had an opportunity to talk through the

standards document the curriculum frameworks and that that is something people are interested in that maybe seven years ago they they were not as interested in but we we have a really engaged parent and public contingency in public education right now and rather than say we're going to do public input the way that we always have i want to make sure that that we are that we're creating

[06:01:18] more entry points for the public to have input and have a say hence the extended time more voices the addition of the community engagement sessions ms holton if i may ms baylor both a comment and a question i welcome public engagement and as long as it takes us i am eager to hear from everybody here i understand the role of the community engagement sessions etc my comment is i do want to note that today we've heard from in person from many members of the public we have received

[06:01:56] letters from hundreds of parents. We received, I'm told, another 500 letters that haven't even been submitted to us yet because this process was so condensed. They came in too late to get to us yet, but I am told that they, like the hundreds we have already seen, are overwhelmingly in favor of the August 22 version rather than the November version and raise very serious concerns about the November so we're hearing from a lot of parents and they are not on board with

[06:02:31] the draft that you're asking us to go forward on that's my comment my question is I want to go back to dr. Mann's question can I can I just respond to that really quickly sure um one one thing that I I heard loud and clear this morning is that a lot of the commenters believed that their input was gone if it's not in the standards document it's gone that is not the case all of that information from the combined documents is now in the curriculum frameworks and there will be an opportunity to build build on to that and so I you know I I

[06:03:10] want to make really clear in communication that that what I heard today is that we gave input and it's not reflected in the standards document hopefully some of that is is is quelled or allayed with you know with with this discussion about the curriculum frameworks and that nothing from that document is lost it's gone in to curriculum frameworks to be built upon and and we will continue to do that thank you I but I do understand when

[06:03:45] things were in the 2015 version in the standards not the curriculum framework in the standards and that they've now disappeared from the November draft and numerous things that applies to that matter to a lot of the people we heard from this morning. I'll enumerate some of them when we talk later, but I understand why the public has doubts.

[06:04:07] My question is, going back to Dr. Mann's, can't we get a list, I mean, can you tell us now who some of those reviewers are? I mean, that's gonna matter to my consideration of the conversation today. And I've confessed that I've been so overwhelmed reading board of head, board book documents this week.

[06:04:23] I haven't actually read much of the press. So if you've told the press, I don't know what you've told them. Who are these reviewers that we've been using besides Ms. Bird Carmichael? - So, okay, okay. So we will get that.

[06:04:39] I can't name them off the top of my head, sorry. - Perhaps Ms. Bird Carmichael can, but somebody before we get to the discussion voting part of this meeting, it would be helpful to know that. - All right.

[06:04:53] Yes. PTA, just one point. I know that many schools, especially Title I schools, do not have PTAs. There are many schools that do not have PTOs and there are many organic parent groups. And so if you do reach out, I would appreciate if it was a more inclusive and thorough outreach to the parent groups.

[06:05:20] um i just wanted to make a couple of comments please uh three things that kind of stood out in the the uh the standards guiding principles um that i think to me are just very important uh i'll just kind of read them the it says the virtues and flaws of virginia the united states and other world civilizations will be taught in an objective factual and age-appropriate way by balancing fact and inquiry-based learning opportunities teachers must facilitate open

[06:05:54] and balanced discussions on difficult topics including discrimination and racism and presenting learning opportunities without personal or political bias and parents should have open access to all instructional materials utilized in any virginia public school division policies and practices should reflect this commitment i think these are very important in my mind and um to many people that i know i i will wait to read how the curriculum framework is fleshed out

[06:06:29] as for the standards they are um to me um just 50 or so odd pages that were clear and easy to read they seemed to me factual uh i see diversity of content um a speaker earlier said something about teaching history is not just about teaching facts i don't know about that as i've noted before the august version was repetitive with the themes and concepts cut and pasted throughout there were questionable jargon and content which may many have objected to teaching facts is the right thing

[06:07:07] to do teaching patriotism is important my parents grew up in colonial india in very humble households during india's independence my father was lucky to escape the slaughter of hindus during the partition from then east bengal and he was the only one in his family to be able to go to college through the you know armed forces when i was thinking about immigrating to the united states some decades ago there were some who said that i would always be a second-class citizen in america

[06:07:42] america is not perfect but nor is any other country in the world i know i speak for many immigrants who were drawn to this country because of the promise of individual liberty and responsibility and the founding principles that we have made this country undoubtedly you know it's undoubtedly the best in the world where we can pretty much do anything if we set our minds to it and where there is a promise of equal protection under law today i heard words like

[06:08:14] you know christian nationalism white supremacy youngkin standards right wing dark money groups racist overtures right-wing indoctrination i mean these are definitely tough times in america everything is controversial nothing escapes being politicized the turmoil that the country has been in the last two years has been especially challenging parents who look like me and and other Asians have been called racists.

[06:08:46] I've been called white adjacent, white supremacist for voicing my support for objectivity and merit. On December 1, 2020, I attended a virtual down hall hosted by the Virginia Department of Education called Addressing Racism and Anti-Blackness in Asian American Communities.

[06:09:07] This was one of the many such down halls being held at that time. And in conversations and emails from community members parents i hear questions about whether the hand-picked history standards committees in the prior administration included our voices whether they were unbiased i don't

know no matter what history standards are approved some of us will be called racists and that has become the culture in mainstream american um america today there is no escaping that but to create

[06:09:45] a culture of grievance instead of looking to an optimistic future and bettering our lives is harmful to the psyche of our nation it stunts our children's growth and abilities despite america's constant struggles to live up to her finding idea founding ideals i i think america is a great example worth looking up to um so thank you thank you and i i do think that it is um it

[06:10:18] is probably just important to at least point the board toward a summary of the guiding principles that precede the standards document and and it underscores much of what miss data just just relayed individual liberty and representative govern government are cornerstones of the American way of life the Declaration of Independence in the Constitution are remarkable documents that provide the freedoms and framework for our constitutional republic we aspire to live up to

[06:10:53] the founders ideals for a society that recognizes all individuals are created equally slavery segregation and other examples of american failure live up to its founding ideals failure failing to live up to its founding ideals must be presented honestly accurately and completely immigrants from around the world have come to our shores seeking freedom and opportunity to build a better life and have contributed to our communities and added to the rich history of achievement in our country and free enterprise property rights and the rule of law enable the econ an economic system that allocates assets through free markets and competition and fosters

[06:11:32] innovation opportunity and efficiency america is exceptional but not perfect and um the the rights guaranteed are our cornerstone. Virginia's history is America's history and over the ages civilizations have grown, prospered and vanished. Students should understand that our great American experiment is not guaranteed forever. If we don't teach our students that as a cornerstone for history and social sciences then you know I think I think we're missing the mark in a lot of

[06:12:07] ways and um and that is something that um that our reviewers uh pointed to throughout and that is a place where we have really built out the standards uh with with respect to these guiding principles and um one example uh you know martin luther king jr and other civil rights leaders are included in the revised standards draft we heard some concerns that they weren't this morning or um some statements that they weren't and the standards weren't weren't changed to exclude any history

[06:12:41] in fact just the opposite as i showed you earlier we went from this to this to build out those standards and we'll continue to do that in the um in the frameworks um also the we the reviewers added an entire section on u.s history since world war ii about the causes and effects of the civil rights movement, including some of what I just read earlier regarding Martin Luther King Jr.

[06:13:09] and others. And so the concept is not to whitewash, so to speak, or to water this down in any other way. It is to make sure that our standards document is content and fact-rich and accessible to everyone and that our curriculum frameworks offer teachers an opportunity to use that content and to understand what skills need to be taught at what level.

[06:13:36] I am going to, with that, if it's okay, turn it over to Sheila to talk just a little bit. Mr. Hanson, you had a question. And then Mr. Rotherham. I just, I really appreciate the last back and forth. I think really focusing on the substance that is in here.

[06:13:54] I appreciate the process that you undertake. And I had a similar concern back in the August meeting, I think expressed it asking who had been met with in 2020, 2021, leading up to this, and I never really got an answer either.

[06:14:12] And so I decided to table that and not push it, but I think it's important for us to focus on the substance and I'm looking forward to, you know, who you talk to, what you got input from. But I would also say that the world didn't stop in August or July, you know, from a public input standpoint it wasn't perfect the prior process i'm sure to your point of reaching out to parents in your first few months here i articulated that in the august meeting as well and so i just think that you know if we can keep the conversation focused on the substance where

[06:14:52] we are where we need to be going you know it's i guess good political theater to you know find out or you know want to know who we talk to and stuff but there are a lot of national experts i'm sure there were a lot of national experts and intellectual experts that were discussed in 2020 and 2021 you know my curiosity didn't push me to you know find out exactly who those were i was going more on the substance of what we were viewing um this summer and so i just think that i would respectfully you know just thank you for reaching out to additional people because

[06:15:28] i was frustrated that i wasn't sure who we had talked to if there was a fulsomeness to me the substance of what we were reviewing in august was lacking in many ways from its approach and i just appreciate the work that's gone on to help us get to this i'm also grateful that we've been able to bifurcate this just as it was done seven years ago so that we can have the processes broken down into both the standards and the framework so thank you for what you've been

[06:15:57] doing andy and then dr man i want to make sure so i think and probably other board members i have questions about the standards themselves questions about the curricular frameworks we're holding those and we're still right now mr president prefer we just we focus on sort of process and those points is that correct actually if i had my way we would go through the presentation and then run the full discussion at the end but i'm okay with that i'm happy to let them you know obviously i'm content letting everything go now but well i don't i want to hold them at some point i think you're right we need to organize our thoughts into you know the process the content

[06:16:39] you know and where we're going from here but so i know the superintendent just finished speaking i think and then it was about to turn it over to miss bird and you know let's finish up this round of questions and then we'll go through miss bird's presentation if that's okay i don't i don't have um a long presentation but i'm happy to share with you what my experience has been coming into the middle of this movie and well i think for now let's go ahead and answer the question we'll answer questions and i'm not cutting you off certainly as this progresses i believe that when we get to that point there will be ample opportunity to speak to uh your experience elsewhere i don't

[06:17:16] want to be seen as cutting you off but i think it will be more appropriate as we move a little bit to the next step is that okay okay and yeah so my question is about the is about the process what are we going to do dr bala it was i mean there's i think there's a couple of different kinds of disagreement about the standards there's going to be disagreement that is just legitimate people are going to disagree both on like what's age appropriate and and which content people are going to disagree on what should be in and out and everything can't be in or it becomes unmanageable for teachers those are substantive

disagreements and i think we also have just there's bad faith disagreement and that's going to happen because this is a political process and that's a fact of

[06:17:56] life then there's a third kind which is confusion uh where people we saw a lot of that this morning right people saying stuff's out when it's not confused i don't think you know the department help matters with we're putting you know frameworks and stuff we're trying to figure out while the meeting is going on and and i think that it's very important on a complicated process like this that we try to get like the noise the signal ratio as much towards signals we're actually talking about the content and some of the stuff that's been raised not confusion and this has been a reoccurring this is not the first time the last draft everybody lost it because george why can't remember george

[06:18:32] washington or something like each time sorry yeah he and then and then yeah then he actually came um uh each time so this one we've got confusion about what's in and out what are we going to do going forward because it seems like the next few months are pretty important to get we're spending a lot of time talking about past input like it seems to me the really important input is coming up over these next uh couple months what are we going to do differently to make sure that this process that we're getting that noise to signal ratio as well as we can by communicating clearly, making sure the public knows what's actually going on, what the table stakes are, all of those kinds

[06:19:11] of things. Let me just say, Andy, if you don't mind if I answer that first, what we do going from here is a board call. I mean, the standards are peculiarly in the board's purview, not in the departments, right? We use the department for work, but it is in the board's purview. And what, january 21 i think we adopted a fairly significant you know work program which took a complicated process as you referred to it too and laid out the steps that staff would take on our behalf uh as well as you know who would have input you know various meetings practitioners etc you know

[06:19:49] i think well we'll go over that at the end of this but you know where we are today in my view is you know in august the board i think correctly said split up the framework right from the standards and tasked the department with doing that the department has done a good bit more than that which is fine and that's you know that's not to say the content isn't fine i'm just saying that the the department went past the board's charge which was to really separate out the standards in the framework right that would be if you will the october document that all of us have

[06:20:25] scene which would be that separation where we go from here is up to us and you know at some point we need to recognize well i think we need to recognize that we have to go out for the mandatory public hearings the statute gives a slight preference actually for educator input right there's a specific requirement that separate you know access be maintained for educators which i think is completely appropriate folks who teach this you know i don't think any of us although

[06:21:01] you may be are and grace may be experts on content you know we're not necessarily experts on great appropriateness and we're not necessarily experts on sequencing but we are taking the advice of a myriad of people weighing that advice and you know hopefully going to end up with a final document at some point and i hope it's soon i would like to see the board because we can between the department the consultants and the board we could be talking about this three years from now and not

[06:21:36] making progress toward the goal and the goal is you know to come up with standards that make sense for the commonwealth i would like to see us come out of today or at this point out of february

with an agreement that we go to the mandated public hearings as well as open up the required channel for educators to comment because this is not the last bite at the content apple.

[06:22:07] This is really the first bite in a sense at the content apple. We will have a chance, and I think I even mentioned in August, we can go line by line through the final thing and vote on every sentence if we need to. That's not the point of today. not to get it to perfect it's to get it to that step where the board feels comfortable putting it out as a board draft for public comment now i will also say and i was planning on talking about this later that in terms of process and i mean you guys have seen me now you know you for eight months nine months ten months you know 11 months whatever it's been some of these folks for years how

[06:22:46] important process is to me you know because i do i genuinely believe you know the whole system is set up around you know process makes things better following real process actually turns out a better product you know even in our judicial system is not built on you know it's built on procedural due process as opposed to substantive right I mean there are that's not exactly correctly said but you know what I mean the emphasis is on the process there and you know the error goes the you know towards defendants and things but for us where we sit today we

[06:23:19] We are so far away from established process that I am concerned that we've lost our way quite candidly as a board in terms of directing what's supposed to be going on. And whatever, you know, for us to be getting drafts during the meeting drives me absolutely insane.

[06:23:41] It doesn't matter if they're perfect. Honestly, it still drives me insane because there's nobody up here who can possibly review those things in time. We have documents before us that say the department, and I know what Jillian said today, and I appreciate and respect that, but that the department doesn't have to come back to us for the curriculum framework, and yet a lot of what was in the old standards is now going to be pulled into the curriculum framework.

[06:24:05] To me, it's important that those two things get married, and I'm not sure now how we proceed without the framework in place also, so that we can be sure what the integrated whole will look like. I don't know where this ends up going, but I appreciate the comments.

[06:24:26] Well, gee, this is much better. I don't even understand what the meaning of best in class is, and it's something I wanted to ask. I mean, I understand the concept, but I don't know how we measure are we really best in class, right? I mean, I looked at, just because I was curious, and everybody's now referring to Massachusetts since the NAEP data came out, I looked at their standards.

[06:24:49] You know, we're close to what they are. the first version was close to where they were there they had a few things more than we did they were a little bit more inclusive in terms of their language and bringing you know diverse groups in is are they best in class and what makes them better than us uh you know i don't know what our goal is when we say we want to be best in class and i understand the phrase that's caught on you know we want to teach history full and fair and you know all that stuff but again i don't know what that means in terms of the documents how do we compare ourselves to other people and how do we

[06:25:23] compare ourselves to uh you know what we have you know we have a document this morning we've already apologized twice for and said the omissions were inadvertent right uh well actually three juneteenth king day uh and you know having indigenous people refer to as immigrants i don't know how

many more items like that are in this. And that's because we haven't gone through the exhaustive review, frankly, that Cristania and her team did on the August version. And so although I can read this and say, well, yeah, this all makes sense to me, I can't read it and tell you it's the right

[06:26:01] document for the Commonwealth to teach history from. And that's troublesome to me. And candidly, I understand the idea of bringing in groups that we don't know exactly who they are, But that is troublesome to me also. I mean, we ought to be able to weigh, you know, sort of the points of view.

[06:26:21] And that is a known thing as we teach. You know, we're moving toward more fact and less inquiry. I don't know if that really is best in class. I will tell you that of the educators who have called me, uniformly they say, for example, that the sequencing in elementary school is inappropriate.

[06:26:41] Can I tell you why? Honestly, I can't, right? not my field of expertise you want to know how to build a building i can tell you that you want to know you know how to build these standards not my thing uh but i have to rely upon people who you know we respect and who call in and say hey sequencing is wrong we're not teaching what we need to be teaching you know that way is on me and i you know i guess this is the very long-winded answer to your question but i'm not sure where we're going from here because i don't believe that this board ought to legitimately put out this document as the work of the board, given the length of time or lack thereof we've had to review it.

[06:27:21] And frankly, given the absence of transparency with regard to how it got to where it got from where it was when the direction was separate out the framework from, you know, the standards.

[06:27:38] And, you know, it's, I mean, you guys know I like to move things through. And it bothers me when we get this far behind and really seem to still be meandering in the wilderness. Anyway, I know, Mr. Dr. Mann, you have some.

[06:27:55] Well, I think there's two things here, though, President Geck. I want to take your set of questions there, which I'm sure people want to respond to. Mine was just a little different just in terms of getting materials like this to the board in ample time and all that, which is a subset of a larger thing.

[06:28:15] this process and getting stuff we've said we're going to have for the public in time, it's been a far from perfect process, and my question was more about that, and to your point, at some point, we're going to adopt standards, and so what's the process going to be to make sure we're sort of stepping up our game around that? That was more, and then I think you have a second, you then introduced a second set of issues. I will do my normal quietness now and wait for you guys to finish. I'm sorry about the intrusion into the discussion. Dr. Mann? I actually think your comments were

[06:28:52] spot on and clarifying. I think that's what the unrest has been like, trying to really appreciate how we got here based on what I understood we were trying to accomplish. And it does feel challenging to think about how do we get how do we get forward? I know we have a timeline that talks about that but i think in light of the things that you articulated um it was just very very important clarifying i think dr bird has a suggestion so since i've been in the middle of

[06:29:32] this messy process as well pardon me yeah we can barely hear you the light's on can you not hear me can everyone can everyone hear me now so um for those of you who don't know me i'm sheila bird Carmichael. I have been doing standards curriculum and assessment development for, oh gosh, at least 20, if not 30, 30 years, I think now, and was a teacher before that. I'm also a mom and a Virginian, and happily, but with a little trepidation, I came into this process, as I said,

[06:30:07] in the middle of the movie, but I've seen this movie many, many times. This process is always passionate messy political and in spite of all that I think there is a way out of this so if you'll just sort of let me spew a little bit about that I think maybe you can come out of today in a good place I was asked to review the August version of the draft standards that you received and make comments about that hold in some experts so I can talk about that to get more input and

[06:30:44] the result of that is that document that you received recently and about which so many people spoke passionately this morning I think at the end of this hurried process recently you have a document that has omissions and errors similarly after two years and hundreds of people participating you had a document that was that had omissions and errors and problems so I have a hundred percent support the assertion that the process is important because this is a public process it has to be there have to be many many voices involved and

[06:31:23] everybody has to feel good about the product at the end of the day some people say the messier the product the messier the process the better the product I'm not so sure about that but what I would say if I were if I were sitting on this board today is which is the better product going forward which is the product that is going to be easier to refine and and fix to use that word in a timely way that everyone's gonna feel good about supporting and I would suggest that although the most recent process has been hurried and maybe there haven't been as many voices included as I would have liked as a

[06:32:01] professional in the process I think there's still time for that and I would recommend that you go forward with the document that you have knowing that the content in the curriculum frameworks from the August version about which I think you heard mostly today I think I haven't seen all of it but the feedback I've seen suggests that people are assuming that content has been taken out when it has not it was in the framework they don't necessarily understand the difference between standards and curriculum and I can go on about that if you want me to but I don't think you want me to do that um standards are the

[06:32:38] what curriculum is the how and I think what we have in the August document is a whole lot of how a lot of immeasurable and honorable but immeasurable expectations for for life goals for our students and not necessarily specific content and skills that teachers can take action to convey to kids so I would move forward for you I would take this document I would take what's what's in the curriculum frameworks from the previous version I would do the best job

[06:33:14] you can of pulling out the best of both those both of those documents getting more voices involved which is possible we reached out to a number of experts in this process that could simply just said that it's not enough time and I was very sympathetic to that because I feel the same way but they are people that are willing to do that going forward and I and I think that I would allow that to happen and trust that the amazing staff here and with help from people like me and other other advisors from from the world who've done this many many times

[06:33:53] you can end up with it with a document that you can be all everyone can be happy with just ask you which state do you think is the best history standards right now right now right now who's got the best there are a number of Massachusetts is good believe it or not Washington DC I mean I don't know I would not not believe it so I mean well it's a complicated place I mean I was Born and raised in DC, although I have deep roots in Virginia I thought you were in Stanton now. Aren't you in Stanton? I have been living in Stanton for the last However old my daughter is 14 years 13 years

[06:34:27] Visit us at the villages. Pardon me? Come visit us at the villages at Stanton. Oh, yeah, that's right. That's right. It's a great place So I think so would you model off of Massachusetts as a starting point, you know I think it's always smart to do that to look at how other people have done it but you guys need to feel good about what this document says and does.

[06:34:49] And I think that the, I mean, it sounds trite, but I really think the truth is somewhere in between. Between the document that is full of what, there's an education historian you all probably know of Diane Ravitch used to call taught sociology. And this has been happening since the thirties when they formed, when social studies came into being.

[06:35:08] And we lost history, geography, and civics to something called social studies, which has become a very bloated and kind of a vague field um it's not always clear what the history is what the geography is what the civics is we've we've moved into a place where um the skills absent of content but in and of themselves are leading our children bereft actual content knowledge and i understand the goal of wanting kids to to be able to learn and hone and apply those skills but they can't be taught in isolation

[06:35:49] kids can't think critically about nothing they have to have something to think critically about so i think with the two documents that you have there's there is a happy spot in between and if we move forward with more voices very good transparency i think in in very short order i don't see any reason why you couldn't have um a decent draft more of a final draft than what you have today in either of those documents by january there's so many documents there's no clarifier comment about two documents so you said the two documents we have pulling out the best of both

[06:36:26] you're i think you were talking about the curriculum framework from august and the standards that so you're you're saying again i heard you say that we need to pull the best out of both documents to be able to move forward that's my professional opinion yes and i don't think it's impossible to do i really don't i mean it's people are we're very passionate about these things but i think you know we can also be reasonable if we sit down together and work it out it's very interesting what you mentioned about uh social studies being lumped together because growing up in india and having studied in india we always had we were taught history we were

[06:37:06] taught geography we were taught civics and there were three different teachers they would come in teachers and so this was very unique to me for my children to see this kind of education so i can um can read you just an extra I pulled this out because it just it holds up so well over time what miss rabbits wrote in I forget what year this was but she talks about the research that she began in the 80s about history instruction in the United States and she said this curriculum with me my family my school my community now dominates the early grades in American public education it

[06:37:42] contains no mythology legends biographies hero tales or great events in the life of this nation or any other. It has taught sociology. And its intent was during the progressive era, right, to bring, make education more practical, right?

[06:37:58] To equip students to go out into the world and make a mark. And while I understand that goal and I appreciate that goal, I think what happens far too often in standards document is that the statements themselves end up being really empty of any content that's really actionable, even though that's the goal.

[06:38:19] So for example, this is just the first, literally open any page. This is the first one I pulled up when I was making notes for this morning. In first grade, in the August document, we're asking students to

demonstrate skills for historical thinking, geographic analysis, economic decision-making, and responsible citizenship by determining cause and effect of what, I'm not sure, to analyze multiple connections between past and present.

[06:38:47] I don't know how anybody does that. I don't know how an adult does that without a predicate, right? There's no, the cause and effect of what? And I don't mean to sound critical, but it's frustrating for me as someone who's been doing this for so long that we're still in a place where we're expecting children to do this instead of to appreciate what I know from my teaching experience, my experience as a mother, you know, that young children love great stories.

[06:39:14] Great history is great stories of the great people and the bad people too, of history, right? We need compelling storytelling and content to capture kids' imaginations.

[06:39:31] It's a little bit like in English where we have skills-based standards that say, today we're gonna determine how to find the main idea. And maybe you read a paragraph about police dogs and the next day you read a paragraph about firefighters.

[06:39:46] What is compelling to children about that, right? What are they learning when they're being asked to just find the main idea? Wouldn't they much rather, from their perspective, wouldn't they rather read a great story about a great American? I don't know.

[06:40:01] Jackie Robinson jumps off the page to me because I recently did a curriculum unit on him with a bunch of different types of texts, fiction and nonfiction. And that I've seen in classrooms, that's compelling. I've seen kids in kindergarten have Socratic seminars, interesting discussions where they have to talk about a text, a common text that they've read, analyze that text, make assertions about their opinions and support them with evidence from the text, grounded in text, it's tethered to content.

[06:40:30] So I understand the goal of this, but I think that there has to be a balance. And I'll end by just, I often quote the Dalai Lama who I think is sort of in a category, it's Dalai Parton and people that everybody loves. He said of enlightenment.

[06:40:49] He said, we must not confuse our goal, which is enlightenment, with the standards by which we judge our success toward meeting that goal. And I think in standards writing, we often, we're so passionate about the goals, what we want kids to do, the habits of mind we want them to have, that we confuse those goals with more specific, more teachable, more measurable standards that are gonna help our children get to that goal that I think in almost every case, I think we all share.

[06:41:18] - That paragraph was from kindergarten, right? - First grade. - First grade, okay. It's interesting because, so when I read that paragraph, and I think it's something not terribly different in kindergarten, I went over those paragraphs over and over and I asked my family, do you think it's, how do you measure these goals?

[06:41:40] How do you, it's just so, so confounding i i couldn't believe teachers what teachers would take out of that so yeah anybody else on these standards do you worry i take your point on the previous one that's something i i agree with and i do think like kids need content and then that's how you learn to think critically and there's there's there's abundant research on this it's one of these ones we keep in the education we keep fighting about it's an old story yeah um yeah speaking of old

[06:42:18] stories right um uh content matters but do you worry on the new standards it seems like there are places where to create that content we've got like lists of stuff yeah that are not all sort of equal and in importance and like yes okay because it seems like one of the things that seems like this might need is is some of that stuff needs to probably come out so that needs to go in like there's some of them are actually i think really good but some of them i was like this all these things are not like on this list you know I wholeheartedly agree I think that I don't want to get too technical but in standards where we talk about grain size some of the standards are lengthy and have long lists of names some are

[06:42:57] very short some are more skills based more content based it's it's messy right now I mean I would say that this draft is more like a first draft than a final for sure but I think that it is an easier draft to refine than the 400 page conflated standards and curriculum framework that we had even even even when they're take pulled apart so thank you I try really hard to listen and

[06:43:34] listen and listen and formulate some some thoughts and ideas here appreciate timeline i've also you know my i've been keeping track of our timeline the things that we've said each meeting because i want to make sure that we we do what we say and and so yeah thank you for coming back to this slide because i want to get to that just a moment but i also remember that you know in august when christine and her team presented the process every one of us was very impressed with the high level participation collaboration and work that we we were like wow that has been a massive and respectable and commendable undertaking that same meeting uh the

[06:44:09] governor came and and visited with us and he asked he said i would like all of virginia's history to be taught the good and the bad and so i i took that as as a affirmation that what we were doing was the right thing so so that was important i think that the extreme and understandable dissatisfaction that we we heard today about the november document um it is by itself because the november document i think we just kind of established here by itself does not achieve that objective because it leaves people questioning are we going to teach all of history the good and

[06:44:48] the bad and so you know we just heard the idea of pulling out the best of both of both documents i think the the concerns uh address or we're largely what we're hearing is many of the concerns raised today are being addressed by assurances that they will be in the standard framework these things will be in the framework but those were not posted and that gets into some of this process challenge we have that the framework examples were not in a timely manner we did also at one point decouple in september the the standards from the framework which i think was appropriate but i i think we've created a problem here because i did not understand in decoupling

[06:45:26] that we were creating two timelines i envisioned these being two trains running on parallel tracks at approximately the same rate of speed and i think that's kind of where maybe some of and andy you hit on the idea of mr rogham you you hit on the idea of confusion we i think we've created the conditions for confusion and so whatever we can move forward now will benefit mightily from having a curriculums framework associated with it um i think next summer for the curriculum framework is too late i if the framework is the tool to kind of make this right then we're going to need it sooner and again we've been dealing with this challenge of time

[06:46:06] and capacity all the way through the the august documents have been out there since august people reference them today so there's certainly you know people working from them looking at them uh the november document has only recently been available but um i keep hearing again that the frameworks

are essential and the idea of pulling out the best of both documents so that's that's where i'm thinking right now when i'm trying to i'm getting at process wise is how do we do pull out the best of both so that we can because because we got to get the conversation going and and we got to get the process moving again but i think that the trust earning the trust back is

[06:46:42] absolutely essential and it sounds like the framework is the way including the framework in the process on a parallel track the same rate of speed is the way to do that i could i just totally agree dr siebert i and i think when we talked last time about splitting it wasn't to have of an elongated process it was to have a simpler set of standards more sharpened to take to the public to take to the parents and to have more transparency and i think especially with the trust issue right now they've got to be on the same path as best we can maybe overlap a little bit

[06:47:23] or it cannot be this i think it's got to be at least totally congruent or at least halfway just looking at it visually because i do think that what's not here is what caused a lot of the anxiety out there and then lacking communication lacking context lacking uh and i just don't think we have that luxury anymore so i just would really second what dr siebert said if i'd like to understand if it's possible or not i think it should be but i think one of the previous slides you had what happened in 2015 but the being like a two-step two-year process

[06:48:02] that was then this is now and I just I don't think we've got that luxury I think we've got to have the content and the substance together not exactly the same path but I think they've got to be congruent yeah I'm sorry Julia I didn't realize you were responding go ahead absolutely just just a quick response and And I appreciate that, Mr. Hanson.

[06:48:27] And just to reiterate, yes, in 2015, 2016, the curriculum frameworks came out one full year later. But there was nothing developed when the standards were passed. We have a really good basis that is full of rich skills, critical thinking, inquiry-based learning, to start fleshing out the frameworks.

[06:48:52] You know, just the example that I shared today with the civil rights, again, I'm gonna go back to it. This is what was in the straight decoupled document. This is what's in now, it's richer, it's more robust.

[06:49:07] That takes some additional work on the curriculum framework to make sure that there are skills associated with each of those, as well as inquiry-based learning opportunities and perhaps resources, primary documents, et cetera.

[06:49:23] So, you know, I think when we decoupled the document, nobody quite knew what that was going to look like. And when we did decouple it, we had neither an adequate standards document nor an adequate set of curriculum frameworks.

[06:49:45] And that's where we are. So that, you know, and I don't want to fill gaps in a standards document without the input reviewers and professionals and and so we continued to work with video E staff with reviewers etc to make sure that we were able to build that standards document out the curriculum frameworks as they are today our draft frameworks and they have that additional information in them I know that that Sheila has some ideas because she's been working a little bit more on the

[06:50:19] curriculum framework regarding timeline and and trying to get those more on to parallel track if I before we get to that if I may just I'm sorry I'm sorry thank you Sheila for your that context I haven't two things I still haven't heard an answer as to who are the extra reviewers that have been involved in the

process to date so I don't know whether you're the person who can answer that or or somebody else but but adding on to that in the moving forward spirit mr.

[06:50:58] Hanson and Dr. Seberg have suggested. I heard this morning that the American Historical Association has offered twice to be of assistance to this process, hasn't yet heard back from the department, but still stands ready.

[06:51:13] I understand from previous information we've heard that they are the national experts on what history is taught, including at the higher ed level, and that they have also been intimately involved in helping write K-12 standards in a number of other states.

[06:51:30] Are they a good partner that can help us forward and help us expedite this process going forward? And would you recommend them to the department as a potential partner going forward? Or do you have concerns about them? - I think we should hear from as many people as we can with as many perspectives as we can.

[06:51:47] But I'm suggesting as a, you know, we need a primary writing partner or a primary, can they play a role in helping us resolve these multiple documents going forward? - Sure, they and many others that I think would love to be involved. - And then who are those others?

[06:52:03] - Just name some of the organizations you've already engaged with or you want to engage with. - Some of the people we've heard from and that we have reached out to more recently and tried to get input on, want to get input from on this draft are people that you would recommend, Andy recommended, I heard in the meeting recently, trying to solicit input from the Core Knowledge Foundation.

[06:52:25] We already have had input from the Fordham Institute in DC, National Association of Scholars. I think the truth is somewhere in between the National Association of Scholars and the American History Association. We, Susan Wise Bower, who is an author of the story of the world books and the well-trained mind series of texts.

[06:52:47] We've reached out to her. People at, professors from a number of different, American University, Princeton University, University of Virginia. I don't have the list in front of me.

[06:53:03] Yeah, yeah, Tim Caesar at UVA. And some of those are curriculum vendors. Am I right? I mean, have a product that they would happily sell us, sell our divisions, the Core Knowledge Foundation. Well, that's true.

[06:53:19] I think more of their expertise when I think of them in history. And I don't mean that we should discount them, but that does put an asterisk next. who's hoping to sell us a curriculum that corresponds to this standard and framework i would want to know that affiliation before i good point yeah absolutely and miss dana well i um to that point i also um and to mr hansen's earlier point about um i think i had also emailed this was while

[06:53:51] ago um to the history group um uh for the list of you know the list of members or earlier contributors in the committees i don't think i heard back about that so to your point it would be good in full transparency to have that as well and um when i got out of the august meeting um i knew i know that right away there were several problems and we talked about decoupling um the curriculum framework for the standards but i also got out of that meeting with the

[06:54:30] and with with the feeling and some of us talked about it that the content needed um edit it wasn't just a simple decoupling it there were there were several problems with the content and so that's how i felt i never got out of the august or september meetings thinking it would be a straight decoupling andy what's the best practice and grace you have do you want to go you haven't what's going to be the best practice just on the quality control questions and i don't know how

[06:55:06] like weedy we want to get but like the first draft did look the august sorry to dr siever's point there's so many of these doctors we can't say that document we gotta break the august document definitely looked to me but when i was reading it i was like this looks like it was written by committee right because and you can sort of see that in in different ways in it yeah this current version just looks like it was written like also in some cases like not necessarily by committee but a little fast and so there's like some of the stuff some of the problems we've had just today are well i would say our quality control problems another one i noticed was a document uh one of the

[06:55:43] proposed curriculum framework that i know is not trying to say there was lots of causes of the civil war the cause of the civil war was slavery but was trying to say there's you know states rights around slavery um uh you know economics of slavery you know let's try to make that point that like these things but it could read to somebody just because of how it's written that we're trying to say that like yeah there's lots of causes for the civil war besides slavery so what are we going to do to make sure that like we're not again and i'm sorry to be like a broken record that we're arguing about noise about signal not about noise because that is like that is a classic example of a noise issue because it's not what it's always intended but it's how it's going

[06:56:23] to be heard that's just about like good precise writing and good quality control and i feel like that's what's gotten us in a not insignificant amount of trouble. So my question for you is like, what is best practice so that going forward, we can keep people, I mean, I liked how you said it, that the truth is probably best between these two different groups that like, you know, battle over this. Like that's the debate to have, not the debate about imprecise writing and so forth.

[06:56:48] That's, you know, is great for social media, you know, gets lots of clicks, gets everybody excited, but it's not what we're actually talking about. So like, what have you seen in other states? like and what should we learn from so we can like what is best practice here i know i sound like a broken record but this is this is a point i'm very concerned about at this point it's a very important question um my experience is the best practice is that there's a single author listening to multiple perspectives taking in all the input and that that input is public and that that person's work is public and that everybody gets to see it and decide for yourselves ultimately like a single

[06:57:28] author who's i think a single author just in terms of um voice and and you know uh that grain size issue you know and coherence and and and some of the things that might not be clear for example in this document uh about how a con how uh content is covered from grade to grade to grade and how it how the thread goes from kindergarten through grade 12 isn't necessarily immediately obvious i saw one news piece that was doing a grade you know grade four comparison from the old document to the grade five grade four in this document and did it grade by grade by grade but there was no

[06:58:04] sort of comprehensive look at how content was treated across grade levels and where something might have been moved from one grade to another um i think that it looks to me as if the the staff in the first version did a really really thorough job of trying to be clear about what had changed why

and what had moved and why it's really really hard to follow but but at least with is seemingly transparent I think that's the best path forward that we know who's contributing input somebody is taking the input writing it all down and you can hold someone accountable okay and then my I guess my follow-up and this is I hopefully a question little warm our president's

[06:58:42] heart it's about process is there any state you've seen that's done that process particularly so I'm not talking about like who's got the best standards the highest whatever but just like I'm process anyone's especially well and have you seen anywhere where it's gone off the rails and you would advise us to not but like where it's got where it's like gone off for reasons that we can like avoid I you know I'm hard-pressed to think of any one particular example I in the end the the proof is the product right and some and sometimes in some cases with a bad process you get a good product there are people tell you that they love the new Louisiana standards I'm not necessarily sure that the process

[06:59:22] they used was was all that good even though you might like the content in the product I can just say from my own experience that it works best when there's a single author taking an input and and everything is transparent no it's a hard it's a hard thing and it just and I'm just trying to figure out how we don't I want people in here talking about issues of concern and disagreement not in here because they are confused or because there's you know as you said, errors and omissions.

[06:59:55] - I want to just add to that and say, I think it depends on what metric we're using for success. Is it a unanimous board vote? Is it, you know, a quantity of 42 page document versus a 700 page document?

[07:00:11] Is it a Fordham rating? Is it an article by a renowned historian? So I think thinking about the metric for success is it makes the answer to that question really, really different. I think, and President Gecker and I are probably not the same in this respect, but I think oftentimes out of complexity comes simplicity. And out of sort of this messiness and chaos and hard, hard conversations that we're

[07:00:46] having today comes a clear eye for moving forward. And I agree with Sheila that having a single author um uh to to incorporate changes and then having a you know you all laid out the process in in january of 2021 and i think it's just two bullets uh review the input follow the law and uh and and convene people as needed to double check facts and accuracy it's led by the staff though and um so you know we we certainly that that's the that's what the board put forth and that's what

[07:01:23] but we'll continue to follow with the additions that we've talked about today. But as I talk to my colleagues across the nation, I'm more convinced that sort of out of that messiness and chaos comes some clarity and comes good standards that everyone can be happy with.

[07:01:42] But again, it depends on what your metric for success is. Not everyone will be happy with every single standard. You know, maybe even not up on this dais, what we do want is to have a really clear picture of the learning goals for our students in history, civics, geography, and economics. And we want to make sure that we teach history comprehensively.

[07:02:10] I did just want to make sure, thank you so much for all the conversation. I've definitely been listening quite carefully. I did just take a moment too to go back to the July presentation that had 75 slides in it that actually listed out all of the groups that were participants to the work and i do think it's important to note that there was a parent advisory committee included in this effort so and as much as it seemed that perhaps parents did not participate i really did want the record to reflect that based on that presentation we had in july

[07:02:50] it does show that there's a parent advisory committee educators represented the largest group of participants on the uh really when i look across the 211 people who were a part of the various committees that participated educators and i do think there is something to be said for educators who are actually subject matter experts in the work that they do and the importance of valuing that perspective they were the largest representative group that participated in the process along with a number of other committees and while you know the names aren't here i'm sure

[07:03:29] we could get the names but there is a very clear roadmap that identifies the voices that were part of the process and again i think it's so important to keep articulating that because we want people to know that we do understand that there has been broad input in this we don't want people to feel like um it didn't matter and i know that's not what you're saying but when we say that we have

[07:04:01] to keep going back out and out for more input i just don't want that the implication of that to reflect something that isn't your intentions as you are speaking about the importance of voice yeah and another yes and moment and the the parent advisory committee was one that i asked staff to include when i came on board as well as the community engagement sessions so um yes that that was um and remains a really important voice and so again it's a yes and not an either or yeah

[07:04:39] of course and the characterization of sort of the january 2020 time frame was a little abbreviated i mean it's a five-page document that details what's going to happen when and who's going to be involved you know it's not just we'll go seek input it's very specific as to whose input the formation of the practitioners committee the looking at the virginia social studies leaders groups you know museum people it's it's really a little unfair to characterize it as well we'll get input and then we'll modify it you know it's it's a little bit short form and really it does an injustice to staff's work on this over the last two years who followed a framework that was

[07:05:18] approved by the board to march down gather really a significant amount of public and practitioner input to come up with the documents that we saw in august so you know i just couldn't let that that particular comment sit grace yeah so um i guess sitting back and hearing all of this it kind of brings me back to our original point here and that is that we we have to be while all of these external groups are really great to inform the content, it's extremely important for us to remember exactly why this document is in place.

[07:05:57] This document is in place to drive instruction, to assist teachers and students in classrooms every day, and having been a part of external review committees and been the practitioner in the classroom that was contributing to the outcome it is absolutely crucial for teachers who are doing this work every day to understand i mean we can sit up here and argue about politics

[07:06:33] or process or whatever it is we want to we want to talk about as it relates to this but at the end of the day if if what we produce is successful for the best possible student outcomes the best teaching in the country then that's where i want to be and so if we can marry these these things bring it all together and and come up with a product that is absolutely something that everyone

[07:07:08] can be proud of students and parents and teachers can all use effectively with our very brightest students and our most challenged students that's where that is the crux of this entire process in my opinion let me ask grace you know i know it's rude to ask a board member this but i'm going to ask you anyway or actually i shouldn't jillian what's wrong with the 15 standards In other words, the 2015 standards, you know, where are we trying to improve?

[07:07:47] What are we not doing well in the view of the education community under the 15 standards that the 22 standards? You know, our statutory requirement is not to revise, it's to review. That's why I was going to ask you originally, Grace, and I just thought that would be rude.

[07:08:06] But I knew you'd want to answer it. Yeah, you know, I just can't avoid answering this question for you. So, I don't, I mean, I'm not going to sit here and specifically point out what is actually wrong with that document, because, I mean, I was part of authoring that document, so I'm not going to speak too poorly about it.

[07:08:25] Perfect, yes. However, what I will say is this. I think the reason, you know, part of the discussion in August was this is our responsibility to move, and that's why we have moved.

[07:08:42] And I don't think part of that August discussion ever brought to bear the opportunity to, you know, even look at the 2015 for amendments, edits, whatever, however.

[07:08:58] So at that point, that really wasn't germane to the discussion, if you will. But we are where we are now. And we're talking about actually, you know, with straight faces, taking two disparate documents and trying to merge them somehow and saying it's going to be better than what we have.

[07:09:15] And, you know, candidly, I'm not sure that that really is the answer here. I would like to, I mean, I understand, for example, because when Governor Northam put together the African American History Education Committee, right, they came back to the board with a bunch of proposed changes and, you know, to include, you know, a more full view of history, right, that the 15 standards didn't have.

[07:09:45] There were a list of things. and, you know, you can agree with all of them, you can agree with some of them, doesn't matter, but there was a list of things, and, you know, rightfully or wrongly, I said, you know, we have a process for this, we're going to go through the process, and changes to the standards will be considered as part of that process. So that's one area where I know we believed that the, or at least a, you know, segment of the population, including me, believed that the 2015 standards were lacking in terms of their overall inclusiveness, right? We've heard from the Asian, you know, Pacific island groups that have said, we have not been treated fully and fairly in the Virginia history

[07:10:22] curriculum, and we'd like inclusion. And they came up with specific suggestions, which were incorporated through the process, right? We have seen greater talk about civil rights, right? And the impact, you know, in different civilizations that had contributions to the world other than, you know, the Byzantine Empire. And, you know, we wanted to include those. But believe it or not, it would help me and uh you know to understand what other areas and i think staff could probably

[07:10:56] do this i bet you christianya knows this what areas were considered lacking in 2015 that were going to be augmented by those various groups that contributed so that we could actually see what it is what we were looking to do make that full and fair out in the public and then see whether or not those you know concerns were in the eyes of the board legitimate for inclusion in the virginia curriculum so one thing i will i will point out is that in 2015 um we previously had prescriptions on

[07:11:36] course progression where we do not post 2015. that becomes a problem which i have heard repeatedly from the field because you get students who are um you know coming from one division to another and so for example my my uh content was civics we we had school divisions that taught civics in seventh grade school divisions that taught civics in eighth grade and so when we had a student that came from a school division in eighth grade and we were

[07:12:13] teaching civics they they had civics in seventh grade but they're coming to the division that teaches it in eighth grade they had to repeat the course there was no other means by which to satisfy that that course progression scenario that's just one thing off the top of my head that I can point out from a kind of one of the coordinators who called you know was talking about I don't understand the technical issues of this but you know in the middle schools because we're not requiring sequencing anymore there might be no teachers who are endorsed to teach the particular courses that they're looking I don't know again out of

[07:12:47] area of expertise but it's one of those things we need to look at in the overall view in terms of sequencing but in terms of content you know is it possible christina to understand you know to do it at the podium but a simple yes or no would do to have an understanding of those areas of content that we believe were lacking or that people believed were lacking not the board but the general community in 2015 so the board could have a list to see where what we were looking to boost when we embarked upon this project in 2020 i think that um the best way to answer that is

[07:13:26] that's the big purpose of the crosswalk and you're able to see from the crosswalk what is there for the 2015 standards and then not necessarily um that content moved but what content is now there or what content may have been removed so the crosswalk really helps it helps visualize that but in terms of understanding what the drivers were i mean we put out how many kids under the 2015 standards you know 100 000 graduates a year so all right we're moving on close to 750 million

[07:14:05] graduates from who have been through the 15 standards do we think that they were inadequately educated in social studies? I'm going to answer no to that. I would answer no to that also. That's a good answer. And so that doesn't mean the 15 document doesn't need improvement or enhancement. And what I'm looking for is from staffs, you, based upon the two years of input you took, or a year and a half of input you took, what areas were highlighted as needing improvement in the 15 standards? Again, I don't expect it from here because I'm not going to write it all down, but could you?

[07:14:38] thank you and I have glasses on and good and not able to really see I wish somebody would hand me a phone before I talked but the what we saw mainly was with the expansion of the external committees and looking more at the cultural organizations that we included that had not been included it during the 15 review we separated those external committees so that we could bring more groups in and we found

[07:15:13] out mainly from the ahag commission that this is not just african-american history but from that committee we learned that we really do need to think about bringing in more groups and how that content is couched in um in the standards so cultural looking at cultural history versus just the um sequence of events for example for the civil for the civil rights movement as a matter of fact what's on the screen not just those events that happened but how did those events

[07:15:53] impact groups of people and we we really wanted to look at who are those people and how are they being impacted politically economically civically um so probably that's the biggest thing that we learned going into the review of the 15 standards really looking at that culture cultural history that the standards may have been lacking before and we tried to remedy that by bringing in the external group that was all about the cultural organizations that typically i guess would have

[07:16:32] impacted the later grade standards as opposed to all of the earlier grades typically yes because the k3 standards have traditionally provided a foundation for content and skills and the skills are taught

through the content they're not taught in isolation of content so if you take a look at the 15 standards i guess the only holiday we're missing that we might want in here is juneteenth yes as an example but other than that we didn't forget to include martin luther king day right

[07:17:05] right and and even looking at um with dr king the holiday in kindergarten first second and third grade but because we were moving from that community state country world you would learn about dr king himself in second grade and the impact on this country and in k3 we're still teaching or at least since we're under the 15 standards patriotism and the glory of america i

[07:17:38] take it i mean yes yes i mean k11 k.11 student will develop an understanding of how communities express patriotism yes events and symbols again sort of the common things recognizing the flag recognizing the pledge of allegiance knowing the president things like that yes sir go ahead miss holden i know i'm not going to be able to keep you quiet well i i i do still have longer remarks that i'd like to make at the appropriate time but actually this is just a quick question for uh christina you just made a reference to the the approach of kindergarten community

[07:18:13] in kindergarten uh virginia in first grade nation in second grade little mini world history in third grade if i understand correctly that's in the 2015 standards and that's in is maintained that approach is maintained in the august 22 draft am i correct yes ma'am and i'm not going to ask you this my comment would be i don't think that approach is maintained in the november draft but that we can and discuss amongst ourselves thank you can i move walk away yeah it's probably safe to move unless you want to hand me your phone in which case i'll know what to say

[07:18:57] have we exhausted this for the moment anybody want to take five minutes maybe all of us still have one more round my guess would be fair enough let's uh do 10 minutes

[07:19:13] we'll be back you know 4 12. uh the superintendent would like to make a few comments so jillian i

[07:33:25] will be very brief um now that i'm back up on the dais and first of all just thank the board members for such um careful and thoughtful deliberation um as i said before i think that sometimes these these conversations and and periods of time are um difficult and chaotic but i am a firm believer that these are the exact discussions that lead to really great product and policy so thank you so much for being deliberative for being thoughtful um and for being civil we are modeling uh well for for the children in virginia today um and every day that i've been a part of this board

[07:34:03] um secondly i you know i i want to own um the the videoe has lots and lots and lots of initiatives and balls in the air right now and um and this is a process that certainly uh over the the last few months has um me reflecting on how we can improve the process going forward and probably as chris donya experienced uh before i came and certainly as i experienced in the state where i used to be the chief um and and that you all reflected today that process is usually very you do this at this

[07:34:39] month this at this month this at this month so thank you for your benevolence in um in allowing us to make sure that those additional voices were heard that the additional uh work was done and um and so so that said um you know i think it's important to to find our pathway forward uh for for the exact reasons that grace stated um and that is we want every single student in virginia to have to continue to have access to the very best history civics geography and economics education possible so i just wanted to um to say that uh you know going forward um again

[07:35:17] this has been an opportunity for me to reflect as the state superintendent and um and and just making sure that uh that transparency remains that process is clear and um and that it's articulated and that uh you know uh that that i state the adequate time that we need to get the work that we need to be done instead of um or that to get the work done that we need to have done instead of saying um i think we can get it done by then and then we're rushing to get that done because we've got a lot of other things going on and it turns out that it was a really tight

[07:35:56] timeline for the important work that's going on and that's a a reflection for me professionally and a reflection in or in and a commitment going forward it's crazy i'd really like to bring this discussion home if i may love to see the effort so yes let's do this um so uh mr president what i would like to do is make a motion uh to direct the superintendent and the department to combine

[07:36:30] the 11-8 framework and the 11-11 standards and ask them to additionally engage in whatever way they see fit with the american historical association to help us ensure that the end of this um this product is the best in class the curriculum framework that was the 11-8 framework

[07:36:59] that is remember my questions earlier that is come from the august document i'm a little bit confused as the superintendent so okay so remember my question a few minutes ago which was the curriculum framework that is in our board book right now that has kindergarten through whatever that came from the august document see we have all of these documents it is decoupled

[07:37:35] It's the other side of the decoupled document the frameworks the the parking lot of frameworks, right? Correct. So is everyone on the same page with me where I am now if I might offer a friendly amendment Okay, that we use because the public action actually seen any of that. It just got added to our board works at lunchtime I don't even know if it's been posted yet, but that perhaps we could refer to the August 22 version But designated as decoupled a decoupled version Okay, this is a different way for a second grace. Okay is it you're looking to accomplish then let's make the motion like what's the end product look like

[07:38:14] and are you looking to figure out what the board is going to put out to public comment around the state yeah board's public comment not the department's public comment so so in other words what I want to have happen is the standards that we have that were presented to us today that goes into the curriculum framework that is what we've seen in our board book but is not I guess out there for public consumption so I don't know how how that appears in the public right now to be able to give you I guess the better an

[07:38:52] area and you guys a clarifying question so you're because these are the ones that they're from August they're now up on our board page and in our electronic board books but that happened during this meeting so I haven't had I haven't had a chance to go through them They're there. They're the ones from August. Is that correct? That's correct And these are the ones that that I believe board members received several weeks ago through a request by a By a board member and they're not changed. I I only shared the October standards. I didn't share the October framework. Okay, okay

[07:39:31] so and and what is in the frameworks as as Cristania confirmed today is the the other side of the decoupled document what what I'm not sure I understand is What you mean by combined? So so I would offer again a friendly amendment to say I think it would be a lot clearer if we say send out the August 22 document and the

[07:40:05] November 22 document in tandem for public comment and you're saying miss Holton the new Sounds this is so confusing you're saying the august decoupled document. Yes Okay, but but both the standards component and the framework component thereof Okay, that's yeah, that's why it's not a friendly amendment. Okay, then I withdraw it as a friendly amendment But I'm sorry. Go ahead. No, no, go ahead. No to your point Um, I think one of the things that's been difficult to map to the point that Ann was trying to Note in them in an amendment We now have two different documents.

[07:40:43] We have a document that we received today. We have the August document. It's been very difficult to understand between the two of them, how they relate. And I think since they're both different, if we were to simply accept all the track changes in the August 20th document, along with what has been produced today, so that there's an opportunity to really see and appreciate what's between these two documents to inform what the

[07:41:16] third iteration of this is going to look like have we seen the red line copy no right i mean i guess the difficulty i'm having grace is as i said before i don't believe that we ought to put out the document that was delivered let's say last friday right the one that's in the board book today as the standards as a board document for public comment at this point because honestly we We have not, I mean, maybe you guys have, but I haven't had the time to really go through it, to understand, we took, you know, four hours, three hours of public comment, most of which was negative.

[07:41:51] Every educator I've talked to has been negative about it, which is not to say it's been an exhaustive list of educators, but everybody who's called has been negative, which is not unusual. We had a, you know, close to two year process that generated a document with a lot of input that clearly followed a board mandated process.

[07:42:11] And now what we're saying is we're going to go to the public for the last round of public hearing on a document that we don't even know what changed from our original document to this document. I mean, I would rather put this off than go out with the last Friday document, the one we got, you know, in conjunction with this meeting as the board's work product.

[07:42:35] Because I don't believe it is. Well, I shouldn't say that. I don't know if it is the board's work product. I know it is the product of the department taking what the board's process produced and changing it, maybe, or maybe it was original drafting. I don't even know that. And for us to turn around in essentially six days, five days, six days, you know, and I think as Dr. Siebert once mentioned during the course of one of these meetings, you know, 30 days wasn't enough for new board members to review the old document.

[07:43:09] And now what we're saying is that in a five-day turnaround, you're expecting the board to adopt this as ours. And I just don't think that's right. Now I need to have some understanding, because what I thought I asked earlier, what I thought the answer was, that the advice was that we pull out the best of both documents.

[07:43:28] And what I thought pulling out the best of both documents was that we get the framework from the August draft, have that and the November standards, because we talked about the confusion and that the concerns raised about the November standards are reportedly addressed in the framework.

[07:43:52] So that's where my thought was if the standards and the framework would move forward, now we have public comment that represents the work of both worlds. In fairness to the department, The

August framework is not the framework they're proposing for the November standards, and they don't match up I mean, you know in grade 3 point 1 in the frameworks We're talking about the Constitution and in the standards. We're talking about European rivers I mean they they just they don't work together view it as such a breach of faith with the public to do what you're suggesting

[07:44:31] You know we and again I acknowledge the change in membership and composition of the board and I'm willing to take the time Needed to reconcile the differences created by that but for us to now turn around after having announced a public process in 2020 2021 21. Yeah And tell the public that based upon you know six days of review. This is now the board product I think is You know again, and you've heard me say this before one of my goals as a board member and as president of this board Has been to elevate the stature of this board to one that thinks seriously about policy

[07:45:11] And I don't think that any of us can say with a straight face that we've had enough time to go through You know in a in the six days that we've had at the documents provided by the department To say that we are in fact a body that studies things and this is not you know let's not have the perfect be the enemy of the good this is geez between what we did yesterday and what we're doing today you know and our other lives i just don't believe that any of us have had the time to adequately absorb and analyze you know what's before us and i appreciate miss dada's

[07:45:46] point before well it reads okay it may well right but that doesn't mean if you read it a second time or a third time and compared it to the august document that you wouldn't find things that you you would say, gee, this is interesting too, maybe this ought to be incorporated into what the board's putting out.

[07:46:02] This to me is no way to run the railroad, in other words. You know, and I accept the fact that the votes may be there to push this through, but I will tell you, you know, it is heartbreaking to me to see a board that has been steeped in studied, research-based, you know, evidence-based policy come down to putting out a document as if it's ours five days review with absolutely no idea how we got there and frankly no idea what's changed from the original document that was ours to this one however you do have a motion that you're making

[07:46:40] so you're entitled to do that and let's see where we go i i have a question and maybe it's for you miss bellow but just and for my colleagues i mean my i have a couple of principles here i think one the governor said best standards that should be our north star second minimizing confusion and then third moving this process forward like so I'm curious like how does if we put out the two if we put out the two documents so then we would basically I

[07:47:16] think get a lot of feedback probably in the I would assume I can't prejudge it in the vein of I like this I don't like this I want this and I want this out like how does that in terms of moving the process for is that does that does that how does that fit with not creating confusion and moving the process forward is that is that you're sort of out of messiness we could get some order or out messiness do we get more messiness okay I think there were a whole bunch of questions in that that question so yeah well my question I mean I'm just telling you where I'm coming from in terms of my things like how does that does this in your view like miss crazy's amendment does that help us with confusion and

[07:47:56] does that give us good actionable feedback or does it not move the process so I'm gonna I'm gonna back up to just a couple of things that I think I've I've heard sort of a bantered about and one is

going forward with two documents to the public I think that that would be a mistake because Public comment would be around which one are you voting for?

[07:48:22] versus What what do we do with this with this document to make it the best that it can be so that's one issue and I Absolutely would not recommend going forward with two documents the second thing my question you're saying, just be clear, we wouldn't get the picking and choosing feedback, we would just get two versions and comments on them? Unless we're directed otherwise. You know, I think that's what I'm looking for today is some direction, whether that's accepting for first review or, you know,

[07:48:57] some pointed direction in terms of moving forward. We've placed a document for consideration for first review today it's obviously the the purview of the board or the purview of the president whether or not that's accepted and and along with that is what I would hope or what I would hope is that along with that first review comes some really pointed and specific directive for us as we undertake public

[07:49:28] comment input and and move forward with how to to uh how to move forward the second thing uh is is i want to make sure that um we're able to capture that other half of the document the well it's more than half of the document the curriculum framework part of the document and um i i hear loud and clear that this board is committed to making sure that that content doesn't go away and um so i think that as I just sort of maybe read between the lines of Grace's motion,

[07:50:07] I'm not sure if this is something that would be desirable, but a commitment from this board or directive from this board that we use those curriculum frameworks moving forward and align those to whatever the final standards document is.

[07:50:23] And so, and that that's the basis for it. It's solidifying that the basis for the curriculum frameworks. They're not aligned right now. They're not being presented as curriculum frameworks for you all to consider for first review or to vote on.

[07:50:40] You know, we simply can't do that. And I hate to bring this up again, but 2015, one year later, one year after the standards are developed, the curriculum frameworks are in place because we need the standards to be able to fully align and develop the curriculum frameworks.

[07:50:57] We've got a good start, it's not gonna take a year, but we need that time. So looking for some of that direction in terms and commitment from the board, which could be solidified or it could just be saying, please use that document, which we will, and maybe that provides a path forward.

[07:51:18] Which document are we going, which standards document do, not which, you only have one in front of you, but do we use the standards document in front of us to move forward and make it the best that it can be and align the curriculum frameworks that already exist to that?

[07:51:38] Or do we go a different path? - So I appreciate the asking for guidance and I will say for me, I am not comfortable going forward with the November 22 standards draft as the basis for public comment and public engagement.

[07:52:00] I would prefer that we go back to the August 22 draft We could direct the staff to pull out, just simply pull the standards piece out of it, correct the typos and the specific content things that Kristania spoke to in August and September, and put that out as a basis for public comment.

[07:52:20] That would be my preference. I could also live with putting out the August version of the standards and the November version of the standards. Not curriculum framework now, but the August standards, or either the August standards and framework, but if you wanna do just standards, August standards and November standards both and get public comment on it.

[07:52:41] But if I may elaborate a little bit more and I'll try to get this off my chest and then do my best to not speak. My comments on why, I frankly think this new draft is a disaster and it starts with the very first line of the preface document, which I just, I don't know that anybody's spoken to yet, but it says Virginia's history and social science standards aim to restore excellence, curiosity, and excitement, et cetera, et cetera.

[07:53:08] I was taught by, I had teachers in the Richmond public, I mean, in the Virginia public schools who changed my life teaching me history and social studies. I had, my children had history and government teachers who changed their lives teaching history in the Virginia public schools.

[07:53:30] The work that I have seen go into this document by hundreds of historians, educators, DOE staff, et cetera, over the last two years. It is, I'm sure it's absolutely, I hope and pray that it's not intentional, but that's disrespectful to them to say that we need to restore excellence.

[07:53:52] We have excellence and we're looking to make it better. I'd like to come in a little bit on the process and then a little bit on the content, and then I want to come back to something the guiding principles document the the process where have the staff been i mean what what happened to christina brown and christine harris our long time depart they've done this process repeatedly they get us through difficult you know what what caused us to so radically depart from that process superintendent baylow has affirmed her confidence in them she's talked about how much she respects

[07:54:31] them in their work what happened to them it's disrespectful that they've disappeared the speed with which this matter has been pressed has has been disrespectful to the board and the public giving us Friday afternoon documents giving us Corrections on Monday and Corrections on Tuesday and more documents submitted to us the middle of the day today it's it's it's it's indefensible I have defended the administration's handling of this matter both publicly and privately I have told people who thought that this was all an attempt to whitewash no no no calm down we're really just trying to get it right I no longer have that confidence I no longer can say that to those folks prior

[07:55:10] commitments have repeatedly been violated and I don't mean to say that it's intentional but that's what's happened I have not read all of the the the November document one of the things we asked for and were absolutely should have had was a track changes document it would have made them so much easier to read between Friday night and this today's discussion what happened if we'd had a track changes document it's disrespectful that we haven't but with despite that I've done my best to be reading and comparing I mean the August draft also gave you track changes back to what's in the 2015 standard so if we had known what was in 2015 the comparison back to 2015 would have been

[07:55:50] helpful but so I haven't focused mostly on the early grades I have not read all the public comment we haven't even been given all we've been told that 800 public comment came in yesterday we haven't even been given it yet i will draw everybody's attention to if you haven't seen it the virginia association of social studies leaders i think the virginia social studies leaders consortium submitted comment that emily sent us this morning it's very persuasive these are the pros guys and they call this document a disaster we've heard from uh respected leaders in our legislature calling this document,

[07:56:30] calling it whitewashing. As I say, I have focused primarily on the early grades, so I want to comment a little bit on the content in the early grades. I acknowledge the department's recognition of the accident that Martin Luther King was left off the holiday list.

[07:56:48] I think this was on Tuesday, they told us that Martin Luther King and Juneteenth were accidentally left off the list. I understand that Superintendent Balo has acknowledged today that the first immigrant's reference was also an accident.

[07:57:03] The nature of the accidents in the early grades, and as I say, that's been my focus, are extreme. If you compare, simply even comparing the November draft to the 2015, the existing standards, it is a major step backwards.

[07:57:20] So for instance, grade three, as we talked earlier, grade three has always been a little mini world history. This is not a woke Northern administration document, the 2015 existing standards have us, in our many world history, have us study Greece, Rome, the Empire of Mali, China, and Egypt.

[07:57:40] It's now Greece and Rome. There's now a Egypt unit moved down to second grade where we're supposed to be studying the nation, but nevertheless, China, China, and the Emperor of Mali are gone altogether.

[07:57:56] Africa and Asia have disappeared from the elementary school curriculum. There is no discussion of Africa or Asia in the early, that the list of continents that I learned in third grade or fourth grade in my coming up, you learn the continents, right?

[07:58:11] The seven continents and the five oceans, it's gone. I'm sure that's much of that wasn't intentional, but it's just sloppy. They just, they didn't try to start with the 2015 standards. And one of the things the social studies leaders has pointed out is that this draft is such, it is such a total rewrite from 2015, unlike the August 22 draft, that it will require years of developing new curriculum and reteaching elementary school teachers who haven't had to learn about the code of Hammurabi, et cetera, et cetera.

[07:58:46] Because it, oh, in third grade, we talk about European geography. It's so Eurocentric. It's just mind bothering. second grade which in the 2015 standards again we're not talking about some recent woke document the 2015 standards in in second grade are focused on the nation that means we learn about martin luther king now we put him back on the holiday list as of yesterday but he's not back in the the the nation's leaders list that second graders are supposed to study he's not back there yet somebody made reference to jackie robinson earlier he was an exemplar of a nation leader

[07:59:23] that was in the 2015 standards and isn't here. Thurgood Marshall, Cesar Chavez, all missing from second grade standards now. What happened? First grade is Virginia history that we heard from a number of our Virginia indigenous tribes earlier today, but first grade Chief Powhatan and Pocahontas have been there forever and they're not there now. It's hard to see how you don't call that whitewashing you certainly can see why people would feel like it is as I say I haven't looked in great detail at the later grades but I did just you know

[08:00:01] we'll use a little search function I see numerous additions to Ronald Reagan added throughout the curriculum and you know Ronald Reagan deserves to be in their way where he was in the 2015 standards and in the August 22 draft as as the, for his role in ending the Cold War.

[08:00:21] Very, very significant contribution. But the six or seven additional references to Ronald Reagan, and how many references to our first African American president in a country with the original sin of slavery that continues to have the impact that it does in our nation?

[08:00:41] How many references to the first African American president, Barack Obama? Zero. I don't know how you can't call it whitewashing. No Obergefell, no reference to LGBT. I hear the superintendent saying that she's met with the Jewish community, but we heard today from the Holocaust Museum representative.

[08:01:01] And I know from my time as secretary that our Virginia standards really have been regarded as national models, the gold standard on how to address the Holocaust. Maybe it'll be added back in in the frameworks, but I can understand why people are worried.

[08:01:19] The sample, short sample curriculum frameworks we were given today, inadequate. The profile of the graduate disappeared. I could go, I mean, I could go on and on, I won't. The one I want to end on is there is language in the preface document, if I can find it, that I want to address.

[08:01:43] There's language in here that says, sorry, I'm gonna take a minute to find it.

[08:02:01] Teachers should engage students in age appropriate ways that do not, quote, ascribe guilt to any population in the classroom. Now, I'm not promoting guilt. That is not by any means the way I think students should be taught. Do you know, I have learned really, frankly, not until I was an adult, but about the impact of redlining in our country, the impact of the combination of redlining, the GI Bill, and segregated colleges, and how those things gave my family the opportunity to develop wealth such that I went to college debt-free.

[08:02:40] My children went to college debt-free. What a blessing, what an, in this day and age, an unusual accomplishment. And a lot of that was because of the GI Bill, great Virginia universities and the effects, home mortgage benefits from the federal government.

[08:03:01] All of those were my African-American counterparts who have literally one 10th of the wealth of their white counterparts across our nation. It's directly tied to that history. So suppose that a Virginia history teacher were to choose to teach about those topics in 11th grade, God forbid some white kid in that class might feel a little responsibility, might actually have some recognition that ties their personal experience of going to college debt-free when their black friends can't because of family wealth, might not only feel responsibility, might even feel a little guilt.

[08:03:41] And then is that teacher going to potentially get fired over that? Is that ascribing guilt? Well, that may seem speculative, but I tell you what, teachers are self-censoring already on this, and teachers are getting fired in other states that have adopted language about don't ascribe guilt.

[08:04:00] I'm sorry I'm so emotional about this. This is stuff I've been living since I was a child, and the fact that we are still here 60-some years later, we've made progress, no doubt we've made progress, but we've got a long way to go from removing the consequences of the original sin of racism in this country.

[08:04:21] And this document does not advance that goal. If there's some compromise that sends out both sets of documents, I could live with it. But what I would prefer is that we move forward with the work that the cast of hundreds, including thousands of parents with barely a peep of anybody.

[08:04:41] I mean, I can count on one hand the number of comments we have heard. I don't know what the superintendent's heard, but the number of comments we've heard throughout this process that says we should go forward with the November version instead of the August version. If there was a compromise that put out both documents, the standards, you know, I could live with it, but it's my preference as we go forward with the August version.

[08:05:05] Thank you. - Anybody else wanna speak on this? - Well, I think, I mean, I think this actually speaks to kind of where we are.

[08:05:22] don't disagree with with i disagree with some aspects of what miss holton said some characterizations but other parts like i i was surprised that there was no mention of lgbt uh and sort of basically just gay rights civil rights as as part of that you know with like landmark court cases for instance i and i ascribe that that like there's stuff in the curriculum framework that's gotten dropped out and i i guess i have i come to a little more grace i think what we have no pun intended um like what we have here is a is a haphazard uh process that's brought us to to where we are more than because i they're the stuff that's toggling back and forth um and

[08:05:57] so i look at other stuff like i i was surprised the scotch irish where there wasn't more on that i don't know how you really can understand virginia if you don't understand sort of the you know different kinds of people who came here we have you know it's noteworthy we talk about people who are forcibly removed uh from what's now shandoah national park which most people are sort of unaware of that but you have to sort of know know the history um there's other global stuff we could go on i think we all have i think we went around i suspect all eight of us here have stuff that were you know um uh that we're concerned about i thought it was light on some aspects of abolitionism and that movement but a lot of that stuff's in the curricular framework so is it is

[08:06:34] it really light so i think i think i think what we i think what we're what we're struggling with is less like enormous disagreements and more like a serious content management problem uh that and and you can hear that in sort of the ideas do we move two documents best i can tell i don't think there's support for moving the august document in total but we're talking about do you take out the curriculum frameworks and move those dr ballas says you didn't support that do we like just move this with some number of changes i think we'll be here for a while so i think it's a very we're struggling i think more that it's less about disagreements on a lot of this stuff and

[08:07:13] more about like how do we manage this content given where we are and the process well i think there are some disagreements but i think the thing i'm concerned about as we talk about um what to do with the curriculum framework and we sort of trust that's where it is i keep going back to or at least what i thought i heard i understood and i think this is right the framework talks about how but the content is what and if there are not references in the in the what of it

[08:07:46] the choice to sort of determine the how is is a choice it's not it's not exactly equating it with these are important things to know so that's a worry because we trust and hope that the importance of some of the things that contextualize the what are important for critical thinking and all of the other skills we've talked about so i i do think we have to be careful in in sort of saying it's

[08:08:23] all there because there will be different weights placed on what you need to know versus how you help elevate that understanding if we went with grace's approach and the lack of alignment i'm

[08:08:58] just wondering how would we could that physically be worked on over the course of the next two months while we're getting into the first phase of the comment or meetings in december but as we move into the january of um board i guess uh what are they called uh board meetings out in the field um i'm just wondering if that might still be a workable solution of course i don't know what you

[08:09:36] had in mind from having obviously the misalignment of what yeah i mean so my what i was thinking was is that that would be part of the editing process to get them aligned correct so let let me let me just take a stab at maybe a path forward um we have the curriculum frame i it's it's really important to me that um that the public understands that and and that there is a statement from this

[08:10:11] board that um that this board and and myself and our staff are committed to keeping the input the feedback from the August 2022 document that went into the curriculum frameworks so what if we moved forward with the curriculum frameworks as they are right now and not not actually make a motion to move them forward but as videoe we move forward with those and align those to the standards document to get them as um as i think it was dr siebert said to kind of get them on the same track

[08:10:49] at the same time and and based on today's discussion as well as public comment we make revisions to the standards document to bring back forward to this board as you know it obviously I'm not sure I'm just trying to see a path path forward are you suggesting that the content in the curriculum framework from august that is the document that's going to be

[08:11:25] changed is the standards document from this meeting as opposed to the curriculum framework being altered to conform in other words the document that's going to be changed to conform is the standards you're not going to change anything in the curriculum framework no that's not what i'm saying that's what i want to understand yeah and you know i don't have the slides up anymore but again going going back to uh i'll just actually look at my notes really quick we added an entire section that historians added an entire section um to u.s history since world war ii about the causes and effects of the civil rights movement that was not in the decoupled

[08:12:04] document that needs to be in the decoupled document and to miss holton's point that helps build out um the the whole the the story not just of of slavery's and of slavery and um all of all of i i'm not even going to try to encapsulate what miss holton said but everything that she said trying to build that out at different levels and at different places and this is one example an entire section of u.s history since world war ii standards are about the causes and effects of civil rights including origins of the civil rights movement evaluating the impact of martin luther

[08:12:44] king including and i won't reread oh someone put it up there the next slide all of that needs to go into a curriculum framework now so it would be a commitment to maintain what is already in the curriculum frameworks and working to align the curriculum frameworks to um to the standards document that was presented today with revisions based on the discussion and based on the public feedback just a clarifying question mm-hmm does that mean the curriculum framework for third grade for example is it going to be a mini is it going to address Mali and China or is it going to be limited to

[08:13:24] European history as the standards now are yes so and and I want to be clear about that too Mali and China aren't taken out well they are they're not in the standard they're not in that grade level well they're not anywhere in elementary school and and they they are still in the curriculum framework so if if that is something that needs to to go back into third grade and and that is is something that I heard today

from from public feedback that's something that I'm hearing from this board we absolutely will put that back in but in other words the third grade standards document says this is all about Greece

[08:13:59] and Rome the old the 2015 third grade standard says this is a mini world history covering five places from around the world so unless you were to change the grade 3 standards document from November you you know Molly doesn't fit in there there's not there's it doesn't the framework there's nothing for a framework to fill out and it's not just grade 3 this you have the same issues about grades 2 and grade 1 and kindergarten again I haven't gotten much

[08:14:30] beyond those maybe and maybe this isn't tenable but i'm just pulled up slide eight of um maybe if we can go to slide eight if somebody's controlling this um we already our next board meeting is february 1st the next board meeting after that is march 22nd 23rd um if we ask staff to work on

[08:15:05] getting these two documents aligned over the course of the next six weeks by the end of the year and we just slide this back i frankly felt like we were going to have a very difficult time getting to february 1st to begin with but and this still allows us to work on what we need to get accomplished throughout the rest of 2023 into 2024 for the following school year if i remember correctly but this would allow us to have our public engagement sessions in january our public

[08:15:40] hearings in february and um our final review for adoption at the march 22nd meeting with all due respect mr jance i appreciate the comment and i also appreciate the idea that we're not going to get there soon i'm not sure that we ought to be going out with documents you know sort of before we have some of these base level things i'm not suggesting we do i'm suggesting we wait if we're going out in january we're not going to have the meeting i mean just take it i would suggest we have a meeting first week in january and i'm sorry and can i ask a clarifying question that i think

[08:16:17] is a friendly amendment to mr hansen so part of the problem here like we i think we won't everybody recognize we've got to move forward and so forth if we formally do first review that triggers an immediate process because or anything okay so because i mean honestly this is part of the problem is this what we're taking out to the pub what we're taking out to the public yeah what triggers the public process is the decision to go and hold the public hearings first review honestly we had last time right and we're having another one today with a different document uh you know it's it's a concept that we use in order to say we're going to separate review from action but it's not really

[08:16:57] a parliamentary thing you know it's just the body's heard both things they're both before us but even on a simple issue like uh you know when we say we're going to conform the documents does molly come into the into the proposed standards or do the or does the curriculum framework get changed to reflect you know the uh yeah greece and rome thank you alone so so if we say reconcile the two the question is which one trumps i don't even consider reconciling the two

[08:17:31] i think the november 11th document is new document i think it's got a lot of work to be done to it and aligning it to the framework and with all of the great work that's gone into getting the substance of the framework together obviously it will need to be adjusted for some of the adjustments that have been or might be made in the standard document but to give staff time to

[08:18:04] get this aligned give us time to review on not five days three days notice a more aligned set of documents to me is yeah of course what might be more helpful first is i'm not and i don't think this should be done i'm sorry at the gaps between the two documents right i mean we've asked for black line and so

you don't know if you want the document that was on today's agenda to be sort of the base or and have concepts in the august document brought into it that we can consider

[08:18:40] to be important or if you want the August document to be the base and have concepts that got put into the November document, put into it. So which is really the base document here is my point. And without knowing where we would go on all these myriad points that of difference, right? What I hear Jillian saying is I'm happy to do whatever it is you want me to do, but I need to understand what it is you want me to do and she's not in position to resolve the conflicts in those that's really our job to resolve those conflicts and so i don't know how we proceed even now without

[08:19:19] understanding fully and you know the differences between the proposed standards in august which have got some you know measure of support on the board and the proposed standards in november which have got some measure of support on the board unless we're just going to take the hard vote and say, you know, all you folks who cared about August, you know, you're done.

[08:19:39] Well, I think there's a third factor, Mr. President. I think both these documents need work. I'm not suggesting that either of them are final. What I'm saying is, Andy, that one or the other in terms of where we're headed as a Commonwealth is, you know, ought to, those base concepts ought to prevail and additional items being brought into the other one.

[08:20:00] Right. And we can't make that, I can't make that decision until I see, you know, what the changes were. What I know is I had four hours of public comment and a thousand letters saying August was better than November But I can't weigh that you know without actually taking the time to do it. Sheila Do you have any advice for us? Yeah, I was gonna ask if I may ask her consultant the question because I I think it was a couple hours ago now, but there was a point that I was really excited about the idea of Pulling the best out of both documents and so that's where you know I thought this was starting to go and I thought, oh my gosh, this is going to be, but now I'm

[08:20:39] hearing that's not a good idea. It's problematic. What's involved there? Please, I like that idea. How do we bring that to pass? I still think that's possible to do, but we need to establish a process for doing it. They're very different documents. They have different aspirations, I think you have to ask yourself questions like, do you have to put China and Mali back in just because they were in the 2015 framework?

[08:21:12] Is that the only reason that they have to go back in? Or is there, you know, is there a more open posture to looking at what could be in each of those grades that makes sense coherently across the grades?

[08:21:28] So, for example, we heard from the, you know, the people we consulted, they were upset that there was no history at all in grades K through two. And then suddenly at grade three, you've got China, Mali, Greece, Rome, and that you can't possibly do all that. So that was the purpose of trying to spread that history out and include some history content in those earlier grades where kids really want and need it in order to get through every, right?

[08:21:53] So I think it's possible to do. I or somebody else, I'm sure, would be willing to work. Are you still here, Christina? I'm here. You know, with people who are very intimately familiar with the decisions that went into creating the august document and trying to reconcile those and and look at the 2015 document again and understand why and how that document was put together which i as i understand has always been was pretty highly praised um before so i i think all things are possible you just have to

[08:22:28] decide which which way you want to go i i as a as an outsider i would say that that you should try to combine and make the standards as good as they can be first without thinking i i think you can't do the frameworks responsibly without knowing what the standards are going to do first they can move on parallel tracks but you know if it's molly used to be in third grade and now it's somewhere else then the frameworks that were developed to go with that well again that would even be helpful for us to know from a red line version of why and i think it answers um miss Hultons question of but again I didn't really put two and two together to get to that point so I

[08:23:08] think a red line version the context of why some things might be in might be in a different place or just the rationality of that's I think what's missing and without context people can come to conclusions which aren't helpful so I just um and surely this may be a terrible idea and it's late in the day and you've known me long enough that I know you'll feel comfortable being like Andy that's an absolutely terrible idea um the redlining is helpful but i think even more what people are worried about and and and the august document had some of this said you know the standard has been moved this piece but like what people are more worried about i think the public

[08:23:45] is like what's in and out right and you have to make decisions because if we don't we're not doing standards we're doing an encyclopedia and so stuff like you can and and that's true with the curricular frameworks so redlining is one thing is it possible to just that we as we revise this we could have a list on like this is what's in and this is what's out because i mean as we've seen like there's a bunch of stuff that was put in that i don't think people are even realize is in that was not in the earlier standards like what is it possible i guess to do like if you will an in and out list to help people understand here are decisions we made and then people are going to agree or disagree but at least it's clear we're not having this sort of parlor game of this isn't

[08:24:23] in this is now which is just again creating a ton of confusion and need needless angst i see the the logic of that, but in all honesty, I think that the document itself needs a little bit of a take a breath and look and see whether what's actually in there now, actually straight, is really the right stuff. I think I would freely admit that I think that the process was a little hasty and could be much better with a little more input and an attempt to

[08:24:55] What is the best of both worlds and get it into one document and then explain that to you? That's what I would want in my book. I'm not necessarily recommending the red line. I think there needs to be some way.

[08:25:11] But I think to your point, Andy, the document at some point is going to need to stand on its own two legs. It's got to shine. It's got to be reflective of what it is and kind of almost have that aha moment.

[08:25:26] And I don't think we've had that with either. And so I think that's why I'm suggesting what I'm suggesting with the time frame is that I don't think either versions are at the point where they need to be. So I think to your point, we'll recognize it, I think, when we get there.

[08:25:48] So let me ask if I understand that maybe there is a path forward in what you just said, Andy and Bill. And that is that we have two documents. We have the August document and the November document.

[08:26:04] And maybe the comfort level lies somewhere in between or at least knowledge of what's in, what's out. And certainly moving forward, there are opportunities for refinement of this document.

[08:26:20] um the second thing that i i think i'm hearing you say is uh let's try to be on on a little bit more of a parallel track with the curriculum framework so that everyone is assured that that content isn't going away um that to me helps us not to necessarily do a third document um but to but to refine and i i know i know i i'm not sure i'm i'm i'm not sure it's it's somewhere in the middle of the august and november documents and um it is a third and and that is that is maybe where we need

[08:27:00] to be i yeah i i love to hear a thought from dr siebert i have an idea of postponement motion to help us maybe move forward well then i guess i withdraw mine well is it still on the table i think yours still failed for lack of a second oh well okay i didn't realize that we were just in the middle of a discussion well usually that's after the second we haven't heard a second yet so you don't have to withdraw it but you can if you want you're asking me a question i'm just curious you've been like what what do you think on this i'm i have i have an idea for a motion but we haven't heard from you so i i certainly wanted to before i i have been saying for months that i was concerned

[08:27:36] that extended delays are going to create problems for our teachers and our school leaders and the people who do the work in the field and that if we go too long we start overlapping with the math standards review and we're really going to hurt and challenge our elementary schools moving ahead so so the the timeline here has been been vexing um i i really was excited about the idea of taking the best out of both documents and i thought maybe there was a way to do that for sake of moving forward but i've heard maybe no um so my my this is not a recommendation this is just

[08:28:15] i'm brainstorming right here in a pretty formal setting which is probably a good place to brainstorm but you know i'm like i've already looked at my calendar and i could meet january 5th thursday january 5th i i just i just there there's we we have got got to keep as president gecker said earlier we got to keep the process moving um so i don't know i i i thought we had something but apparently we don't well and i thought the question about taking the best of both was such was was challenged only because there are structural elements that come with the november

[08:28:55] document that are misaligned with the framework that the framework that we have is tied to different standards and that's a problem so i think the idea the idea of what is trumping what in terms of what are we integrating into what's the foundation document and what's like we're going to pick from the secondary one to create the third one but that's having a conversation

[08:29:30] about what people feel most comfortable with in that respect might be helpful because ultimately there is going to need to be a third document um there's no question about that um it's just what's going to be considered foundational is it november or is it 2015 where the progress the progression of the content the structural things that we're concerned about that have been changed in terms of when content is being introduced that's not disrupted is there a way

[08:30:05] to look at what august represented and incorporate from that point as to that point just i i just want to take brief exception to the characterization of the prior the 2015 is not having any history before third grade first grade first grade maybe i misunderstood it first grade is a clear introduction to virginia history second grade is a clear introduction to the nation's history kindergarten is a little vague it's community but it's on beginning to understand local historical locally indicated historical concepts all of the that's in the standards and everything almost

[08:30:43] everything i said earlier is in the standards in 2015 all of them fleshed out by curriculum i mean i'm certainly prepared to ask for a you know combined document with a clear understanding what's

being left out. I would like there to be an understanding of, you know, because we hear things like, well, our people said, you know, it's being taught too early. I'd like to have, because I think we got it before the input that was given by the social studies teachers

[08:31:19] and the coordinators, the people who actually teach this stuff and understand what is possible in the classroom and what isn't possible, perhaps more than any of us do, except for Grace. and uh you know i am content with that if you know we end up having an extra meeting that's fine uh but i don't as i said before i don't see how we move forward to the public with the november document as a product of this board and say that we've maintained faith with

[08:31:51] the public okay and so yeah there's a realistic question of you know and i say this respectfully you know the department's capacity to produce this and i know you've got staffing issues and i mean do we have the capability of moving this through on a realistic time frame you know without you know and i heard and i certainly don't discredit the idea of everybody in the universe looking at this at some point or another but at some point we've had a lot of

[08:32:26] people look at it let's go ahead and bring it in house make the changes you know combine the way you think this board is going to end up being happy with it and roll that out you know and not have to show it to everybody else before it comes back yeah i guess my motion to possibly would my motion would be and does grace have to withdraw no i already did but but can i can i make a comment before we okay so um the superintendent made a comment about wanting to ensure that we continue

[08:33:01] to uphold the previous public comment that had been made on the August document. And so I think that with that, that can inform some of this work about what is intentional that needs to be retained from the August document. And that might help to inform Dr. Mann what we additionally want to, I mean, that public comment can help to hold what is sacred in terms of the different

[08:33:39] progressions we've talked about in the curriculum. So using Sheila for what her professional opinion is here, I think we maintain the importance of that public comment from that document, use it to support combining August and November.

[08:34:01] so that would be my motion I have a friendly amendment which is that we because we've got to that we work from we work from the this existing draft but we incorporate that but we need a document like we are gonna end up with like and we modify it in accordance with this and with the feedback from the board and the end feedback from these different groups that we're gonna continuing to engage with so essentially we don't go out on first review we continue we continue to

[08:34:38] move forward to get a document that we're prepared to and then we commit to today to moving forward uh to get to a document that we're comfortable putting out that that includes just getting like what everybody has said these errors and omissions just getting it so we're putting out we're putting out a document that's going to lead to you know we want the best standards we should probably aspire to have the best conversation about those standards that we can as well i'm not sure if i - If I may, I'm not sure I understand the motion, either the original or the friendly amendment, but I'm not sure I need to if we're not now going forward with scheduling public hearing on anything.

[08:35:15] So if we're basically continuing the discussion with some guidance to staff based on our conversation, we can do that without voting on a motion. - Yeah, but I think we wanna be very clear that we're moving forward with that. Otherwise we're gonna just be here.

[08:35:30] - Then I would love clarification as to the motion 'cause I don't understand it, I'm sorry. it's just the time of day okay so do you want to incorporate from your amendment what I was just saying Andy people have ideas that are almost formed let's give them five minutes to form ideas we'll give you 10 5:30 at 5:30 it'll be less

[08:35:57] formed when we come back I will say members of the board are now thinking

[08:49:33] about taking hotel rooms tonight so let's see if we can move through this one and a few of the other items pretty quickly mr rotherham do you have uh the sage suggestion that i'm told you may have i found a suggestion i don't recall anything about it being sagacious so my my suggestion would be that we do a motion um uh to schedule first review of the history standards for a special meeting in early january we direct the superintendent public instruction to draft standards to include content from the draft standard presented to the board in august

[08:50:11] we further request the superintendent provide the board with a crosswalk document before the meeting comparing the august november january drafts all factual errors uh and omissions are corrected the draft and uh um uh and identified in both the august and november drafts i'd like to make one suggestion there and that is to not mandate yet the meeting in january because i want to make sure we get the product done before we schedule a meeting for no purpose by motion with the commitment that i'm entitled under the bylaws to do it right when staff says you know we're going to make the deadline then we'll schedule the meeting although in advance i'm happy to solicit

[08:50:51] dates to get it on the calendars but i don't want to formally call it yet thank you for that well is that okay yeah thank you for that my assumption was what we were talking about with some stuff yesterday that we were going to be meeting so can we just change it to the next meeting of the board is that sure but again the commitment among the board members is we will have a special meeting which i'm agreeing i got to call if the work product is at a point where it makes sense to have that special meeting uh and that uh uh i just don't want there to be any surprises i mean that's

[08:51:22] my intent here okay so yeah i was hoping you wouldn't all right let me try yeah i'm going from like notes i made so uh i moved that the board of education schedule uh parts coming out sorry uh okay so how should i i think what you're asking is that the uh department be directed to take the august and the uh to take the november document as the basis of moving forward incorporate

[08:51:55] uh the elements of the august of the august uh draft as we've discussed clarify all errors and omissions and give us a clear crosswalk so we can see what is in and what is out so we basically the the spirit of my motion is that we continue to move forward but we don't go out to the public yet i would like to offer a friendly suggestion on top of that and to say include not just what we've discussed but reflective of the public comment we've received so far as well as in particular

[08:52:27] paying attention to the practitioner comment that occurred during the uh august draft i would say i would change that to incorporating all feedback we've received i don't know that we want to start direct just make sure that all feedback uh that we received and actually if i can make a friendly amendment to my friendly amendment also just direct the the department just to communicate very clearly uh and all in all these documents just make sure that they're being presented not just to us but the public in a timely manner clearly so people have an opportunity to engage

[08:53:03] uh and and and and uh that the process remains transparent all right is there i think we have a motion to basically you know incorporate more things into the draft that was presented today taking into account all feedback received uh comments of the board today as well as public comment received today and public comment received earlier so if that's okay is there a second to that thank you miss creasy is there any other discussion dr ballad is this is that clear enough i want to make sure i didn't just didn't throw a word salad at you too yeah no um no it is and i'll

[08:53:38] just i'll just paraphrase what i think i heard um so we're going to incorporate elements of the August draft plus comment and feedback and discussion from from today's meeting and before Into an updated August draft or a refined August draft Okay, and it's crosswalk. We're going to also provide a crosswalk of all three documents communicate clearly in a timely manner with the transparent process and

[08:54:15] I I think I would also add to that just I Think the public needs I want to find a better way to depict all of the great content That from the decoupled document that it that lives in the frameworks I want to find a way to bring that front and center going forward so that it's a little bit of a mantelpiece All right, can I just ask that some piece of that include Track changes to the 2015 standards as well because that's really what we're amending

[08:54:50] Whether that's a separate document or it can be incorporated into one and I don't need that to go into the motion I'm just asking that that Part of the crosswalk that there be a comparison document that enables us to easily see What the newest recommendations are compared to the 2015 existence?

[08:55:11] I think it's a good idea because that's gonna really be hitting the street of what people are currently doing and what they'll need to be doing. - I think that's good. - Good, all right, we have a motion. Unbelievable, we have a second. Any more discussion whatsoever?

[08:55:28] Speak now or forever hold your peace. All those in favor signify by saying aye. - Aye. - Aye. - Any opposed? Does the word punt mean anything to anybody? - Can I just ask a question just to get a copy of the decoupled document that was shared?

[08:55:46] Ann, I think you mentioned you had a copy of it. Just, again, just to have it, it would be very helpful to see what was actually decoupled in October standards framework, if you could just share that.

[08:56:01] I think that went into our board books like at lunchtime today. But there's so many things. Yeah, this is true. If I could just ask that it be emailed with that title or blind CC so that we can like have it, I would find that very helpful.

[08:56:18] And Dr. Bell, I just want to say, I know this has been, I'm excited we're still moving forward. This is important. We need to get this done. I know it's been a lot to manage. It's also been happening at a time when we've had all this other stuff going on. And so, like, I think you've heard our feedback on things we want to see going forward, but also that doesn't mean we don't recognize how hard everyone's working and just all the multiple priorities that everyone's struggling here i just want to that's why i named that thank you mr rotherham um i i appreciate that

[08:56:53] and um and again this is this is difficult but i i think that these struggles um equate to a great document at at the end okay we will move on and back on the agenda items b c and d were pulled off the consent mr you had a question for the superintendent these are the praxis uh passing scores right um it was more of a comment and i've i think i've relayed via email and i've had a

[08:57:26] conversation with sbelo um and i'm regarding the praxis cut scores for chemistry biology and physics and i just wanted to relay that i do disagree with the cut score recommendations by vdoe which accepts the ets suggested scores um i think i mentioned it last time as well and you know according to ets a state may accept the recommended past scores adjust the score upward to reflect more stringent expectations or uh you know adjusted downward and i i hope and expect the governor's

[08:58:06] executive directive in september has a positive impact on addressing teacher shortages and retention and recruitment efforts um i but i don't accept the premise of lowering standards to build a more diverse workforce or to obey teacher shortages yes uh professional development is imperative however would it fix everything um if so why even have a praxis um cut score at all um i you know i've read about the teacher i'm reading about the teacher shortage and i do

[08:58:42] appreciate the gravity i don't however believe that it's an either or situation lowering the cut score either for student sol assessments or for teachers is important to maintain a high academic standard that was going to be my comment i don't agree with this position okay uh we appreciate the comments and uh however is there a motion to adopt items b c and d

[08:59:17] as recommended by uh the department which would be the ets cut scores so moved there a second thank you dr mann uh any other discussion all those in favor i just like i know we want to get on i um just want i i'm good i support the superintendent's recommendation and we voted but But, like, Ms. Dutta, the amount of homework she did to figure this out and the amount of research, I think this is – these are ones where reasonable people can disagree.

[08:59:48] And it was a very conscientious effort, and I do appreciate her raising it. And there have been in the past ones that I've disagreed with. And I just wanted to – I'd like to go one step further. My understanding was from the presentation that this is kind of like a new test, and that's where they're kind of piloting these cut scores.

[09:00:05] you know i'm oh i support to pronounce recommendation also um if this is something that you know there's desire to revisit because we might be looking for things for our agenda a year from now um again i i don't my point is that i i i get if this is a newer test we're going to use the recommendation maybe we need to reevaluate that i'm open to that and i did look at the the documents and the content for both old and new so they're most of it's pretty know comparable and I don't have a problem with the comprehensiveness of

[09:00:42] the content or the test itself what my issue is the cut score and so that's all I wanted to say and I looked at the entire the way they developed the the statistics that went into it the research it's pretty good you know since yeah thank you for your diligence I will say though that to me the question on practice cut scores and all of these cut scores is are they accomplishing the purpose that we're seeking to accomplish and here the purpose is do does the teacher meet the threshold amount of knowledge in order to be effective in a classroom and they're just even ets says there doesn't seem

[09:01:21] to be evidence that if you ratchet that cut score up you have a more effective teacher you may have i'm not sure if ets because he said that here okay so um i know that there was another document included in the october meeting uh agenda where uh the national council on teacher quality published 15 out of 15 out of 11 out of 15 studies which did find a positive correlation between licensure uh test scores and student outcomes and even if you do a you know online research just a simple

[09:01:56] online search you can get get many research papers and published material uh which do state that raising the the passing score on the the practice test does include would increase the quality of the teacher workforce as measured by like student value-added student achievement so there are many ways to look at it there are lots of research that one can look at so just wanted to say that thank you okay we have a motion a second a lot of discussion uh all in favor signify by saying aye

[09:02:32] aye opposed no i oppose all right so that takes us down to mr dickey sorry to keep you so late sir just another day at the office was that that sai was as he's approaching i'd like to note that we also have the hardest working staff in the coming world no doubt about that well i think there is yes yet another uh here it is another um powerpoint for you probably your 30th today but good evening you can feel free to abbreviate yeah uh i think we can arrange that but uh thanks

[09:03:10] president gecker members of the board superintendent baylow this is final review of the uh guidelines on the um school construction assistance program and um uh we in this brief powerpoint we've repeated some of the background information for you that we had in there last month just for um for your information in this final review version no no revisions proposed to um the general parameters and and apple general application requirements um for for the program

[09:03:47] um no no changes to the um uh the the parameters for the um uh grants at either 10 20 or 30 percent and all of that remains the same. So what we focused on in the final review version for revisions based on comment from school divisions, some comments from general assembly staff, internal review by DOE staff, is some wording clarifications and revisions to five or six of the 11 competitive application criteria.

[09:04:22] So the final revisions in the document compared to what you reviewed in October, focus on six of the criteria with an eye towards clarification to align to legislative intent as we understand it, and just general clarification.

[09:04:47] And criteria, and I'll just touch on these very briefly in these two slides, Criterion two related to access improvements for ADA compliance, Americans with Disability Act compliance.

[09:05:06] In addition to proposed renovation projects, that particular building need or facilities need in the school division would also apply to new construction. That was a comment essentially from the school division.

[09:05:22] Similar revision to Criterion 3, related to building deficiencies. In the first review version, that focused only on building renovation projects. That's been expanded as well to new construction for replacement buildings, similar to Criterion 2.

[09:05:47] Then revisions to Criterion 6, related to points awarded if the project is included in a CIP, in a capital improvement plan. The first review version indicated only in a school division CIP.

[09:06:05] In some school divisions or localities, capital projects may be housed in both, or in the local government CIP. So we've inserted or localities, current CIP. So the points be awarded whether the projects in the school division, CIP, or the locality.

[09:06:26] And then criterion seven revisions related to, in the area of commitment to maintain local revenues for public education during the project financing period.

[09:06:45] This change deleted. financing already executed to only read financing proposed and that exactly matches the Appropriation Act language. That was a comment discussion with General Assembly staff with an eye towards the intent of the program right now being projects that haven't started or being planned and are seeking final financing and funding.

[09:07:15] So already executed would denote the projects fully funded and likely already begun. Criterion eight related to fiscal stress, really more of a technical change there. We would just simply strike or have stricken in the final review version, the quantitative ranges that exist under the current fiscal stress indicator data, because across years those ranges tied to the qualitative designations

[09:07:51] of high fiscal stress, above average, et cetera, can change across years as those calculations are updated. So the criterion would only use and assign points based on the high, above average, below average, low fiscal stress designations and and uh eliminate the um uh the qualitative ranges because those vary across years as the index is updated annually and then lastly uh related to uh condition of uh other school

[09:08:28] buildings in the uh division um you know denoting um you know overall uh condition of buildings and an overall need for state funding support. We've clarified that the assessment of buildings, other buildings besides the project building, being in poor, fair, or good condition would be based on the majority or over half of the other buildings in the division we thought was a better reflection of overall need.

[09:09:04] So we've simply, in effect, inserted over half of the buildings as a clarification there. We got some questions on that. And then moving forward, the next several slides are simply all of the criteria with the most substantive edits or revisions in bold red type, as you can see there.

[09:09:30] We've just listed those for the six criteria that we're proposing for revision. Criteria two and three would allow those two criteria to apply for new construction, for a replacement of an old building, in addition to renovation projects.

[09:09:56] so those those are the changes there as you can see and then moving over to criteria six we've inserted or locality cip so the the points would be awarded if the project is in either the division or locality cip and that was response to comments from the field and then And lastly, in criteria seven, related to financing proposed, that aligns to Appropriation

[09:10:34] Act language is adopted by the General Assembly. We struck already or already executed denoting that's a project that's been fully funded, likely has already begun the construction phase. And then criteria eight, where, again, we've stricken the quantitative ranges that exist right now on the fiscal stress data, because those vary based on the re-benchmarking or updates of that data across years, and it would be based solely on where a locality fell out on the qualitative ranges.

[09:11:14] So those ranges would not have to be updated every year by striking the quantitative data. And then lastly, the sixth edit or revision proposed criteria 10, again, condition of other school buildings in the division to indicate overall need, facilities needs in the division, it would specify greater than half or over half of the other buildings being

[09:11:50] in fair, poor, good condition is a clarification on criteria 10. So those are the substantive revisions proposed. else remains the same. We made the revisions that we are proposing the revisions. We

felt like that we can based on reconfirmation of legislative intent from the General Assembly and discussions the last couple of weeks, and that's what's proposed. And then simply

[09:12:26] next steps um uh we have uh since we drafted this found out um from the attorney general's office guidance um that the these particular guidelines would not be uh subject to the 30-day public comment period on the town hall given the nature of these guidelines and their alignment to appropriation act requirements um so in that first bullet um that won't be required as we understand it from the recent general assembly guidance and then in the second

[09:13:01] bullet or the last two bullets on this page is an opportunity to present issues from the field that have been identified program improvements your ideas to improve and change and refine the program is your required report to the general assembly on December 1 and staff will assist with that that that's just around the corner uh and we're we're beginning to tabulate that that brief report or letter and that's a means to communicate issues of the general assembly and then on the same day

[09:13:35] december 1 the commission on school construction um meets and has asked for a report on this program and the guidelines uh and that that's another avenue to um update the general assembly and also present some issues coming from the field and potential changes for the program.

[09:13:55] And then lastly, Mr. President, the superintendent's recommendation recommends the board approve the final review guidelines as proposed. Thank you, Mr. Dickey. Dr. Siebert? Yeah, I just want to thank Kent and staff for being responsive to questions I did pose.

[09:14:15] I think the redlining, some of the thresholds, I think those are all really, really good changes. So my question really probably is more of a board role question, which I'm obviously still learning. Because we heard today from COSARS that a look back to the beginning of the biennium, July 1, would be eminently helpful for those divisions.

[09:14:36] As staff shared with me, this group, this legislative group is meeting on December 1st, so they may have some ideas there. And of course the General Assembly will be convening uh shortly after that in early january but um again so the it just i i'm just going to wrap my mind around the fact that the general assembly does a biennial budget and the biennial budget started on july 1 and have there been other situations or conditions where we there's a look back um i know there has been a look back but it's not explicitly in the budget language so i just don't know what options were there because i i'm very sympathetic to the work that's

[09:15:12] happening in those small rural divisions. Yeah, I understand that the staff told us that the intent was something. You know, Virginia is not an intense state with regard to legislative interpretation. I mean, does it actually prohibit us starting until there are guidelines, staff's comments aside, or can we take the position as a board that, you know, July 1 is it? Yeah, I think the totality of the guidelines you know really written to prospective projects and in in um you know one one cost that's not allowable to be paid with the funds is debt service or financing

[09:15:51] cost so a a project that um you know may have started you know july 1 you know that's broken ground of course it's been it's been fully funded you know either either you know cash or debt financed. So let's assume it was cash funded instead of debt or that there was enough cash that our grant would replace it. Is there any concept reason why we can't give a grant to replace localities cash? And I mean frankly if

you want to talk about intent, I'm on the school modernization committee with the legislature. That is certainly something we were looking to do, was to act as

[09:16:29] quickly as possible. You know I get the fact that they 100% debt financed it, they're just out of luck. But is there a reason we can't say that if you are replacing your equity, essentially. You can't get a grant back to July 1.

[09:16:44] My understanding is, and Dr. Peregrine has said a few times now that I've heard him, the governor was down southwest at a school in Bristol saying, this is great. We're going to help fund it with this program. And if we adopt that, we can't do it until the guidelines are done, then obviously that's not going to happen.

[09:17:02] So I mean, do we have flexibility here or do you think we just have none? So we've had a lot of discussion with legislative staff. I mean, from a staff perspective, that is our conduit.

[09:17:18] What about the AG's office? No, for those specific scenarios, we've not asked for guidance from the AG's office. I've got to tell you, I did sit in on all of those meetings, And there was a clear belief that anything we did to facilitate schools construction ought to be as flexible as possible for the localities.

[09:17:47] And so, you know, if we could see our way to, I'm not saying fund expenses that we're not allowed to fund, but to have the effective date essentially being the beginning of the biennium, that would be a good thing in my view. Okay. We can certainly, you know, continue to look at that and seek some AG's guidance on that.

[09:18:12] And I know that may take some setup and some time to do that. Ms. Hulton. So does that mean we would – so your opinion today, your best good faith representation to us at this moment is that we can't do a look back to July 1?

[09:18:32] That's my judgment and assessment. Okay, so if that's so but we need to I think I'm right we need to move on this so people don't continue that You know, so we don't create more of this problem Would it would it work for us to go ahead and pass this?

[09:18:50] Item vote affirmatively on this item on the super intense recommendation on this item today But on the understanding that you continue to work with the attorney general and if you can find a room you'll bring it back to us number one and number two i understand you're in touch with the appropriations committee staff and it is it is my impression that in the past sometimes everybody over and appropriations and finance committee staff all agrees that something was not quite written as they wanted it to in last year's approach document they can massage it in such a

[09:19:26] way that eventually they'll fix it this legislation's late of season retroactively and then we'll come Come back and fix it then. But anyway, so that's a long-winded way of saying, shouldn't we go forward today even if we can't fix this? - I think we ought to go forward. What I would actually suggest is having the sort of incentives on the other side.

[09:19:45] You know, we go forward with the direction that the effective date be as flexible as possible unless the AG's office, not the staff, but unless the AG's office comes back and says, no, you can't, in which case, we'll use the effective date of the guidelines today. I'd also like to include in the motion, because we do have the report due, It is not uncommon on those reports in the last six years for me because they're pretty much nothing.

[09:20:09] I'm not disrespecting the report or the work, but you know what I'm saying, Ken. It's not like it's a very routine report to just allow me to sign it on behalf of the board without it being coming before the board. Like I said, that's been a fairly common practice. It's not a policy document, it's a reporting document.

[09:20:28] So the motion that I would ask for is one that says, we pass the guidelines as suggested by Mr. Dickey with the instruction that the department interpret them as being in effect on July 1, unless after consultation with the attorney general, they find they have to do it as a date of passage.

[09:20:47] And allowing me to sign the report that's needed December 1, you know, on behalf of the board. - Second. - Okay, any discussion on this? - And then we just see that report like in our next board book, you'll get it. - Yeah, or I would say Emily would send it out as a matter of course, but that's not gonna happen.

[09:21:05] so I guess Jillian I'll be sending them all out I don't know I mean I mean it's it's a pretty straightforward letter I just had a few questions just just for me to understand and these are this is all very new for me just just a question about the competitive scoring criteria and their associated value points in the evaluating the funding so a minimum of 65 criteria points on a hundred point scale to qualify for a grant award.

[09:21:39] How did you go about, or is this just an existing some precedence from elsewhere that would follow? What is the, how do you go about establishing this minimum score? - Yeah, and that is a program requirement.

[09:21:54] And it, you know, essentially a staff judgmental process. I mean, looking at, you know, some simulated data, Staff did that internally on some of the criteria. Legislative staff did the same thing on some of the draft criteria.

[09:22:17] Where we fell was, you know, that was a reasonable cut point for the minimum scoring points to qualify for a grant based on the totality of the 11 criteria. It's on a scale from 0 to 100.

[09:22:33] I mean, the maximum points are 100, and looking at, you know, several school divisions around the state, different regions, you know, different sizes, you know, as best we could based on the data we have right now, that was the final, you know, assessment of a reasonable, you know minimum cut point for for a high need you know locality division high need project modeling some sort of modeling yes yes as best we could

[09:23:11] without having any true application data from school divisions on some of the criteria some some of its secondary data you know composite index fiscal stress you know some of the building condition data we have from two years ago this is all kind of really new compared to two years ago this whole well yeah this is a brand new program though you know there's never been a competitive you know application program for school construction support there's formula funding and there has been in the past but this is the first time there's been

[09:23:47] a criterion based right you know program for school facilities one more question project costs question about that I it said it excluded the financing costs is does it excluding exclude existing debts and yes it would yeah yeah yeah you know with the with the you know the the incentive and the intent being active construction costs in the active construction phase not not debt service you know after the project's completed put in a service non

[09:24:26] construction costs non-construction associated costs it wouldn't include that yeah the end the intent is really the yeah the core construction cost a you know design architectural and engineering the core building construction you know site preparation for the building and in the end really the general assembly signaled the priorities there. But the Preparation Act language specifically

[09:25:01] excludes financing costs from being a reimbursable cost under the program, which we interpret to be debt service, paying off debt for a prior project. And is there a mechanism to, I mean, how does the state do a financial oversight or enforce the spend of these funds?

[09:25:29] Well, yeah, I mean, that will be part of the administrative implementation and monitoring. We'll ask for demonstration of vendor cost. We will ask for documentation as part of this.

[09:25:45] And the budget language essentially implies that we would do that. we would pay as school divisions incur reasonable ongoing costs for construction. So we will ask for backup documentation on their costs for those that are awarded.

[09:26:03] Thank you. Okay. We have a motion. Have we all read it on this? I don't remember if we did this. Thank you. Shall we take the vote then? Here we go. All in favor signify by saying aye.

[09:26:18] Aye. Any opposed? Thanks, Kent, very much. Thank you. Okay, item K. Good evening.

[09:26:34] I'm presenting to you a nomination to fill a vacancy on the Early Childhood Advisory Committee. The board has several advisory committees. Many are required by state or federal statute or regulations, including the ECAC. The ECAC vacancy arose after Ms. Creasy's appointment to the board.

[09:26:52] Due to her appointment to the board, she resigned from her position on ECAC as the representative for the Virginia Council on Private Education. The individual recommended for appointment for this vacancy is Ms. Wendy Lipscomb. she is the director of early learning at blessed sacrament huguenot school in addition to the video e staff recommendation she also has the recommendation from VCPE in the code section is very specific that it has to be an individual representing VCPE the superintendent of public instruction recommends that the board waive first review and approve this appointment to the early childhood advisory committee okay thank you the chair would be

[09:27:29] delighted to entertain a motion to do that is there a second is there any discussion seeing that all in favor signify by saying aye aye any opposed good okay thank you i love that one final review of proposal to adopt special provisions regarding the determination of performance level for the chronic absenteeism indicator and accreditation years 2023-24 and 24-25 i would say good evening good evening at the october 20th business meeting the board was

[09:28:08] prevent presented a first review of a proposal to adopt special provisions to alter the manner in which the performance level for the chronic absenteeism indicator is determined in accreditation years 23 24 and 24 25. today the proposal is being presented for final review there is detailed information in the board agenda item that supplements the summary information that i'll be highlighting tonight specifically the proposal has two parts the first part is to remove the 21-22

[09:28:44] school year chronic absenteeism data from accreditation calculations in accountability year 23-24 this will result in the removal of the cumulative three-year rate and the demonstration of adequate improvement from the determination of a school's performance level for chronic absenteeism in

accountability year 23-24. The 22-23 school year data, therefore, will be the sole determinant of the chronic absenteeism rate. And then the second part of the proposal is to

[09:29:18] remove the 21-22 school year chronic absenteeism data from the cumulative three-year rate in accountability year 24-25. The cumulative year rate will only include data then from the 22-23 and 2324 school years. Demonstration of adequate improvement will be determined by comparing data from school years 2223 to 2324. The VDOE is asking the board to consider removal of the

[09:29:51] school year 2122 chronic absenteeism data because it was negatively impacted by several factors related to the pandemic and was not necessarily an accurate indicator of the school's programs in efforts to engage students in attending school the board did adopt special provisions in april 22 to remove the chronic absenteeism indicator from the determination of accreditation status in 2223 for this reason it should be noted that chronic absenteeism was the only active indicator that

[09:30:26] was not used in accrediting schools in 2223 when the board discussed the decision in april of 22 the accuracy of the other indicators did not come into question the other indicators were impacted by the pandemic but they did measure what they were intended to measure when the board discussed this current proposal in october there was a request to look at an alternate scenario the alternate scenario for the 23-24 accountability year was to remove the 21-22 school year data

[09:31:01] from the calculations but to use the 2018-19 school year data as the previous year and then use the 17-18 18-19 and 22-23 school year data in the cumulative three-year rate after an analysis of this scenario for the 23-24 accountability year it was estimated that a small number of schools approximately five percent would have their performance level determined by the current year rate and the vast majority of schools over 90 percent would benefit from the advantage that

[09:31:37] the two pre-pandemic years would provide in the cumulative three-year rate in addition using these two pre-pandemic years in the cumulative three-year rate rate would result in the majority of schools approximately 70 percent earning a level one as such the analysis indicates that the results will be skewed upwards because of the pre-pandemic chronic absenteeism rates it's also important to note that some of the data used to calculate performance levels in this scenario are up to five years old and this methodology may not necessarily be representative of how schools are currently

[09:32:15] performing post-pandemic as such videoe staff believe the proposal is shown or as described at the beginning of the presentation to be a better option the superintendent of public instruction recommends that the board of education approve the current proposal to adopt special provisions regarding the determination of the performance level for the chronic absenteeism indicator and accreditation years 23 24 and 24 25. adopting these special provisions will provide

[09:32:50] an accurate reflection of how schools have addressed chronic absenteeism post-pandemic and underscore the need for schools to proactively address chronic absenteeism using the 22-23 rates as the sole determinant of the performance level also provides the most transparent reflection of the school's programs and practices to re-engage students in school and it is the most transparent data to drive school improvement as schools engage in addressing this critically important issue bdoe is asking whether or not the board approves the special

[09:33:28] provisions regarding the chronic absenteeism indicator as detailed in the board agenda item and as uh presented and i can answer any questions at this time are there any questions by board

members it is a benefit to being this late i know thank you for providing the detailed information that you did as a follow-up to the discussion. I found it very helpful.

[09:33:55] Thank you. All right. If there are no questions. I just want to give accolades. First of all, thank you for being here this late. And second of all, just thank you for all of the extra time that you spent with me walking through the different decision points and scenarios to get to this. So I don't necessarily agree that it's the late hour. It's great preparation and a great discussion. Thank you.

[09:34:19] that's actually what i meant when i said that julian i'm not going to miss a chance okay uh seeing no questions is there a motion to adopt the superintendent's recommendation so moved thank you dr siever is there a second second thank you miss dutta all those in favor signify by saying aye aye any opposed thank you both very much thank you okay item m first review a fast-track action to update 8BAC 20-490-30's length of school day requirement.

[09:34:53] Thank you, President Gecker, Vice President Dr. Mann, members of the board, Superintendent Balo, good evening. I hope to keep this relatively short. This is, again, a fairly technical item just in the sense of process. What we have here is in 2020, there was a law that was passed that required us to change the required minimum hours for kindergarten instructional time from the previous 540 up to 990.

[09:35:19] We put an action before this board in June of 2022 that was approved at that time as an exempt action. However, for various reasons, the certification from the Office of the Attorney General didn't come through in time. And as you might recall from our training at the regulatory training last October, if that isn't certified within 90 days of the effective date, We can no longer run it as exempt action.

[09:35:44] So we're simply representing it to you here as a fast track in hopes that you'll prove that and we can move forward with getting this regulation changed. Okay. Are there any questions? Excellent preparation is what I've got to say, clearly.

[09:36:02] I'm fine with this. I think at some point, and at some point it's not 620 on Thursday night, we should have a conversation just about like hours of instruction and so forth. and just I think I think it's a broader conversation to be had around me but again absolutely I yeah but not you know but at some point I'd like to see the board have a conversation about just thinking more holistically about this and sort of where we are and what we can do okay I don't see any questions I appreciate the comment from mr. Rotherham is there a motion to adopt the

[09:36:39] recommendation thank you dr. Mann thank you mr. Hanson all those in favor signify by saying aye. - Aye. - Any opposed? That carries. Thanks very much. All right. Are we looking for a break or are we looking to move right into N?

[09:36:55] - Move. - Okay. Item N. - This could take a little while. - N. Discussion on considerations to revise cut scores on grades three to eight math and reading standards of learning.

[09:37:11] Is it you, Jillian? Or is this? - Dr. Ryder. - Yep. I thought it was the superintendent on this one. - Okay. I will get a start.

[09:37:28] I'm sorry. It is late. blame that on me. Okay. So here, I do see my name on here, and I'll just get us started and then turn it over to you. So yesterday, the president and I made the decision to not do a formal presentation on the NAEP scores, although those are included in your board packet, specifically in

yesterday's agenda, just to save time. We didn't do that. I would encourage everyone on the board and in the public to go through that presentation, take a look at our NAEP scores

[09:38:02] if you haven't already, and perhaps click on some of the links to look at our state report from NAEP as well as the NAEP release that the governor did, the event that the governor led on October 24th. That said, on October 24th, Governor Youngkin put forward seven action items and several of them included the Virginia Department of Education and the Virginia Board of Education, including asking the board to raise achievement expectations and cut scores in grades three through eight, reading and math standards of learning tests.

[09:38:41] Again, this is one of seven items to address the downward trajectory that was exacerbated by school closures. You'll recall yesterday, if you did have a chance to look at the agenda item, and we had a little discussion on the dais yesterday about how Virginia saw the steepest declines in the nation in fourth grade reading and in fourth grade math from 2017 to 2022 we also saw downward trajectory that was exacerbated by school closures in both eighth grade reading and eighth grade math we saw the same trends although with different scores on our SOLs as

[09:39:21] as well as our PALS reading tests. And bottom line is that Virginia is in a crisis. Beginning to address the crisis by making sure that the data that Virginians receive is aligned is a good first step.

[09:39:37] And so we have asked in response to the governor's request, we've asked Shelly and Sarah to make a presentation on our current cut scores where we are, answer questions for information, and perhaps act on that.

[09:39:56] Thank you. - Mr. President, can I, I just wanna note, I don't wanna muck up the process, but I just wanna say, I'm not able to give this my full mental attention today. I'm gonna do my very best, but I don't know about the rest of you, I am wiped out.

[09:40:14] And if this isn't an action item, I would just like to suggest the maximum extent possible we put it off to a later date. I don't mean, I'm not asking, I don't need a response to that. But if there isn't a vote, maybe other people have got more brain power left than I've got.

[09:40:32] So I just want to know. I think what may come out of this is a decision on the part of the board to take, to ask the staff, ask the department through, you know, Superintendent Bailo to take a look at the impact of raising scores.

[09:40:49] Basically more information than, and this is not a criticism of the presentation at all, but I think there may be a request that there be more information given with regard to, you know, what we think the impact would be if we raise scores. You know, at one point there was some discussion about raising them this year.

[09:41:07] I think that there's been some clearly, you know, some clear pushback to the idea of a move the goalpost mid-year kind of raise for the spring. But, you know, we do hear, you know, from Southwest, for example, you know, Matt Hurt writes a lot about the relationship between the expectations as evidenced by the cut scores and student achievement.

[09:41:32] And whether all the data's right or not, you know, that's not my point. My point is that there is some data out there which suggests that there's a correlation, if not a causation between the higher

expectations and student outcomes. And so, you know, I know it's late and if this were an action item, honestly, I would put it off.

[09:41:52] but I do think, you know, it would be fair to everybody to at least hear the underlying presentation. I don't think we're going to take a lot of action today. That's not the goal, but I do think that it warrants putting on our agenda formally this, you know, the study. I mean, if you look, you know, everybody's now comparing us to Massachusetts and mapping, you know, and, you know, one of the questions I have for Shelley is, did they map, and for Sarah, did they map against you know proficient when apparently you know the massachusetts system has four different

[09:42:28] classifications i don't know which one nape is mapping to and you don't need the highest one in order to graduate so i don't know if we have a nomenclature problem in virginia or if we have you know in terms of the nape mapping or if it's something else i really have been unable to figure that out but anyway um with the consent of the board i'd like to at least hear the presentation and then we can decide how much discussion and what the action you know is or isn't i'll do my best thank you i'm sorry to interrupt you guys superintendent baylow we we understood that we were going to be directed to come back with a plan do you want us to go through all of the detail in

[09:43:05] this particular document can you give me some some clarification i thought the idea was that we were going to come back with a plan for what it would take to raise the cut scores do you want us to go through all the detail that's in this document i think we actually had that discussion a little bit earlier and um i i might depend on a little bit of your expertise and i'll explain why very quickly um when you presented this information to me months ago it's incredibly insightful to see how the board lands on the cut scores that they land on and what um what is depicted in that what

[09:43:44] What I'm hoping for is some forward momentum in, number one, seeing the discrepancy between where our state scores are and the NAEP scores, and also seeing a little glimpse of how this board determines cut scores.

[09:44:04] We don't need to go into lots of detail about Angoff versus Bookmark, unless, of course, that's of interest to anyone at 6.30 at night. but just really talking about how that's done with rationale that we want to continue to provide.

[09:44:23] Yeah, I'm not sure Angolf versus Bookmark is necessary, but I think— No, I'm kidding. No, no, no, but I do think, I'm about to say it, and sadly in some ways, because I've heard this before, that a discussion, you know, for criticizing the cut scores, essentially, it would be good to understand how long we've been doing it and the way we've been doing it and, you know, what we believe we achieved by doing it through the angolf or modified angolf method and i i don't know if all eight board members are experts in modified angloff probably not although i know you are at this point um superintendent bale i think if i go through the chart that might be most helpful

[09:44:59] and is it possible to pull up the board item so that we can look at the chart together yes i can't do that but i'll bet someone could see if you can do it all right so just if you will look at your

[09:45:20] board item there is a chart um yeah i don't see it it's got a lot okay so if if you will go to the chart that says summary and background information proposed cut scores for grades three through eight math test based on the 2016 standards of learning okay all right so first of all just nomenclature

[09:45:56] when we name a test we name it based on the date that the standards it's based on were adopted so while these tests were given for the first time in 2019 they're called the math test 2016 because that was the date that this board adopted the mathematics standards so i think as most of you know when we adopt cut scores what we do first is we have been convening committees of educators so it's committee committees of educators who promoted with the content of the particular test so for

[09:46:32] example if we're setting cut scores on grade three mathematics in the past we would have had teachers who taught the grade three math standards and perhaps some curriculum specialists from the school division i won't go through all of bangoff i think we did include a description of it in your board packet if you're interested but essentially the committee members go through what are called the performance level descriptors those performance level descriptors are based on the standards of learning and they describe what the student needs to know and be able to do to be proficient or advanced they then look at those more

[09:47:11] closely for what a student would need to be able to do to be just over the threshold to be proficient and the importance of all of that is it provides sort of a consensus discussion of what a fairly proficient student then those committee members review every item on the test and thinking about that student who's just over the threshold for just for proficient they make a judgment about whether that student would get

[09:47:44] that item correct most of the time so if you look at the chart you'll see that the information from that standard setting committee is represented under standard setting summary and then the standard setting committee recommendation does everybody see that we will use grade um grade four actually let me just interrupt for a second when you say proficient here what we mean in virginia is basically ready to move on to the next level as opposed to innate proficiency which is i

[09:48:20] mean one of the problems we have is terminology right and so could you describe what we understand proficiency to be so in 1998 the board adopted a policy description of proficient that is satisfactory performance on the standards and that has been interpreted to mean that the student is ready to knows that grade level content and these performance level descriptors describe in more detail what the student needs to know so you are correct that our current definition of proficiency

[09:48:52] is somewhat different okay so if we just use grade four as an example we'll see that the standard setting committee recommended 20 out of 50 items to be proficient body okay with me so far okay and then the next thing that happens with the educator committees is there's an articulation committee this is a committee that is composed of several members from each of the individual standard setting committees so it might be um three three members from

[09:49:28] grade 3, 3 from grade 4, and so on. And they look at the scores across the test to make sure that they are consistent and if there are differences in the pass rates, or the estimated pass rates, that there's a content explanation. That articulation group sees estimated impact data. And by that I mean there is an estimate of how many, what percentage of students would be proficient what percentage of students would fall into advanced if a

[09:50:01] particular cut score were adopted so you'll see for grade four that perfect for proficient the articulation committee raised the recommendation of the standard setting committee to 25 so the standard setting committee had 20 articulation had 25 and then on the very right hand side you see the

superintendent's recommendation and you'll notice in this particular case the superintendent at the time bumped the score the cut scores up again to 27 i'm going to go back to the left hand

[09:50:40] side of the chart because this background information is really important so the first column says past proficient cut score for the previous math test so that means what was the cut score on the test prior to this one. So it would have been the mathematics test based on the 2009 standards. It was the one that we set cut scores on in 2012. So on that particular test, the cut score for proficient was 31 out of 50. And the next column is really important.

[09:51:18] It's the past proficient cut score for the new test to maintain the same level of rigor. Basically, this gives the board an estimate of the comparative difficulty of the tests. So if we're looking at grade four, we'll see that the cut score on the previous test was 31 out of 50.

[09:51:37] But the cut score to maintain the same level of rigor was 29 out of 50. It seems counterintuitive, but because that estimated cut score is lower, this is actually a more difficult test.

[09:51:59] So the grade four test and measuring the 2016 standards was slightly more difficult than the test that measured the 2009 standards. So that's why that estimated cut score to maintain the same level of rigor is a bit lower.

[09:52:18] And Shelley, would it be fair to say that the board has set cut scores for each test only once as those tests are developed? That is true in almost all cases. And I'm sorry every time I come up here, I have to tell you all some history, but there was one situation.

[09:52:36] No, it's important. This is an important discussion, and I think people need to understand that, you know, when people say, for example, the board lowered cut scores. Well, we have never taken, at least not in my tenure, a test and said, you know, cut score was 30, we're going to now make it 29 for next year.

[09:52:53] It's always been test to test, new test. And so you are correct that typically the board has only adopted new cut scores when there is a new test. and that means a new set of standards has been adopted and then about three years later we have a new test i think the confusion about lowering the cut scores has been when that estimated cut score to maintain the same level of rigor has been higher than what the board recommended i think that's where there has been the discussion of lowering of cut scores right although it would

[09:53:28] be more accurate to say we changed the level of rigor needed to be past proficient as opposed to lower the cut scores correct so may i ask so uh so i have two questions on that one is so you know on grade four like the the sort of chart that everyone's looking at that show grade four standards across the states and virginia's we're all the way at the lowest is that because we've stayed the same and other states have been raising theirs is that why we've kind of moved to that end of the chart or like what you're referring to the night mapping study exactly yes yeah sorry

[09:54:03] and um we're getting into some really complex discussions now so i mean i can well that's what miss holton asked for is it okay to put is it okay to put that off until you finish this part of the discussion just for the flow i'll ask two questions i'm happy to put off that one and then also how does we not lowering cut scores is one thing then you've also got this whole issue of accreditation so if you change what it means to be accredited it doesn't affect the cut scores but does sort of have a ripple effect i'd love to hear you just talk about how we think about that impact on the kids too yeah all right um so that's just a description of the information you

[09:54:43] you get and you get that all that same information the background information and then also the information about the various committees who've reviewed the the test um in the past this board has not looked i'm so sorry so again looking at these just just so i understand before you move on you're saying that the standard setting summary the recommended recommendation was

[09:55:10] 27 out of 50 right and then the background information 29 out of 50 was the new test that that is the estimated cut score if we wanted to maintain the same level of rigor on the new test as we did on the old so if you wanted to maintain the same expectations on the 2016 test as were

[09:55:42] present on the 2009 test we would have adopted 29 out of 50. but we adopted 27 out of 50. in this particular case the superintendent's recommendation was 27 out of 50 and that is what was adopted got it okay thank you we have had one situation with reading where the superintendent but where the board chose to adopt the articulation committee's recommendation not the superintendent's recommendation but for this particular chart we're looking at now

[09:56:17] the board did adopt the 27 out of 50. for me there were two instances in reading we deviated i think from superintendent lane's recommendations and i think that was it right adopted a more rigorous no actually we adopted the articulation committee which at that time was uh you know i think one below where he was on each of them it's tough to remember all of it andy but i'm pretty sure that's right and i am sorry this is so complicated it just is and it's on page six i was looking at

[09:56:52] page three shelly i think another important thing you articulated is that there is visibility into what the outcome will look like in terms of the standard setting committee and the articulation committee and even the superintendent gets to see that that is not data that the board gets to see as it's trying to make decisions around sort of translating the information so the articulation

[09:57:28] committee sees the impact data and the superintendent sees it the standard setting committee when these standards were set did not see the impact data and you all may want to change your minds about seeing impact data that was something that the 1998 board said they they wanted to make judgments based on content only and not impact data but i think we're probably at a point where you all will want to see the impact data as well you talked us out of it a couple years ago i must

[09:57:58] have been very persuasive you were all right um any questions about the charts then we also have information in the board item about the pass rates, which I think you all are very familiar with at this point. And then there's also information about NAEP, as Superintendent Bailow mentioned. Can I ask, because this is something I am curious about, is rigor determined

[09:58:32] solely by how many people the psychometricians think will pass or percentage? In other words, when we say of equal rigor, is that just means a constant pass percentage? It doesn't. Okay. So, how do they determine how hard the test is if not by how many kids they think will pass so i i am not a psychometrician but it is a statistical estimate based on item response theory that enables us to know how difficult the test is so it's based on how students respond to the

[09:59:07] questions but it is a very complicated statistical procedure but it is this estimate that we've provided um since 2012 i think has actually served the board well in in determining um you know what cut score should be made of course in our system though i didn't think the students took the test before the committees actually looked at it unlike in wyoming where they use bookmark and they do look at it but all

of the items have been field tested so there are items okay so they use the student field test data okay that's helpful thank you miss holton the impact data i am remembering

[09:59:46] some of our prior discussions on that can you just remind me what that is and who does see that under our current system i know i know we don't remind me what it is and who does see it so the impact data is an estimate of how many students will fall into each of the performance levels so so it's a a prediction of what the pass rates will be basically yeah well and so what percentage of kids will be below basic what percentage basic proficient and advanced and and who so somebody we do that every time we adjust the test we

[10:00:23] somebody runs that simulation essentially and who has that information in what stage of the process if any does that get considered the process that was used for these cut scores it was just the articulation committee so So that committee that had representatives from each of the standard setting committees and then the state superintendent.

[10:00:43] - So one process change that we might want to look at is that the articulation, right now, the articulation committee and the superintendent, the prior process, the superintendent and the articulation committee see that data. We might, a process change we might look at that would still preserve this, I think, longstanding process would be to add that impact data into the board's uh considerations so we would know if we're making a cut score change are we suddenly declaring everybody uh passing or whether whether whether we're predicting a major shift

[10:01:23] up or down in in pass rates thank you we certainly are in a different environment now you know the 1998 board i think was concerned that they didn't want to make a decision based just on what percentage of students would pass but we you know we are 20 plus years past the beginning of the program now it was interesting to hear the difference in the bookmark field test approach to trying to understand um what students know um linked to standards i would assume and um the

[10:02:01] angoff method which really does i mean i'm looking at the distinction between um the standard setting committee which you articulated as you know these are educators with subject matter expertise and you see that it would be interesting to know to what extent in the earlier grades there is more distance between the items that end up being included or that the committee believes that

[10:02:36] a proficient student should be able to address. I mean, it is quite a difference. I'm looking at the third grade 16 out of 40 versus 21 out of 40 right just the variability in what feels like and i know you've described to us the angoff method many times and the level of um precision that goes into trying to ensure that there is some measure of reasonableness associated with

[10:03:11] which items end up making sense to keep i may not be explaining this exactly right but that subjective piece of this is just interesting to think about in the content expert sort of perspective of coming up with the score versus how the articulation committee lands as they see as they actually see what the impact of those judgments are as a result of that analysis i I think that's what I'm trying to get at,

[10:03:49] just trying to appreciate how that maybe is a correction method for something on the field test basis that seems a little bit less subjective. Well, and if the articulation committee sees a difference in the pass rates, then they're asked, is there something in those performance level descriptors that describes what a student has to do to be proficient?

[10:04:16] there something that's different in grade 4 and grade 5 that would explain that difference so we always bring it back to the to the content this is very helpful so for past proficient this is almost like 55 percent knowledge content knowledge is enough to pass a student remember that we have to take into account the difficulty of the items so i mean we could give you a 10 item test that was really easy or we could give you a 10 item test that was really difficult so it it is dependent

[10:04:55] on the difficulty of the items and that's why the teachers or the committee members review each test item independently so this doesn't take into account the weightage of but just the number of questions in this example it would be 27 out of 50 items that the standard setting committees reviewed that particular set of items which sorry which uh you were talking about reading or math so i have it still on man which okay yeah that's fine if you're still on math you're still

[10:05:34] on page three right page four page three grade four right okay it's getting late right so around so it's not weighted no it's just the number of items correct out of the total number of items the 54 percent of items correctly answered those particular items so how how would you then effectively compare from either from year to year or from test to test if there are different

[10:06:11] weightages so again it's it's where we rely on our psychometricians again there's statistical methods for it's called equating to make sure that we're expecting the same level of proficiency from students from year to year and the same number of say above uh harder questions are given out each year and the same number of below average if the if the difficulty of the

[10:06:41] items shifts slightly then the number of items needed to be proficient is adjusted as well um president gecker and mr rotherham would it be acceptable if we were to defer the discussion of of the NAIC mapping study until the next meeting.

[10:07:06] - Be okay with me, I mean, Andy. - Fine with me, unless it comes up, is context what we're trying to do, we need to get into it, but. - So, and Superintendent Mayla, I don't know if you have other comments to make. I believe your recommendation was for the board to direct us to come back with the point.

[10:07:22] - That's, thank you. - That is what I'm hoping to glean from the discussion, despite the late hour, is some direction for us to come back to you with a rationale for changing cut scores and not doing that based on a thought of going from the lowest cut scores to the highest cut scores or middle to the top, but really hopefully achieving that with a good rationale and good reasoning behind that.

[10:07:54] So that's what I'm hoping for. And that obviously parlays right into our accountability accreditation discussions and work that we need to do and um and and again is forward momentum to inform that additional work that we're doing my goal is to make sure that that we're moving forward like this not that we're coming forward each month with information that said by the way we prepared this for you and you don't know about it but it's really important and this is really important we're letting you know about it and we'd like to bring it back to you with some direction from you in that

[10:08:31] I think what I would like to see, you know, again, I don't usually speak first, but, oh, Alan, if you want to go first, you can, is, you know, not just the decision we're going to raise scores, but an understanding of what the impact of raising scores would be.

[10:08:48] I mean, a discussion of really, are we still using the right method? I mean, because we clearly have other considerations than some other places, you know, in terms of how we set them. should we

consider moving from Angloff to bookmark? And I know there were historic reasons we didn't about when we can get the test scores ready, and I appreciate that, but the five new board members have not heard that discussion yet.

[10:09:10] I think that would be helpful because the majority of states use a different method for setting cut scores than we do. - They also don't adopt their cut scores until after the test. - I know that, that's what I'm saying. I understand that there are reasons, Shelley, and I heard you loud and clear last time we discussed it. I just, we've got five folks who have never heard the plea to not do this, and I figure it would least be an appropriate thing to understand you know should we look at it again understanding the pros and cons I will say that our good friends in Massachusetts you know recently changed their competency determinations and they were measuring student outcomes by their college career readiness outcomes you

[10:09:50] know how many of their kids were going to college and there's some pretty interesting work they've done I'd like to understand what the indicators are we would use to justify raising the scores and if we raise the scores are we going to saying we're raising it for I'm ready to go to the next grade or are we raising them in other ways in other words is you look at the Massachusetts system they have what four categories in the lower grades exceeds meeting partially meet and not meeting and I don't know how Nate maps and whether they go to well they also have for the higher grades you know or the lower grades advanced proficient needs improvement and failing I don't know

[10:10:27] which one of those NAEP maps to or the, you know, honesty gap is mapped to. But all you need up there to keep moving on is the needs improvement, right? The second lowest of those scores. And so, you know, essentially I think what, you know, the administration is looking for is a full and fair discussion of if we raise expectations as evidenced by an increase in cut scores? Would we have changes and what would those changes be expected to be in our students, number one? Number two, what else do we have to change? In other words, when we first talked

[10:11:05] about, gee, let's just raise them up 10 points. Just as an example, we could predict another 30% of the kids would fail. Under our system, that meant you'd have a lot of kids not progressing, right? Forget the accreditation piece. The impact on the individual kid was going to be significant.

[10:11:22] And so I think, again, what I would be looking for is, you know, a discussion of, if we're going to do it, what are the benefits and what's the path forward to do it? And is that clear enough, I hope? I appreciate your comments, Mr. President.

[10:11:39] I think that, yes, we're ready. So, for example, the Massachusetts descriptors you did, they're more descriptive of the levels. And because they're different, you know, you don't have to mix proficient here versus proficient there and then try to articulate why proficient is different.

[10:11:56] So I think that's certainly a piece of it. I guess, and thank you all. Bless you. My hope going forward, I think we're definitely in an era where we're going to have a look at cut scores. We're going to have to wrestle with them. We're going to become very knowledgeable and make some decisions. And I think everybody would like to see Virginia's children thrive.

[10:12:17] So I think we're entering that era. My concern on this is that we don't consider it a stand-alone measure, that we don't we don't think cut score is just like there's the one lever on the wall we pull we started yesterday with jenna conway talking about systems thinking and the thoughtfulness the virginia

literacy act and all those kinds of things so i just think there needs to be thoughtfulness systems thinking about this and that system thinking absolutely needs to think about the cut score but it also needs to think about not to end the impact and all those kinds of things but how does it fit into our system we're starting this big conversation about accountability and you know severed accreditation i think all these things start to fit in the other

[10:12:55] piece that i i broke a record on is you know at some point in time we need to think about the tests and and you know and i'm not sure when when the when the vendor contract comes up and what have rfp opportunities there are i just think there's we're at a point where i think we just need to think systems yeah i i concur with all of that i think that's what we really need is a little bit what are the things we don't know and help us appreciate the extent to which this is a water balloon and so you push on one yeah it pushes out somewhere else and we need coming into a conversation we're about to have on on accountability and accreditation too we just have

[10:13:32] to have a clear field of view so we can make good decisions and i think like you you've forgotten more about this stuff than we know and so we just need that we need that down on paper right um to help us and i would include in in all that just also the history would be so you've got some of that's in the agenda items make sure we have that and same thing on with just the history of accreditation just to help us understand how do we get to where we are and then so we can like i think that that's important uh just to appreciate sort of the continuity and so forth and then again help us think about the impact of all this would be extremely uh valuable i think the next step in

[10:14:11] in moving forward on doing something about this. We need to learn. - Ms. Hulton? - Just a couple of things to add to the conversation. If we're asking you to do a study, essentially, and come back and report to us, one of the things I would like to see, the president said that he's asking to see the impact.

[10:14:32] What are the changes gonna be for students? What else would we need to change? I would like to include what would the impact be on school level accreditation. And especially under, well, under the current accreditation system, assuming that there may or may not be changes to that.

[10:14:53] And if there are other alternatives that are out there, it would be helpful to see it under those as well. And then the second thing I would like to see added is research on whether having higher expectations, i.e. higher cut scores, impacts student success.

[10:15:15] And you know is that you know looking at states that have adopted higher cut scores all other things being a equal is there any research on whether what the impact of that is or States that have moved from you know some I think there are some states that have made Moves to greatly change their their cut scores So is there research on before and after again other things being equal?

[10:15:41] so the research piece and the more of the impact at the school level on accreditation and then the My final thing is that we'd like to see the HB938 report and maybe even hear from those task force folks that worked on this, I'm sure that would be useful.

[10:15:58] It's my understanding that that committee did the HB938. Am I right that they looked at this cut score issue and made some recommendations? - Where do we see that? You mentioned that yesterday also. - It's supposed to be filed with the General Assembly by November 30th, so I guess it will be out there for public, but it's my understanding that they made some recommendations, a la what Mr. Rotherham

sent us all a piece, a literature piece six weeks or so ago, saying, for instance, that one change you might want to make is add some additional expertise to your review committees.

[10:16:37] You might want to add some higher ed people, for instance. And what I've heard is that their recommendations was that we make changes to the process, a la that, using the research, rather than some wholesale change. whatever they recommended, we'd like to see it.

[10:16:53] - And so, Superintendent, is that out somewhere, HB9? - It isn't, it's not finalized. - Because I did hear a reference to it yesterday and I was kinda surprised. - I did too, and I was as well, because it is not finalized. The group has met, the report is being drafted.

[10:17:13] If you'll recall... - This is 9:30. - 9:38, that committee was on a really, really short timeline. I think, when did the General Assembly finally finish things? Mid-June-ish, end of June. And we had from June until now to make recommendations in, I believe, six different areas.

[10:17:33] So that report is not finalized, but you'll also remember that that is a secretary superintendent report with consultation, in consultation with the board. And so the secretary and I appointed those board members and then we'll share those recommendations.

[10:17:52] - We don't have to sign off on the report, but we'll be able to review it when the public is. But the information I'm going on is apparently there was a consultant that was leading the effort. The final meeting of the task force was on November 4th. The consultant submitted a draft report to the department on November 7th, and it is awaiting action by the administration leadership.

[10:18:15] So there is a draft report. There is not a final report has been sent back out to the task force members as of when i heard from one from one of the task force members some time ago are we pretty clear where we're going shelly i hope sarah yes sir thank you we greatly appreciate both of you being here and you know really the knowledge piece you guys have is unbelievable so uh if you're thinking of retiring don't we've already lost one today

[10:18:49] that i can't afford to lose and you know just i'm asking for at least june 30. we beg you yeah do we need a motion for this are we good i think we're good with the department tomorrow thank you all very much thanks i i i the it's it's clear um as as long as shelley is clear yeah i think are we good we're making forward motion and we are coming back to you thank you for the clear direction and clear input.

[10:19:18] - All right, now I know, Superintendent, you had about 40 minutes of announcements you wanted to make. - I'm looking forward to a discussion of current issues. Off the agenda, sorry. - Hunting stories. - Yeah. - Okay, you know what, I won't go through my update, but I do wanna share that this week, the department awarded three planning grants for lab schools, and we sent out those letters.

[10:19:43] I am a little bit reluctant to say who they are because I am not sure that that's public yet. But it's really, really exciting to first of all, receive applications. We have more to review, more that are in the queue.

[10:19:58] And we also have an additional application that skips the planning grant phase and goes straight to a lab school. And so it's very exciting to see that come to fruition and have the structures in place review the applications and go forward so i did want to share that bit of good news okay anybody else have anything when do you think we would know i'm going to check on that right now okay anybody mr president yes ma'am um in light of shelley's presentation just now i would really

[10:20:34] like to make a motion about specifically moving some things forward as it relates to um ensuring that we ask the superintendent specifically to examine a rationale and a plan for raising those expectations specifically the cut scores looking at how we do that in the future for specifically three through eight in the reading and math areas okay if you want to broaden it to uh all the things we said before which includes not only rationale but research sure

[10:21:11] and the holistic system that dr siebert talked about methodology well more than methodology right i mean because you want to look even assessments i mean if you want to broaden the scope i think you know i'd be happy to support that i think the narrow scope is more narrow than we've asked the department to do it hasn't it isn't just cut scores it's the whole package and how it fits in okay are we clear we need a motion does the department have enough guys we don't the department's accepted the charge but if there's a reason we can talk about getting the motion right but if there's not a need for a motion I think it's important to moving the

[10:21:46] conversation forward and so as if we have an official motion on the books that shows that we are moving towards this end I think that's important well just I for one I'm not yet I don't yet have enough information to say that I would endorse raising the cut scores I don't think that's what my mission is my - My motion is really just to get the research, the understanding of where we are and where we could go.

[10:22:19] - If I'm hearing you, you're really formalizing what the request was and I, for one, appreciate that. I like operating that way when, again, we're like this moving forward and the expectations for my staff and I are really clear in terms of what we need to present.

[10:22:36] So I really appreciate that formalize. i raise just a point of order and i would support the amendment but what do we like a couple of meetings ago miss dada had a set of requests like how do we codify those we didn't go through formal resolutions but i assume like you know as a board member she got responses like how do we how do we codify those things to make sure that first of all the public's aware of what we're asking for as a matter of transparency but then second that there's some accountability that we're going to to get it so i'm not in any way arguing against as crazy's but i feel like since that's now on the table it's a good time to for you to tell us like what has been standard operating procedure

[10:23:14] standard operating procedure has been to ask and the department has delivered it has not been to make a motion for everything requested uh and in the past of course you know the department was responsive to the board in that way happily you know there is you know the ability under i think it's under the superintendent's obligations in the code section or maybe it's under our powers but i think it's under the superintendent's obligations that the board can direct the superintendent to cause things to happen through the department we never had that be necessary in the years i've been here we've always accepted the superintendent saying as jillian did before yeah we can do this

[10:23:55] or james lane saying yeah we can do this but if we want to start operating under you know a different model, that's fine. I mean, we have no enforcement mechanism, right? So, I mean, I was content to ask, have staff say, "I knew, I know what you want," and have Jillian say, "We'll do it."

[10:24:14] - And let me just clarify that I think there's a time and a place for some of these requests to be formal and or formalized via motion. And that is our big initiatives that we're working on.

[10:24:29] This is one of them. I've been at this long enough to know that it's really a good idea to have that in minutes, in motions, so that you can take a historical look or other states can take a historical look

because our accountability system will be so great that they want to take the same actions that we did.

[10:24:51] And so putting some of these milestones forward momentum movements that we're making toward bigger goals is really important I withdraw my question second I would also just say that part of the reason for that is that there there was some consternation about questions about the decoupling of the document the curriculum frameworks back we were discussing history SOL several months ago and there was no understanding and I couldn't find anything back in the minutes about that discussion and so I

[10:25:31] would feel more comfortable with a formalized motion myself so as long as the motion I mean just because the motion is a little amorphous whoever's taking minutes God bless you but if if I understand correctly the motion is a study motion not a recommendation for raised cut scores it may eventually be Emotion for raise cut scores at this point. It is a study motion. Is that correct?

[10:25:59] And we are studying have no problem studies Impact of expectations as may be evidenced by cut scores on student outcomes And dr. Siebert's assessments Three of us raised that So is that good? Okay, is there a second I seconded any other discussion all in favor signify by saying aye Okay, I have canceled the executive session, if that's okay.

[10:26:32] Although if you guys want to do it, you know, the lawyers are here. We have sent staff home for items O&P, so even if you want to do those, I'm sorry, we're not. You know, we can put them off until next month, but we did want to get the cut score piece in this meeting.

[10:26:49] And I would like to at least discuss, we had a discussion yesterday about accountability and accreditation. don't think we have like a clear path forward except there's i think a general sense that we need to figure out ways to decouple those things if we're going to have an accountability system because the accreditation system uh you know carries a lot of baggage and i would welcome an opportunity to have a discussion about that and talk about do we want emergency authority in part because we may not be meeting again for a little while to start to be able to direct the staff to help us start to figure out what are some of our options are there and what things what things look like as we talked about yesterday i don't believe we asked for emergency authority

[10:27:26] until we know what we're doing because part of the requirement is we need not only to say what we want but with a rationale for what we want and we don't if we don't know what we're doing we have no rationale and so nor does not asking for it now hold anything up in the timeline uh because as soon as the governor signs the request we're done all right it's done so from my perspective I thought where we were can we get some clarification on that because I think that the the once the as I understand And and as it was in in my former state

[10:28:02] Once the letter is signed, there's not a clock that ticks until until the until the regs are However, by the same token if we took on first review next month or the next meeting The proposal we could issue the letter at that point the governor could sign it that day And the regs would go into effect in the same time frame as if we asked for it today The only difference being we would actually be asking for something that we know what we're asking for instead of amorphously saying we have an emergency But we have no idea what we want to do about it. Well, I think we want to examine Accreditation account. I think we can get to it narrow enough. I don't think I are

[10:28:40] I thought that's where we concluded yesterday that they were gonna look at the nine principles from Florida and you know See what was the fit for Virginia? So I thought we were moving that forward,

but again, we didn't do this motion approach I know everyone's tired. I think this is why we have to talk about it because I was not like Florida's great, but I was not I thought we were gonna look at this more broadly in terms of what do we need by way of Accreditation that we were not pitching her and I wasn't trying to limit it to Florida I would just say in terms of them looking at principles and bringing back where what tools Virginia had in those principles but I I think that

[10:29:17] That a letter and permission from from this governor first of all is is a preference that I have and and one that shared by the administration the secretary's office and and it signals to all of Virginia That that we're really serious about about making sure that we we examine and move forward intensely and So even though we would not use it obviously until regs are approved by this board Having it having it approved and moving down that track

[10:29:52] Maybe maybe we move so quickly or something changes and we tear it up. I don't think that that will happen but to have that To have that in in play I think is really important or I shouldn't say in play But have it in our pocket is is a preference that I have as we move forward I have no idea what we're are we talking about an A through F grading system Are we talking about a starred system a weighted index or something completely different?

[10:30:24] What and and what are the impact on student success, etc. Until we have some idea what the department is proposing? I just don't see I mean I want I want to know how is this going to help students number one and number two as part of that How is it going to address our teacher shortage crisis right now everything I've heard be on the table?

[10:30:48] Unless there is also a budget proposal a significant budget proposal runs the serious risk of making things worse For our neediest students because we're going to drive teachers even further away from those high-need schools And so I I just don't think this is ripe for primetime. I don't I don't get it. There's no it there think what we're asking for is authority emergency rulemaking authority i don't think we i would not be comfortable asking for any particular accountability system right now or anything anything like that but i i do i do think when you look at the totality of this i do think we have

[10:31:24] under the the broad definition of the way we think about emergencies i think i think it meets that i would like to have the flexibility i do want to be absolutely crystal clear that the work on this needs to be thorough, high quality, and we will need to stop if we run into any concerns around that. There's like an enormous capacity lift here. And so this is not in any way a green light, and this is not, we're going to go fast and break things, quite the opposite. And so I just want to be, given some of the capacity challenges we've experienced, I just want to be absolutely crystal

[10:32:01] clear that I think we would set back the efforts to improve accountability and also make life more difficult for educators for no reason if we're not very careful. And so, like, I'm not saying this is now we put the foot on the gas, we don't stop. But I think having that flexibility would be extremely important. We have the flexibility now, right, to draft. And if we believe we have an emergency, once we know which direction we're going, we can write a letter to the governor and say, here's what we want and here's why it's an emergency. And here's the proposed solution.

[10:32:33] It does not change the time frame of implementation at all. It's a question to me of cart before the horse and you know i just don't think we write letters that don't know what we want to do mr mr i'm sorry you go i was just wondering that yeah i do appreciate you know the talk about flexibility and we know that something has to be done i mean something does need to uh the transparency accountability

uh factors do need to change and i was just wondering if something that can be develop we know I don't think we're defining a process but I would like to

[10:33:11] be able to move and things in parallel so that and as I said as soon as we have even the first draft of a proposal you have more than enough time to get it approved by the governor but that's moving in series not parallel and I know it's actually moving in parallel because right now you want to say we're going to do an emergency request before we have a single document drafted what I am saying is the day you have first review, we can do that. And then we come back to final review and it can be implemented at the same time as the governor will sign the letter. That's a parallel process. You're basically saying, Hey, we know we're going to do something. We don't know what

[10:33:51] it is we're going to do, but we want you to declare there's an emergency because we think there's something we want to do. But what if the board doesn't hit upon that something, right? Then, and, and how, you know, part of the letter is here's what we're proposing. I have no idea to say how to say what we're proposing here mr. gecker am i right i don't think there's any precedent for writing a letter to the governor saying this is emergency without saying anything about what i mean there's just no way to write to get we want to do things but what are the things we want to do i think the problem is it's not we want to do eight things we don't know what it is

[10:34:30] we don't know what that's going to look like that's also not we want to do things and people may be in a different place and maybe i'm the only one i think our accreditation system has been functioning as an accountability system and it doesn't work as one and we need an accountability system and and that we've got that that it behooves us to move as expeditiously as responsible on that to help people understand in a real-time actionable way with what's what's going on now i may be that that may that may be a minority of one believing that but that's we had a long discussion yesterday about the path forward and again the request to the governor can occur at any point

[10:35:09] during that process i would prefer it occur when we actually have a direction right now we don't have a direction so we could direct the superintendent to give us that direction very quickly i think we'll probably may end up with the same the direction was bring back proposed regs at the next meeting that was the direction right that's where we're going that wasn't i wouldn't say that's the direction but that's what we presented um again it it may be um it may be preference but i'm i'm telling you that that the preference is to put this in motion as a signal

[10:35:48] that formalizes the process um so that we can move forward um and am i correct that he can also just if he wants the heat can he has the authority to do that unilaterally whether or not we were no no we have to request it we have to request it and i think that's an important signal to send to all of virginia that um that we will be sending rules they will be forthcoming We will act expeditiously because of the urgency and the seriousness of this of this situation So if we know that there is going to be a change of some sort

[10:36:27] Is and to get the ball rolling? It's nothing to do with getting the ball rolling the ball should be rolling at the department So let me let me What we're looking for here is a political signal that change is coming. It's not about process at this point It's about messaging the messaging occurred yesterday. The board was quite clear which direction we're going okay We will come back with with regs, and we will do it that way again. That is is not my preference

[10:37:07] Well, I'm happy to move the I'm happy to move that we request the authority and see I don't know where everybody I don't know where we have enough Folsom discussion yet a few of us have talked about everybody so I don't have a sense of where everybody even is on this I felt pretty good about where we got yesterday, and now I'm the one out of gas.

[10:37:33] And so, I still think we probably ought to look at calendars before we all leave, but that comes after this conversation. So, are you saying you'd like to make a motion and see? That's fine. I think what Dr. Siebert said there is important.

[10:37:50] You have what you feel to move forward on this end, though, with starting... We'll continue to move forward. Certainly, you know, whatever you want to call this, it's an important signal that formalizes a process. But, but I am, I am not, I'm not hearing that the chair is, or that the president is supporting that.

[10:38:12] And so again, especially if we look at calendars. Good enough. I'm not going to force the issue. Is there anything else on the agenda? Well, to what you mentioned earlier, Mr. Rotham, I had made a couple of motions.

[10:38:28] The last one, I just, is that something being worked on? you know if the department is okay i'm going to ask emily to just provide a quick update on that okay thanks good evening we do we do have several reports and follow-ups to the motions that were passed by several of you last month so those have been drafted and they're currently under review and as soon as they are ready to go they will be sent out to you which hopefully will be very soon

[10:39:06] thank you yes ma'am anybody else somebody ordered the pizza yeah i turned that one down that was a mistake it really was okay uh the other items we're going to move to uh next month uh deb will you be prepared next month or the next meeting for the executive session on that one issue oh do you you want to do it how quick all right is there a motion to move into executive session

[10:39:43] well a special line we need the line we need more than that sorry should we take a two-minute

[10:39:51] restroom break sure cool dr man i move pursuant to virginia code 2.2-37 3711 7 and 8 the virginia

[10:47:15] board of education convene in a closed meeting for the purpose of consultation with legal counsel and briefings by staff members or consultants pertaining to the to actual or probable litigation where such consultation or briefing and open meeting would adversely affect the negotiating or litigating posture of the public body as detailed below. Consultation with legal counsel regarding specific legal matters requiring the provision of legal advice as detailed below.

[10:47:45] And that Deb Love, legal counsel to the Virginia Board of Education, as well as staff members, superintendent jill jillian baylow uh and tim nut hall whose presence will aid the board's consideration of this matter participate in the closed meeting okay uh motions or a second second thank you all in favor aye we're in closed session let me clear the room thank you

[11:08:29] okay the three awarded planning grants oh sorry do the motion okay and then you can send your email please six words okay we convene today in close meeting pursuant to a recorded vote on the motion above and in accordance with the freedom of information act section 2.2-3712 of the code of virginia requires that the board certify that to the best of each member's knowledge one only public business matters lawfully exempt from open meeting requirements under this chapter and two

[11:09:08] only such public business matters as were identified in the motion by which the closed meeting was convened were heard discussed or considered any member who believes there was a departure from these requirements shall so state prior to the vote indicating the substance of the departure that in his or her judgment has taken place the statement of the departure will be recorded in the minutes take the vote by roll call for the certification ms creasy

[11:09:34] Ms. Hulton? Aye. Dr. Siebert? Aye. Dr. Mann? Aye. Mr. Hanson? Aye. Ms. Dutta? Aye. Mr. Rotherham? Aye. And chair votes aye. Okay. Superintendent, six words. I have permission to share the awardees for the planning grants. It is Mary Washington, Mountain Gateway, and George Mason. Perfect. Any other business? Actually, I'm going to look over here because I'm afraid Andy will say yes. Process, a process question. You've broken it.

[11:10:04] all right we are adjourned thank you all very much

